

Changes in extreme temperatures of the Earth’s desert regions over the next 100 years

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Abstract

We quantify changes ΔQ in 100-year return values for regional annual maxima and minima of near-surface atmospheric temperature from output of five CMIP6 models, for five of the Earth’s desert regions, over the interval (2025,2125). We use generalised extreme value (GEV) regression to characterise changes in extremes, considering a range of different parametric forms for the variation of GEV parameters with time, and coupling models for different scenarios so that they provide a common GEV tail in the first year of observation. Parameters are estimated using Bayesian inference.

We perform a simulation study using ground truth models generating data qualitatively similar to the CMIP6 output, to assess the relative performance of different “information criteria” in selecting models from a set of candidates, to minimise error in predictions of ΔQ . The Bayesian information criterion (BIC) provides best performance, outperforming the divergence and widely-applicable information criteria in particular.

Using BIC-selected GEV regression models, we estimate joint posterior distributions of ΔQ over SSP126, SSP245 and SSP585 scenarios, for different combinations of region, GCM and climate ensemble. Estimates show a consistent trend across regions, GCMs and climate ensembles, of ΔQ increasing with climate scenario for both regional annual maxima and minima. Aggregating posterior distributions over climate ensembles and GCMs, we find evidence for significant increases in ΔQ for regional annual maxima under SSP245 and SSP585 scenarios for all desert regions. Similar but weaker and less significant trends are observed for regional annual minima.

Keywords: climate; CMIP6; surface temperature; extreme; generalised extreme value; model selection; Bayesian inference; return value;

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1. Introduction

Our planet’s climate is changing due to human activity. Projections under specified future emissions scenarios using global climate models (GCMs) allow assessment of risk to society, and the efficacy of remedial actions. Large uncertainties in projections remain, especially at local scales (see e.g. Simpson et al. 2025). Some of the greatest societal impacts are caused by changes in mean characteristics of variables quantifying the state of the Earth’s atmosphere and oceans. The fidelity with which these changes are encoded in GCMs can be assessed by comparing climate model output with observation. Other important impacts are caused by extremes, including heatwaves and storms. It is therefore critical also to understand the characteristics of projections of extremes from GCMs. Near-surface atmospheric temperature (**tas**) is a critical output of global climate models; it is widely observed, it is the variable most commonly used to define global warming. It is typically projected to increase under all emission scenarios, and it is a key parameter in physical processes. In particular, the Sixth Assessment Report of the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC 2023) concludes with high to very high confidence that continued increases in global **tas** will lead to systematic intensification of climate impacts, with severities strongly dependent on the magnitude of warming. For example, it is virtually certain that the frequency and intensity of hot extremes, including heatwaves, will increase as global mean near-surface temperature rises.

Desert regions push the Earth’s climate systems to its limits (see e.g. Warner 2004): observations of the Earth’s most extreme temperatures occur in desert regions. Studying predictions of the effects of climate change of extremes of desert temperatures is therefore particularly interesting. In this paper, we seek evidence for changing distributional characteristics of annual maxima and minima of **tas** output from five different CMIP6 GCMs, for some of the Earth’s most prominent desert regions (characterised by low annual precipitation). We estimate non-stationary extreme value models in time, coupled over three forcing scenarios, using Bayesian inference. We consider candidate models encoding different extents of non-stationarity, and use carefully-validated model selection criteria to choose optimal representations.

Outputs from GCMs are subject to bias. Therefore for interpretation, output of global climate models for variables such as **tas** are typically transformed to regional scale projections using downscaling procedures, and potentially further calibrated using observations. Here we work directly with GCM output to quantify the extent to which return values for **tas** change over the next century. We estimate the distribution of the difference between the 100-year return value for **tas** in 2025 and 2125 directly. This approach avoids introducing extra variability in our estimates related to uncertain downscaling and calibration models, at the expense of potential bias due to lack of calibration. As noted in Leach et al. (2025), successful calibration requires that reasonable data are available for both model output and direct measurement, over a relatively large proportion of the time period of interest, (2015,2125) here. We cannot be confident that a calibration developed for the years (2015,2025) (for which measurements are available) is appropriate in 2125. Note also that the *difference* in 100-year return values for **tas** over the next century is unaffected by constant bias correction calibration.

Model selection for extremes is challenging. We estimate a statistical model for the probability distribution which generated the sample data, the functional form of which is dependent on a number of parameters. In a non-stationary model, model parameters themselves vary with covariates. Often, the form of the functional relationship for a model parameter with covariates takes a parametric form; e.g. a model parameter might be linear or quadratic in one or more covariates. For a set of such “parametric regression” candidate models, model selection requires selecting the parametric form for model parameter variation with covariates which is most consistent with the sample data. An alternative approach to “parametric regression” is “semi-parametric” (or “non-parametric”) regression, in which variation of model parameters with covariates is described using more flexible representations (such as splines, Gaussian processes or neural networks). Now there is no need for model selection as such: the challenge instead is to restrict the flexibility of covariate representation so that the model gives optimal performance (see e.g. Zanini et al. 2020).

For “parametric regression”, there are numerous approaches to model selection. If the objective is minimisation of generalisation error, then maximisation of model out-of-sample predictive performance is an appropriate strategy (see e.g. Vehtari and Ojanen 2012, Gelman et al. 2013). This assessment tends to involve either repeated model fitting (e.g. in a cross-validation scheme) or model fitting to just a subset of the sample (e.g. if the sample has been partitioned into training and test subsets). An alternative approach, popular amongst practitioners in particular, is the use of cost-complexity scores or “information criteria” to rank candidate models, selecting the model with optimal score. This approach is relatively straightforward, requiring just one model fit to the sample. An information criterion typically penalises a model in terms of both its lack of fit to the sample, and its complexity; a good low score requires relatively good fit and relative parsimony. Different information criteria quantify lack of fit and model complexity differently, motivated by theoretical and practical considerations; Gelman et al. (2013) Gelman et al. (2014), Kim et al. (2017) and Zhang et al. (2023) provide overviews. Here we consider the Akaike Information Criterion (AIC, Akaike 1974), the Bayesian Information Criterion (BIC, Schwarz 1978), the Divergence Information Criterion (DIC, Spiegelhalter

et al. 2002, Gelman et al. 2004) and the Widely Applicable Information Criterion (WAIC, Watanabe 2013, Vehtari et al. 2017) for model selection. Supplementary material Section SM1 provides further discussion. In comparing the performance of different criteria, Zhang et al. (2023) state that it is not generally possible to foresee which criterion provides best out-of-sample predictive performance for a particular problem. The authors recommend performing a simulation study involving direct quantification of out-of-sample predictive performance using cross-validation, to quantify the relative performance of different information criteria on problems of the relevant type, as a rational basis for selecting the most appropriate criterion for that problem type. This suggestion was adopted by us in the current work to assess which of a range of criteria based on AIC, BIC, DIC and WAIC yields best performance in a specific extreme value prediction problem involving relatively small samples of CMIP6 climate model output for **tas**, below.

Previous work by some of the current authors (e.g. Ewans and Jonathan 2023 and Leach et al. 2025) explored non-stationarity in the distributions of annual maxima and minima of GCM outputs of interest to the ocean engineering community. A series of articles including Kharin and Zwiers (2005), Zwiers et al. (2011), Kharin et al. (2013) and Kharin et al. (2018a) uses parametric GEV regression to quantify non-stationarity of annual maxima of various temperature indices. The parametric form of variation of GEV parameters in time for all of these articles are typically *assumed*, rather than shown statistically to be optimal; see Section SM1.2 for further discussion. Here we seek to justify the functional form for variation of GEV parameters in time based on predictive performance. The impact of climate scenario on the change in the distribution of extreme temperatures has been examined by a number of authors, including Kharin et al. (2018b). Research has tended to focus on independent analysis of data for different climate scenarios. However, for CMIP6 models we expect that the distribution of extreme **tas** will be the same in the first year (2015) of output under all forcing scenarios. For this reason, here we consider coupled models which ensure a common distribution of extreme **tas** under all scenarios in 2015. A discussion of related work of interest, including software for GEV regression, and developments of semi-parametric extreme value regression, is provided in Section SM1.3.

In the current work, we use Bayesian inference (and Markov chain Monte Carlo, MCMC) for model fitting, allowing incorporation of prior information, estimation of the full joint (posterior) distribution of model parameters, and careful quantification of uncertainty. We also demonstrate the potential for Bayesian model averaging (see e.g. Steel 2019, Wasserman 2000) as an alternative to model selection, following the “stacking” approach of Yao et al. (2018), using cross-validation to establish a weighting scheme of candidate models providing optimal predictive performance.

Objectives, outline and novelty

Our objective is to estimate the change, over the century (2025,2125) in the 100-year return value for annual maximum and minimum of **tas** for desert regions. We use output of five CMIP6 GCMs for six of the Earth’s desert regions, described in Section 2 below. To estimate return values, we first characterise how the distribution of annual extrema for each desert region varies in time for each GCM in turn, using parametric generalised extreme value (GEV) regression. Different candidate functional forms for the GEV model parameters (location, scale and shape; see Section 3.1) in time are considered. GCM output for three forcing scenarios is available for numerous ensemble members for each choice of GCM. Since the three scenarios for a given GCM-ensemble pair correspond to the same distribution of extreme temperatures at the start of the GCM period (i.e. in year 2015), we fit a *coupled* GEV regression model imposing this constraint; see Section 3.2. Inference is performed using MCMC. To select between candidate models, we use an information criterion. Since there are many information criteria in use for model selection (see Section 3.3), and it is impossible before analysis to know which criterion is most appropriate to use, we perform a simulation study, generating samples with similar characteristics to those of the CMIP6 spatio-temporal extreme **tas** output, to identify which information criteria provide best eventual estimates of the difference in return values; see Section 4. Using the optimal information criteria, Section 5 provides estimates of changes in return values. The discussion of Section 6 provides an initial assessment of estimates of differences in return values using Bayesian model averaging, exploiting a weighted sum of all candidate models instead of selecting a single candidate.

In estimating the distribution of extreme temperature events from GCM output, the current work can be thought of as building on the series of articles starting with Kharin and Zwiers (2005). Relative to those articles, the novelty of the present analysis is that it (1) considers CMIP6 output for spatio-temporal maxima and minima in desert regions, (2) exploits GEV regressions which are coupled over forcing scenarios, (3) uses Bayesian inference for model estimation, and (4) provides optimal choice of information criterion for parametric GEV regression model selection.

2. Data

Output for near-surface air temperature (**tas**, K) corresponding to five CMIP6 GCMs was accessed via the UK Centre for Environmental Analysis (CEDA) archive during the Spring of 2025. For each of these GCMs, gridded output for the whole globe is generally available daily for the time period 2015-2100. We examine output for three climate scenarios (or climate experiments): SSP126, SSP245 and SSP585. Each of these scenarios combines a Shared Socioeconomic

Pathway (SSP) with a Representative Concentration Pathway (RCP). Experiment SSP126 follows SSP1, a storyline with low climate change mitigation and adaptation challenges, and RCP2.6 which leads to (additional) radiative forcing of 2.6 Wm^{-2} by the year 2100. Analogously, experiment SSP245 (SSP585) follows SSP2 (SSP3), a storyline with intermediate (high) climate change mitigation and adaptation challenges, and RCP4.5 (RDC8.5) which leads to (additional) radiative forcing of 4.5 (8.5) Wm^{-2} by the year 2100.

Daily data are accessed directly from the CEDA archive, for the desert regions (and the temperate UK “control” region) illustrated in Figure 1 and defined by the longitude-latitude bounding boxes of Table 1. For each region, we then calculated the annual maximum temperature, and the annual minimum temperature for the region as detailed in Section 2.1. Notice that the geographic areas of the different regions vary considerably, as does the number of GCM

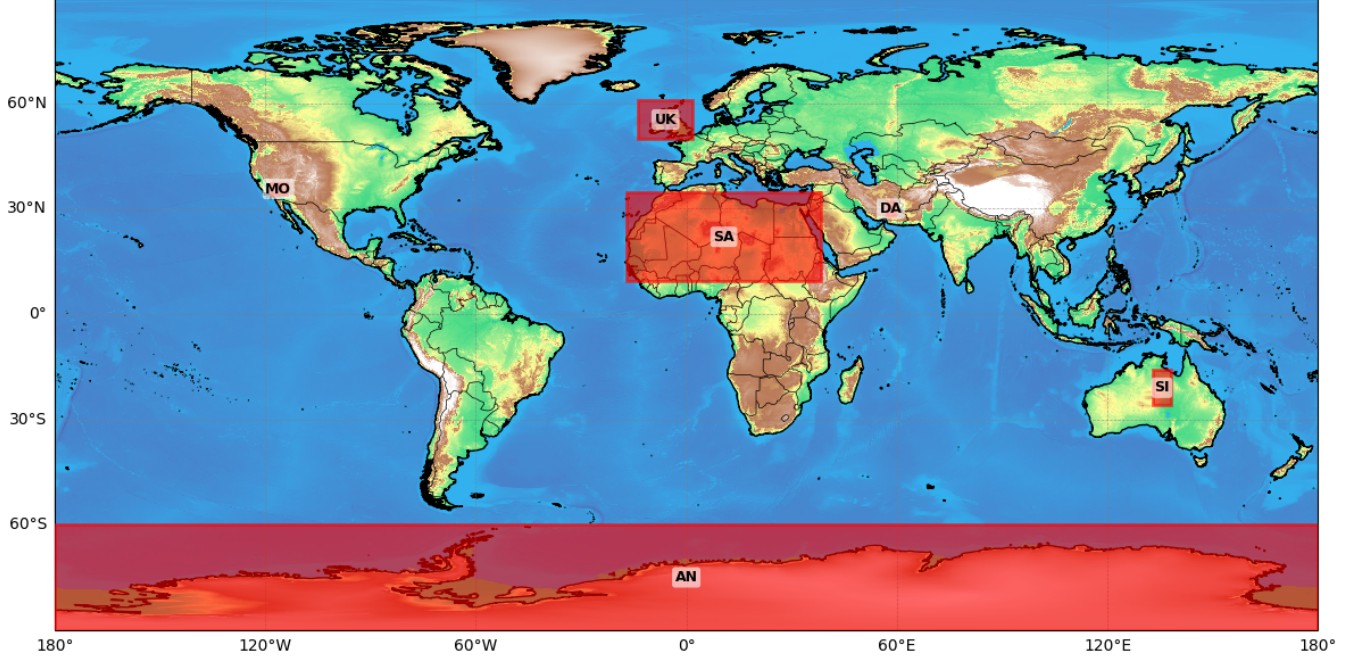


Figure 1: World map showing desert regions considered. Details of longitude-latitude bounding boxes in Table 1. Note that Mojave (MO) and Dasht-e Lut (DA) are small geographic regions consisting of small numbers of GCM grid locations.

grid locations contained within each region. Regional maxima and minima for Antarctic and Sahara in particular are taken over a large number of GCM locations in each case; inspection of Figure 12 provides context. For each

Location	Longitude interval	Latitude interval
Antarctic (AN)	$(-180^{\circ}, -180^{\circ})$	$(-90^{\circ}, -60^{\circ})$
Dasht-e Lut (DA)	$(57^{\circ}, 59.5^{\circ})$	$(28^{\circ}, 32^{\circ})$
Mojave (MO)	$(-118.5^{\circ}, -114^{\circ})$	$(34^{\circ}, 37.25^{\circ})$
Sahara (SA)	$(-17.1^{\circ}, 38.5^{\circ})$	$(9.3^{\circ}, 34.6^{\circ})$
Simpson (SI)	$(133^{\circ}, 138^{\circ})$	$(-26^{\circ}, -16^{\circ})$
UK (UK)	$(-13.7^{\circ}, 1.8^{\circ})$	$(49.9^{\circ}, 60.8^{\circ})$

Table 1: Summary of desert regions. List of geographic locations (and the UK as reference), with region acronyms in alphabetical order (column 1). Longitude-latitude bounding boxes per region (column 2).

combination of desert region, GCM and climate scenario, we examine output for up to five climate model ensemble members (denoted r^* in the climate nomenclature; see Table 2 for examples) where available; these correspond to

a common initialisation (i^*), physics (p^*) and forcing (f^*) per GCM. For each combination of desert region, GCM, climate scenario and ensemble member, we therefore have access to time series, each consisting of 86 values, for annual maximum and annual minimum **tas** for the period 2015-210. The choice of GCM to analyse was entirely pragmatic: we accessed output from all GCMs available on the CEDA archive at the time of data harvesting.

GCM	Ensemble reference
ACCESS-CM2 (AC)	r1i1p1f1, r2i1p1f1, r3i1p1f1, r4i1p1f1, r5i1p1f1
CESM2 (CE)	r4i1p1f1, r10i1p1f1, r11i1p1f1
EC-Earth3 (EC)	r1i1p1f1, r4i1p1f1, r11i1p1f1
MRI-ESM2-0 (MR)	r1i1p1f1, r2i1p1f1, r3i1p1f1, r4i1p1f1, r5i1p1f1
UKESM1-0-LL (UK)	r1i1p1f2, r2i1p1f2, r3i1p1f2, r4i1p1f2, r8i1p1f2

Table 2: List of ensemble members considered per GCM. A total of five GCMs are used, listed in alphabetical order together with two-letter acronym (column 1). A total of up to five ensemble members is considered for each combination of climate variable and scenario (column 2), again depending on availability.

2.1. Compilation of spatio-temporal summaries for desert regions

We consider analysis of spatio-temporal block maxima and minima of **tas**, with temporal blocks corresponding to individual calendar years, and spatial blocks to each of the five desert regions (AN, DA, MO, SA and SI) and temperate UK control region. Henceforth, we refer to the spatio-temporal blocked data as “regional annual maxima” and “regional annual minima” for definiteness. For each combination of region, climate model, ensemble and scenario, regional annual maximum and minima data are extracted per calendar year from GCM output for the corresponding grid of locations (see Table 1). For illustration, Figure 2 shows spatial annual maxima and minima time series for the UK region from UKESM1-0-LL GCM. There is clear evidence for the effect of climate forcing, especially for maxima.

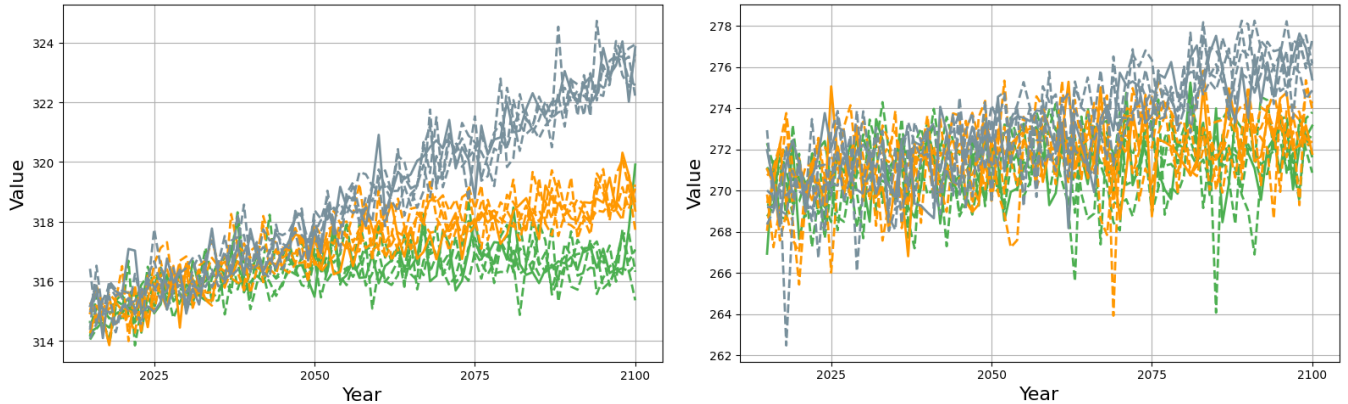


Figure 2: Regional annual maxima (left) and minima (right) time series of **tas** (K) for the UK “control” region from the UKESM1-0-LL GCM. Climate scenarios are distinguished by colour: **SSP126** (green), **SSP245** (orange), **SSP585** (grey). Climate ensemble runs for each scenario, as listed in Table 2, are distinguished by line style.

Figure 3 shows regional annual maxima time series for all regions; corresponding regional annual minima time series are given in Figure SM1. For both regional annual maxima and minima, differences between “cold”, “temperate” and “hot” regions are clear, common to all GCMs. The extent of scenario effects varies somewhat by region and GCM for maxima in Figure 3, but less so for minima in Figure SM1.

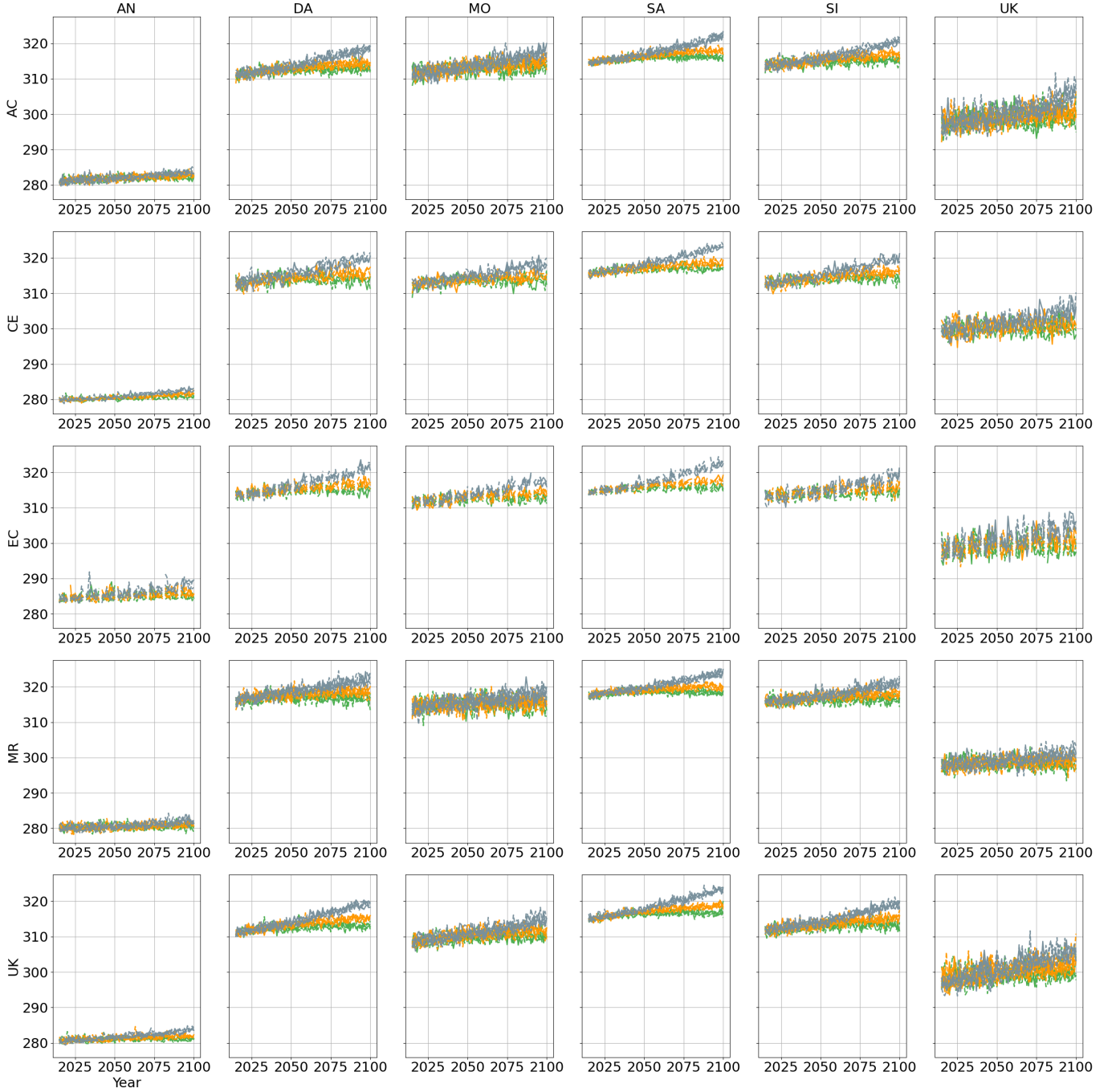


Figure 3: Time series of regional annual maxima of **tas** (K) by GCM (rows: ACCESS-CM2, CESM2, EC-Earth3, MRI-ESM2-0 and UKESM1-0-LL) and region (column: : Antarctic, Dasht-e Lut, Mojave, Sahara, Simpson and UK). In each panel, climate scenarios are distinguished by colour: SSP126 (green), SSP245 (orange), SSP585 (grey). Climate ensemble runs for each scenario, as listed in Table 2, are distinguished by line style. Corresponding spatial annual minima time series are given in Figure SM1.

3. Methodology

We use parametric GEV regression to estimate models for regional annual maxima and minima of **tas**, for regions defined in Section 2.1. Generalising the approaches of Ewans and Jonathan (2023) and Leach et al. (2025), we assume that model parameters vary systematically over the period of observation as a function of time. Moreover, we constrain estimation across the three climate scenarios SSP126, SSP245 and SSP585 such that the estimated tail in the first year of GCM output (2015) is common to all scenarios. We consider GEV regressions with different complexities, discussed in Section 3.1. Model estimation is outlined in Section 3.2. The methods we consider for model selection are discussed in Section 3.3.

3.1. Model complexities

Indexing climate scenarios SSP126, SSP245 and SSP585 in terms of increasing forcing using variable j , $j = 1, 2, 3$, we consider constant, linear and quadratic models for all of location μ , scale σ and shape ξ of the GEV regression, of the form

$$\eta_j(t) = \eta_0 + \tau\eta_{1j} + \tau^2\eta_{2j} \quad (1)$$

where $\eta \in \{\mu, \sigma, \xi\}$, for $i = 1, 2, \dots, P = 86$, $j = 1, 2, 3$, where $\tau = (i - 1)/(P - 1)$, and calendar year $t = i + 2014$. Constant and linear parameterisations are imposed by setting $\eta_{1j} = \eta_{2j} = 0$, and $\eta_{2j} = 0$ respectively. For the location parameter μ , we also consider an ‘‘asymptotic’’ parameterisation

$$\mu_j(t) = \mu_0^a + \mu_{1j}^a \left(\frac{1 - \exp(-\tau/\mu_{2j}^a)}{1 - \exp(-1/\mu_{2j}^a)} \right). \quad (2)$$

The asymptotic parameterisation for μ is considered since intuitively it might be expected that, under some circumstances at least, climate forcing might cause a shift of **tas** over time to a new stable level; it is reasonable to expect that this effect would be most identifiable for the location parameter. For the quadratic and asymptotic parameterisations, note that the values of $\eta_j(2015) = \eta_0$, $\eta \in \{\mu, \sigma, \xi\}$ and $\mu_j(2015) = \mu_0^a$, $j = 1, 2, 3$ are common to all climate scenarios, imposing a common tail distribution for 2015. We also have $\eta_j(2100) = \sum_{k=1}^3 \eta_{kj}$ for the quadratic parameterisation, and $\mu_j(2100) = \sum_{k=1}^2 \mu_{kj}^a$. Note, for a given combination of GCM and region, different parametric forms are considered for each of μ , σ and ξ as a function of time, but those forms are assumed common to all three climate scenarios.

We consider constant (C), linear (L), quadratic (Q) and asymptotic (A) parameterisations for GEV location μ , and C, L and Q parameterisations for σ and ξ . We refer to a specific model choice using an acronym indicating the parameterisations for μ , σ and ξ in order. Thus, ‘‘QLC’’ indicates a GEV regression model with quadratic parameterisation for μ , linear for σ and constant for ξ . It is known that a sample is typically more informative for estimation of GEV location, then of scale then of shape (see e.g. discussion of Jonathan et al. 2008). For this reason, we can expect to identify more complex non-stationary behaviour in GEV location, then in scale, then in shape. As a result, we consider a total of 11 different GEV regression models, with the following complexities: CCC, LCC, QCC, ACC, LLC, LLL, QLC, QLL, QQC, QQL and QQQ.

3.2. Coupled non-stationary generalised extreme value regression

Asymptotic extreme value theory (e.g. Coles 2001, Beirlant et al. 2004, Jonathan and Ewans 2013) shows that block maxima of random draws from a max-stable distribution follow the GEV distribution for sufficiently large block size. With the three climate scenarios again indexed by variable j , $j = 1, 2, 3$, we assume access to a sample $D = \{x_{ij}\}_{i=1, j=1}^{P, 3}$ of regional annual maxima $X_j(t)$ ($i = 1, 2, 3, \dots, P$; $j = 1, 2, 3$; $t = i + 2014$) for analysis, for each combination of climate ensemble and region. Further we assume that for scenario j , the sample is drawn from a GEV distribution, with non-stationary location parameter $\mu_j(t) \in \mathbb{R}$, scale $\sigma_j(t) > 0$, shape $\xi_j(t) \in \mathbb{R}$ and log density function

$$\log f_j(x) = \log f_{\text{GEV}}(x|\mu_j(t), \sigma_j(t), \xi_j(t)) = \begin{cases} -[1 + (\xi_j(t)/\sigma_j(t))(x - \mu_j(t))]^{-1/\xi_j(t)} & \xi_j(t) \neq 0 \\ \exp(-(x - \mu_j(t))/\sigma_j(t)) & \xi_j(t) = 0. \end{cases} \quad (3)$$

Model parameters $\eta_j \in \{\mu_j, \sigma_j, \xi_j\}$ vary with calendar year t as described in Equations 1 and 2, such that a common extreme value tail is fitted for the first year $t = 2015$. The T -year return value $Q_j(t)$ for scenario j in calendar year t is estimated as the $p = 1 - 1/T$ quantile of the corresponding GEV distribution function $F_j(x)$, so that

$$Q_j(t) = \begin{cases} (\sigma_j(t)/\xi_j(t)) \left[(-\log p)^{-\xi_j(t)} - 1 \right] + \mu_j(t) & \xi_j(t) \neq 0 \\ \mu_j(t) - \sigma_j(t) \log(-\log p) & \xi_j(t) = 0. \end{cases} \quad (4)$$

Note that we only consider the case $T = 100$ years in the current work for definiteness. Parameter estimation is performed using Bayesian inference as described in Section SM3, with

$$\ell(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \sum_{j=1}^3 \sum_{i=1}^P \log f_j(x_{ij}|\boldsymbol{\theta}) \quad (5)$$

as sample log likelihood, for parameter vector $\boldsymbol{\theta} = \{\mu_0, \sigma_0, \xi_0, \{\mu_{1j}, \mu_{2j}, \sigma_{1j}, \sigma_{2j}, \xi_{1j}, \xi_{2j}\}_{j=1}^3\}$ (for the full quadratic model QQQ, and the analogous sets for the other 10 GEV regression models). MCMC inference (see Section SM3)

yields a sample $\{\boldsymbol{\theta}_{(s)}\}_{s=1}^{n_S}$ of joint posterior estimates from $f(\boldsymbol{\theta}|D)$ where $n_S = 10,000$. These can be used to estimate the empirical distribution of quantities of interest, such as return values $Q_j(2025)$, $Q_j(2125)$, $j = 1, 2, 3$, and the difference

$$\Delta Q_j = Q_j(2125) - Q_j(2025) \quad (6)$$

in return value over the 100 years from 2025 to 2125. Note that extreme value analysis for regional annual minima is performed via characterisation of the right hand tail of the distribution of negated data.

3.3. Model selection

We consider a large number of possible model parameterisations, and select between them using popular information criteria such as the Akaike information criterion (AIC), the Bayesian information criterion (BIC), the deviance information criterion (DIC) and the Watanabe-Akaike Information Criterion (WAIC).

AIC (Akaike 1974) is an approximation to the Kullback-Leibler divergence between the fitted and underlying true model forms, and takes the form $\text{AIC} = \mathcal{D}(\hat{\boldsymbol{\theta}}) + 2p$, where p is the number of parameters estimated, and $\mathcal{D}(\boldsymbol{\theta})$ is the sample deviance, defined by $\mathcal{D}(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = -2\ell(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = -2\log f(\mathbf{y}|\boldsymbol{\theta})$, evaluated at the maximum likelihood estimates $\hat{\boldsymbol{\theta}}$ of $\boldsymbol{\theta}$ maximising the sample log likelihood defined by Equation 5. Despite its name, BIC (Schwarz 1978) is typically used in a frequentist setting, but has been used in conjunction with Bayesian inference (e.g. Neath and Cavanaugh 2012). BIC is a large sample approximation to the Bayes factor, and defined by $\text{BIC} = \mathcal{D}(\hat{\boldsymbol{\theta}}) + p \log n$ where n is the number of observations for fitting. DIC (Spiegelhalter et al. 2002, Gelman et al. 2004) is typically recommended for model selection in Bayesian inference, and like AIC and BIC, takes the form of “deviance estimate” plus “complexity penalty”. The Spiegelhalter et al. (2002) and Gelman et al. (2004) definitions of DIC are given in Table 3, together with variants due to van der Linde (2005) and Ando (2011). Gelman et al. (2013) recommend use of WAIC (Watanabe 2013) to approximate out-of-sample predictive performance; WAIC again follows the same general form, as detailed in Table 3: WAIC is thought to be a more fully Bayesian approach for estimating out-of-sample expectation, starting with the computed log pointwise posterior predictive density and then adding a correction for effective number of parameters to adjust for over-fitting. Expectations and variances under the posterior distribution are evaluated using the MCMC

Abbreviation	Literature name	Lack of fit, A	Complexity penalty, B	Reference
AIC1	AIC	$\mathcal{D}(\hat{\boldsymbol{\theta}})$	$2p$	Akaike (1974)
AIC2	-	$\mathcal{D}(\mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\theta} D}[\boldsymbol{\theta}])$	$2p$	-
AIC3	Simplified BPIC	$\mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\theta} D}[\mathcal{D}(\boldsymbol{\theta})]$	$2p$	Ando (2011)
BIC1	BIC	$\mathcal{D}(\hat{\boldsymbol{\theta}})$	$p \log n$	Schwarz (1978)
BIC2	-	$\mathcal{D}(\mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\theta} D}[\boldsymbol{\theta}])$	$p \log n$	-
BIC3	-	$\mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\theta} D}[\mathcal{D}(\boldsymbol{\theta})]$	$p \log n$	-
DIC1	DIC	$\mathcal{D}(\mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\theta} D}[\boldsymbol{\theta}])$	$2p_{D1}$, Eqn 9	Spiegelhalter et al. (2002)
DIC2	DICalt	$\mathcal{D}(\mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\theta} D}[\boldsymbol{\theta}])$	$2p_{D2}$, Eqn 10	Gelman et al. (2004)
DIC3	Improved BPIC	$\mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\theta} D}[\mathcal{D}(\boldsymbol{\theta})]$	$2p_{D1}$, Eqn 9	van der Linde (2005), Ando (2011)
WAIC	WAIC	-2lppd , Eqn 8	$2 \sum_{i=1}^n \text{var}_{\boldsymbol{\theta} D}[\log f(y_i \boldsymbol{\theta})]$	Watanabe (2013)

Table 3: Information criteria (of the form $A + B$) explored for model selection. Sample size is n , the number of model parameters p . $\mathcal{D} = -2\log f(\mathbf{y}|\boldsymbol{\theta})$ is the sample deviance, or -2 times the sample log likelihood. $\hat{\boldsymbol{\theta}}$ is the maximum likelihood estimate for $\boldsymbol{\theta}$, and $\mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\theta}|D}[\boldsymbol{\theta}]$ the posterior mean parameter estimate. $\mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\theta}|D}[\mathcal{D}(\boldsymbol{\theta})]$ is the expected sample deviance under the posterior. Definitions of log pointwise predictive density lppd, and the complexity penalties p_{D1} and p_{D2} are given in the equations indicated, in the main text. BPIC refers to the Bayesian Predictive Information Criterion of Ando (2007), intended as an improved version of DIC.

sample, such that for function $g(\boldsymbol{\theta})$

$$\mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\theta}|D}[g(\boldsymbol{\theta})] = \frac{1}{n_S} \sum_{s=1}^{n_S} g(\boldsymbol{\theta}_{(s)}), \text{ and } \text{var}_{\boldsymbol{\theta}|D}[g(\boldsymbol{\theta})] = \frac{1}{n_S - 1} \sum_{s=1}^{n_S} (g(\boldsymbol{\theta}_{(s)}) - \mathbb{E}_{\boldsymbol{\theta}|D}[g(\boldsymbol{\theta})])^2. \quad (7)$$

The log pointwise predictive density lppd is defined as

$$\text{lppd} = \sum_{i=1}^n \log \left(\frac{1}{n_S} \sum_{s=1}^{n_S} f(y_i|\boldsymbol{\theta}_{(s)}) \right) \quad (8)$$

and the penalties p_{D1} and p_{D2} for DIC are defined as

$$p_{D1} = \mathbb{E}_{\theta|D}[\mathcal{D}(\theta)] - \mathcal{D}(\mathbb{E}_{\theta|D}[\theta]) \quad (9)$$

and

$$p_{D2} = 2 \operatorname{var}_{\theta|D} [\log f(\mathbf{y}|\theta)]. \quad (10)$$

Inspired by the nature of the different combinations of “deviance” and “complexity penalty” terms associated with the different information criteria, we consider additional variants AIC2 and BIC2 of AIC and BIC utilising the posterior mean parameter estimate in place of the maximum likelihood estimate. In addition, variant BIC3 adapts BIC to use the posterior mean (predictive) deviance. Further, the analogous adaptation of AIC (to AIC3) results in the simplified BPIC introduced by Ando (and so could also be considered an extension of DIC). The original BPIC of Ando (2007) was developed to reduce over-fitting using DIC; a similar form of information criterion was previously proposed by van der Linde (2005). The simplified BPIC of Ando (2011) is an approximation to BPIC, appropriate when the sample likelihood dominates the prior for well-specified candidate models. In comparing AIC, BIC and DIC, it might be suspected from Table 3 that the role of the complexity penalty is likely to be crucial, and that there is considerable similarity between some information criteria from nominally different classes.

Next, in Section 4, we evaluate the performance of all information criteria in a simulation study using data with known characteristics mimicking those of the regional annual maximum and minimum `tas` data. Subsequently, in Section 5, we adopt the best performing information criteria from the study, for model selection using the CMIP6 climate `tas` data.

4. Simulation study to examine the predictive performance of different model selection criteria

As discussed in Section 3.3, there is no reason to expect that different model selection criteria will choose the same models complexities (defined in Section 3) for scenario-coupled GEV regression for a given application. For example, as can be seen from Table 3, BIC penalises model complexity relatively severely, and might therefore be expected to produce more parsimonious models, possibly advantageous in the context of extreme value modelling.

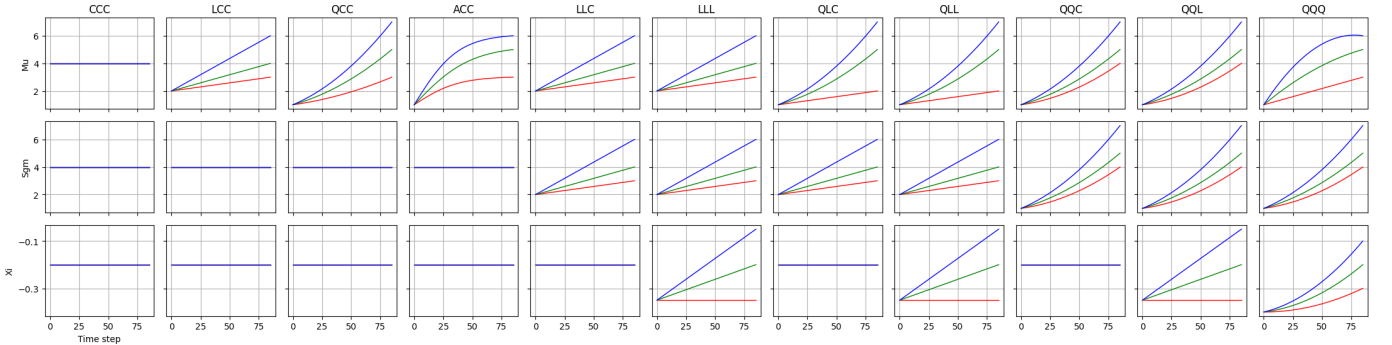


Figure 4: Simulation study design. Variation of GEV location (μ ; top), scale (σ ; middle) and shape (ξ ; bottom) in time for three scenarios (red, green and blue), for each of 11 data-generating processes (CCC to QQQ; columns left to right).

We perform a simulation study using the 11 data generating processes visualised in Figure 4, one for each of the 11 model complexities listed in Section 3.1. The figure shows variation of GEV location, scale and shape parameters for three “scenarios” shown in red, green and blue; these choices of parameter variation were informed by inspection and initial analysis of the CMIP6 regional annual maximum and minimum data. We do not claim that the 11 examples used are representative of all possible non-stationary GEV processes, but they do reasonably reflect the characteristics of the CMIP6 data. We generate $n_R = 100$ sample realisations D_k , $k = 1, 2, \dots, 100$ from each of the 11 processes, each sample consisting of 86 “yearly” observations for each of three scenarios. We then fit all 11 model forms, ranging from CCC (i.e. constant GEV location, scale and shape in time) to QQQ (i.e. quadratic variation of GEV location, scale and shape in time) to each sample using MCMC, obtaining a chain of parameter estimates from the joint posterior distribution $f(\theta|D)$ (see Section 3.2). Then, for each combination of data-generating process and fitted model, we evaluate the root mean square error

$$\text{RMSE} = \left(\frac{1}{3n_R n_S} \sum_{j=1}^3 \sum_{k=1}^{n_R} \sum_{s=1}^{n_S} (\Delta Q_j^* - \Delta Q_{j(s)}|D_k|)^2 \right)^{1/2} \quad (11)$$

in estimation of the difference ΔQ_j in return values over scenarios, $j = 1, 2, 3$, where ΔQ_j^* is the true value, and $\Delta Q_{j(s)}|D_k$ is posterior estimate of ΔQ_j corresponding to iteration s , $s = 1, 2, \dots, n_S$ from the MCMC chain for data realisation D_k , $k = 1, 2, \dots, n_R$.

Finally, we use each of the model selection information criteria in Table 3 to choose optimal model complexities, and corresponding estimates for RMSE; these are shown in Figure 5, as a function of data-generating process and model selection information criterion. From the figure, it is obvious that variants of AIC and BIC perform considerably better

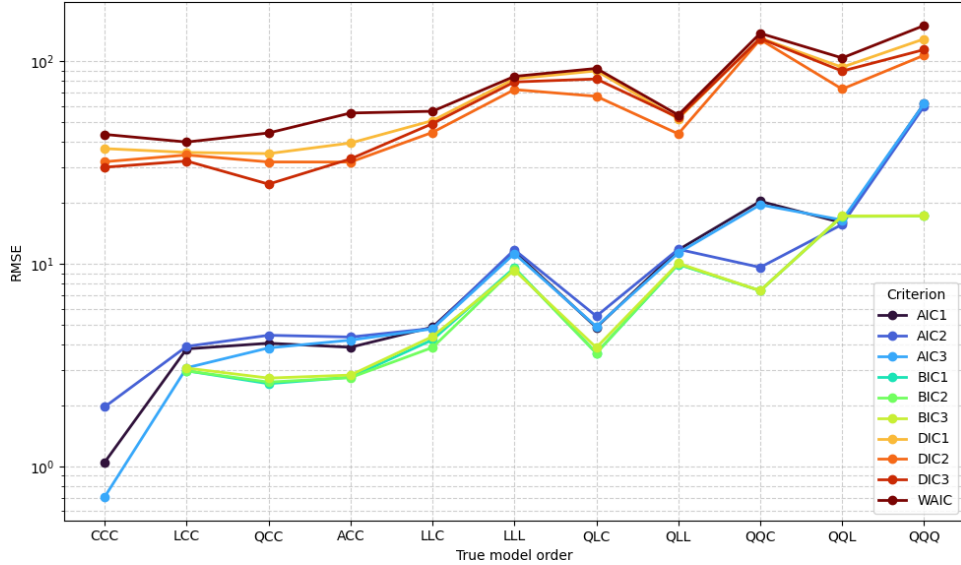


Figure 5: RMSE estimates (see Equation 11) from the simulation study, for different combinations of data-generating process (CCC to QQQ; x-axis) and model selection information criterion (AIC1 to WAIC; coloured lines). Note that for data-generating process CCC, all of BIC1, BIC2 and BIC3 always select the correct CCC model form, resulting in RMSE=0 (not shown on the $\log_{10}$ -scale y-axis.)

than DIC variants and WAIC, and that BIC performs somewhat better than AIC. Moreover, there is little difference between the “within-class” performance of variants of AIC, of BIC, or of DIC. In hindsight, the poor performance of DIC and WAIC is probably to be expected (see e.g. the discussion of Section 7.3 of Gelman et al. 2014, and Section SM1.1). Given these results, we adopt one variant of BIC (BIC3) and one of AIC (AIC3) for model selection applied to the CMIP6 data in Section 5, noting that we could have adopted any of the BIC and AIC variants without loss of generality.

5. Results

In this section, we apply the GEV regression methodology from Section 3 and optimal model selection criteria BIC3 and AIC3 from Section 4 to estimate changes in 100-year return values over the period (2025,2125) for samples of regional annual maxima and minima of **tas**, for different choices of desert region, GCM and climate ensemble. Results for regional annual maxima are summarised in Section 5.1 and Section SM4, and for regional annual minima in Section 5.2 and Section SM5. We address both the estimation of change in return value due to climate forcing, but also the problem of model selection for applied extreme value analysis using GEV regression on small samples.

5.1. Regional annual maxima

A typical result for GEV regression for regional annual maxima, for a specific choice of region and GCM and all climate ensembles, is visualised in Figure 6 (for the Sahara region using the UKESM1-0-LL GCM). Results for all 30 combinations of region and GCM are summarised using the same template in Figures SM2-SM31. The top left panel shows variation of values of information criteria (BIC3 and AIC3; different line styles) for fitting of models of different complexity (CCC to QQQ; x-axis), using data for each of the available climate ensembles (line colours). The optimal model selected is indicated by a red circle (BIC3) and blue cross (AIC3). The other three panels summarise the posterior distribution of the difference ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ in 100-year return value over the period (2025,2125) (see Equation 6) as a function of fitted model and climate ensemble, under climate scenarios SSP126 ($j = 1$, top right), SSP245 ($j = 2$, bottom left) and SSP585 ($j = 3$, bottom right). For the Sahara region using the UKESM1-0-LL GCM, the top left panel indicates that BIC3 prefers QCC models, with quadratic variation of GEV location in time, but stationary GEV scale and shape. AIC3 tends to prefer somewhat more complex models. The remaining panels show

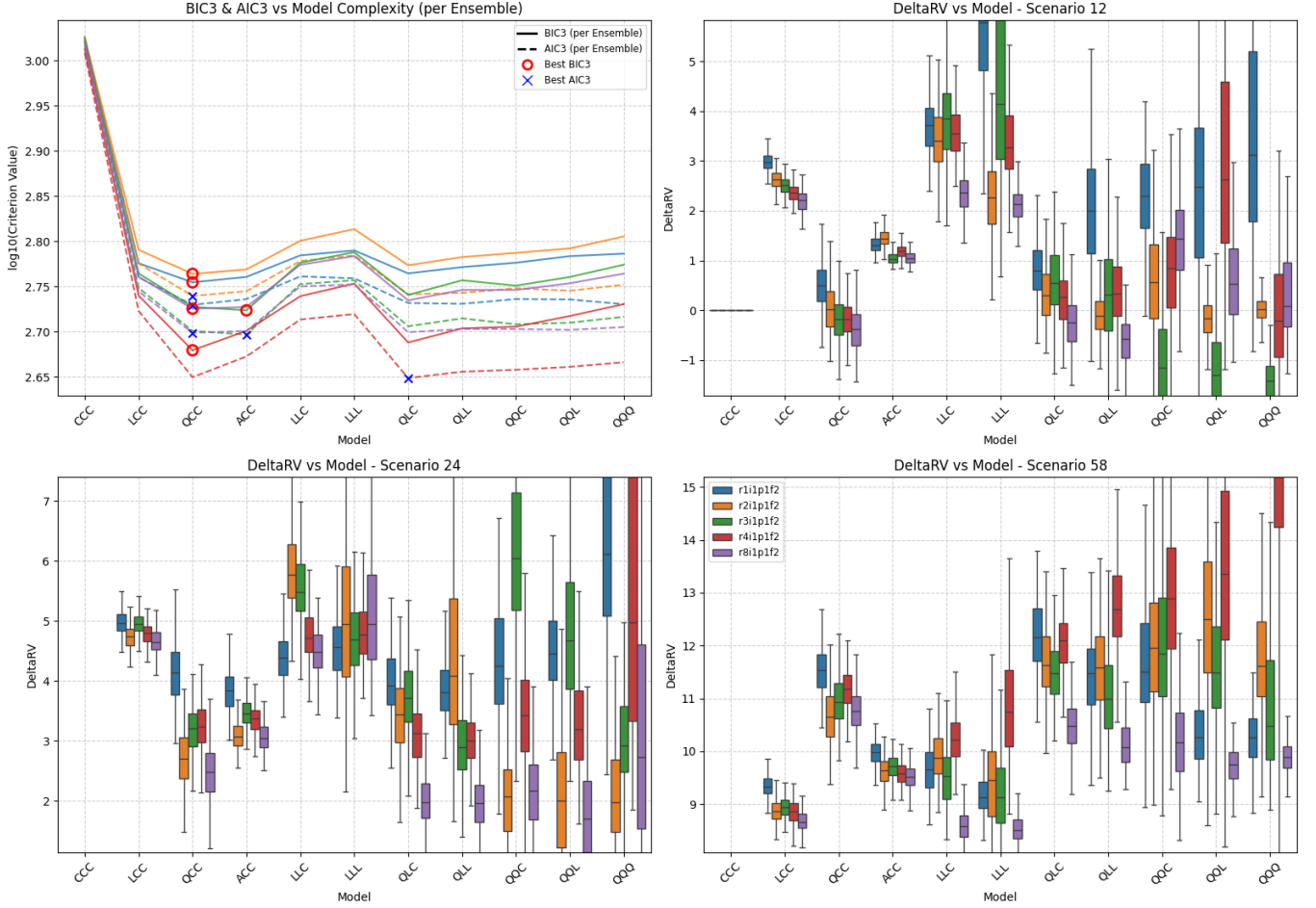


Figure 6: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Sahara region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 6) for climate scenario **SSP126** as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios **SSP245** (ΔQ_2) and **SSP585** (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models.

that the uncertainty in ΔQ increases with fitted model complexity, as does between-ensemble variability. For the BIC3-optimal QCC model fits, there is general agreement across climate ensembles: approximately no change in ΔQ under scenario **SSP126**, but changes of around 3K and 11K under **SSP245** and **SSP585**. Clearly, the choice of fitted model has a large effect on our estimate of ΔQ . The general features of results for other combinations of region and GCM (in Figures SM2-SM31) are similar: BIC3 tends to select more parsimonious models, with LCC the most frequent choice (see Section 6.3).

Figure 7 summarises inferences for ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ of regional annual maxima using the BIC3-optimal GEV regression models, aggregated over climate ensembles, as a function of region and GCM. Aggregation is achieved by simply combining the samples of posterior estimates for ΔQ corresponding to different ensembles into one aggregate sample. The figure indicates general agreement across GCM and region, with somewhat larger increases in ΔQ in Dasht-e Lut, Sahara and Simpson, and lowest in the Antarctic. The UK control region does not look unusual alongside the “hot” desert regions. Corresponding estimates per climate ensemble are given in Figure SM32, showing good general agreement across ensembles. The corresponding summaries for AIC3-optimal models is shown in Figures SM33-SM34. An overall summary for regional annual maxima is presented in Figure 8, where the estimated posterior distribution of

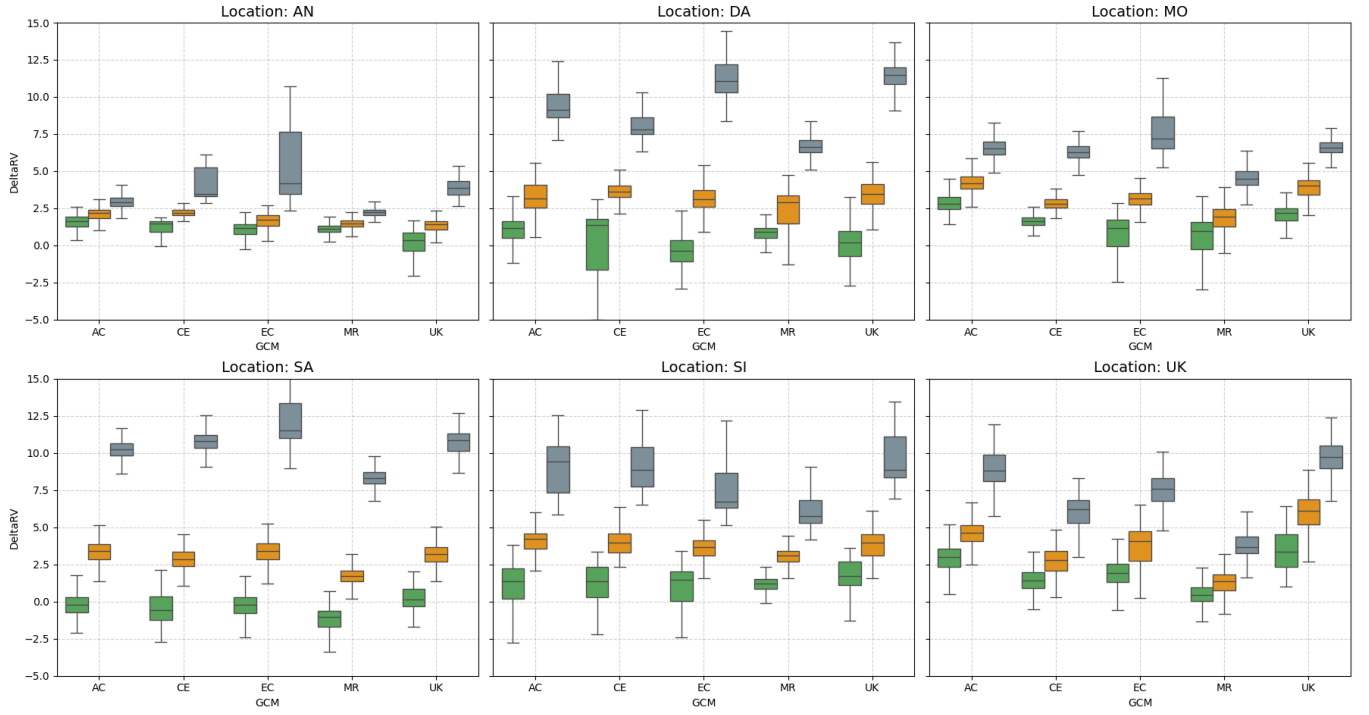


Figure 7: Summary of inferences for return value differences ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 6) of regional annual maxima using BIC3 for model selection, aggregated over climate ensemble. Each panel shows box-whisker plots summarising the posterior distribution of ΔQ for climate scenarios SSP126 ($j = 1$, green), SSP245 ($j = 2$, orange) and SSP585 ($j = 3$, grey) and each of five GCMs (ACCESS-CM2, CESM2, EC-Earth3, MRI-ESM2-0, UKESM1-0-LL). Left to right, top to bottom, panels show inferences for the Antarctic, Dasht-e Lut, Mojave, Sahara, Simpson and UK regions.

ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ using BIC3 for model selection is aggregated over both climate ensemble and GCM. The corresponding summary for AIC3 model selection is given in Figure SM35. It is noteworthy that the 95% credible intervals for ΔQ

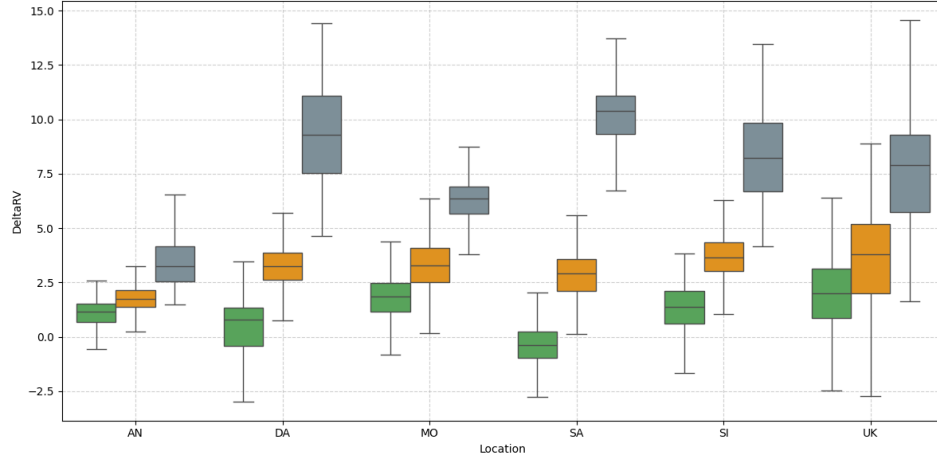


Figure 8: Summary of inferences for return value differences ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 7) of regional annual maxima using BIC3 for model selection, aggregated over climate ensemble and GCM. Box-whisker plots summarise the posterior distribution of ΔQ for climate scenarios SSP126 ($j = 1$, green), SSP245 ($j = 2$, orange) and SSP585 ($j = 3$, grey) for the Antarctic, Dasht-e Lut, Mojave, Sahara, Simpson and UK regions.

under scenario SSP126 include zero (i.e. no change), whereas they do not under SSP245 and SSP585, suggesting *significant* increases in the 100-year return value for **tas** over the next 100 years under the latter scenarios.

5.2. Regional annual minima

Inferences for regional annual minima are presented using the same template used for maxima. Results for all 30 combinations of region and GCM are summarised Figures SM36-SM65. The general characteristics of the figures are similar to those for regional annual maxima. The 100-year return value for $\mathbf{tas}$ typically increases in time, but sometimes there is no obvious trend. The extent of any change observed is less marked. For example, for the Sahara and UKESM1-0-LL GCM in Figure SM55, BIC3 chooses LCC (rather than QCC), with typical changes of 2K, 4K and 7K under SSP126, SSP245 and SSP585. These differences reflect those visible in Figure 2.

Figure 9 summarises inferences for ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ of regional annual minima using the BIC3-optimal GEV regression models, aggregated over climate ensembles, as a function of region and GCM; estimates per climate ensemble are given in Figure SM66. The corresponding summaries for AIC3-optimal models is shown in Figures SM67-SM68. There

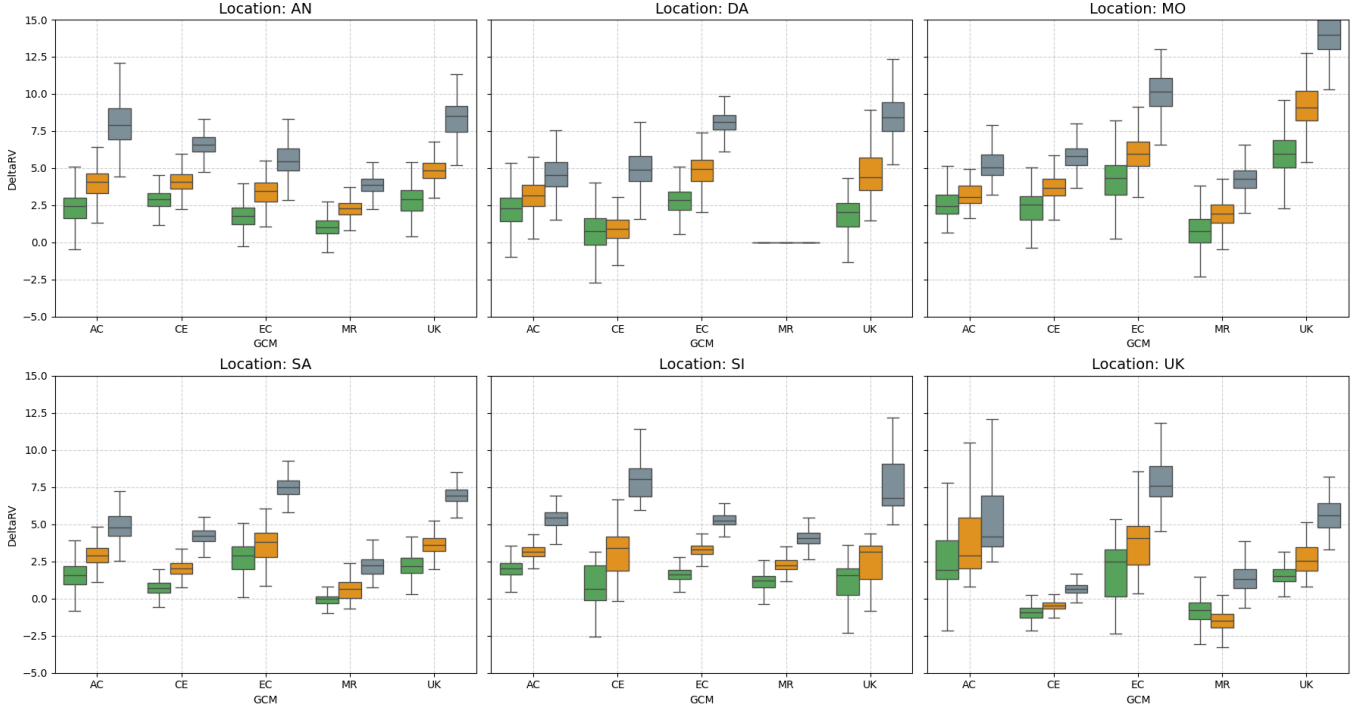


Figure 9: Summary of inferences for return value differences ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 6) of regional annual minima using BIC3 for model selection, aggregated over climate ensemble. For details, see Figure 7.

is in general reasonable between-ensemble agreement (e.g. Figure SM66), but poorer agreement between GCMs; for example, MRI-ESM2-0 yields CCC models for Dasht-e Lut, resulting in $\Delta Q = 0$ under all scenarios. Results for the Antarctic are similar to those for “hot” regions. The overall summary for regional annual minima in Figure 10 gives estimates for the posterior distribution of ΔQ using BIC3 for model selection aggregated over both climate ensemble and GCM. It can be seen that many of the 95% credible intervals include zero, even under SSP245 and SSP585 scenarios, indicating less confidence in the increasing trend observed. The corresponding summary for AIC3 model selection is given in Figure SM69.

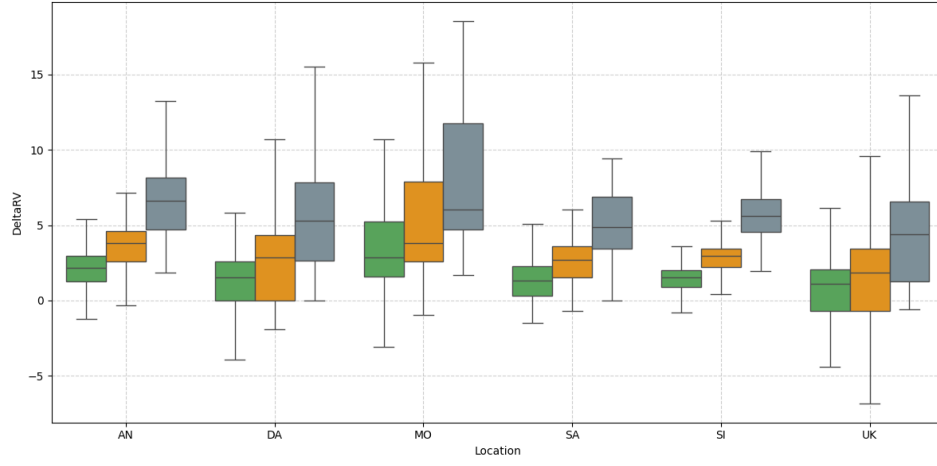


Figure 10: Summary of inferences for return value differences ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 7) of regional annual minima using BIC3 for model selection, aggregated over climate ensemble and GCM. For details, see Figure 8.

6. Discussion and conclusions

The current work estimates the change in the value of the 100-year return value ΔQ for near-surface atmospheric temperature **tas** over the period (2025,2125), and its variability, using climate model output for different coupled climate models, climate scenarios and model ensemble runs for the 86 year period (2015,2100). The temperature data considered are annual spatial maxima and minima for five desert regions of different surface areas and climatic conditions; we also examine annual extrema for the neighbourhood of the United Kingdom as a control region. Model fitting for each data set is performed using non-stationary generalised extreme value (GEV) regression models, the parameters μ, σ, ξ of which are assumed to exhibit parametric variation with time. Models for different scenarios are coupled to ensure common GEV parameters for the first year, and parameters are estimated using Bayesian inference. Models for μ, σ, ξ in time with different complexities are considered and their performance quantified and compared using variants of the Bayesian and Akaike information criteria. These specific choices of criteria were found to be optimal in terms of minimising the root mean square error of predictions of ΔQ in a simulation study. We believe the work provides a number of interesting physical and statistical insights.

6.1. Are extreme regional annual maxima increasing in size more quickly?

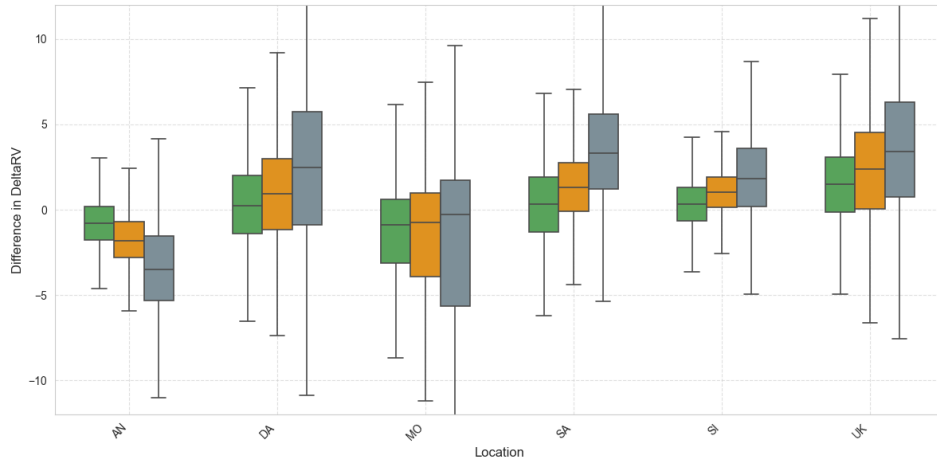


Figure 11: Summary of inferences for the difference $\Delta\Delta Q_j$, $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 12) between ΔQ values of regional annual maxima and minima. BIC3 was used for model selection, and posterior distributions aggregated over climate ensemble and GCM. For other details, see Figure 8.

The distributions of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 6) for regional annual maxima and minima are given in Figures 8 and 10 respectively. It is apparent that there is in general an upward trend for both maxima and minima across desert

and UK control regions, but that the extent of increase of regional annual maxima is in general greater. To quantify this, Figure 11 shows the differences $\Delta\Delta Q_j$, $j = 1, 2, 3$ for each combination of climate scenario and region, aggregated over climate ensemble and GCM.

$$\Delta\Delta Q_j = \Delta Q_j^{\max} - \Delta Q_j^{\min} \quad (12)$$

where $\Delta Q_j^{\max}$ and $\Delta Q_j^{\min}$ refer to ΔQ_j for regional annual maxima and minima respectively, $j = 1, 2, 3$. 95% credible intervals in Figure 11 include zero in every case, suggesting that there are no strong trends in $\Delta\Delta Q$. Nevertheless, it is interesting, for all regions except for Antarctic, that there is a mild increasing trend in median $\Delta\Delta Q$ with increased forcing, suggesting that extreme quantiles of regional annual maxima are increasing (i.e. warming) at a greater rate than those of minima, and that this difference increases with climate forcing. The Antarctic shows the opposite trend: under scenario SSP585 in particular, the value of median $\Delta\Delta Q_3$ is around -3K: extremes of regional annual minima of **tas** are warming faster than those of regional annual maxima. The corresponding result for AIC3 model selection is given in Figure SM70.

6.2. Locations of regional annual maxima and minima in time

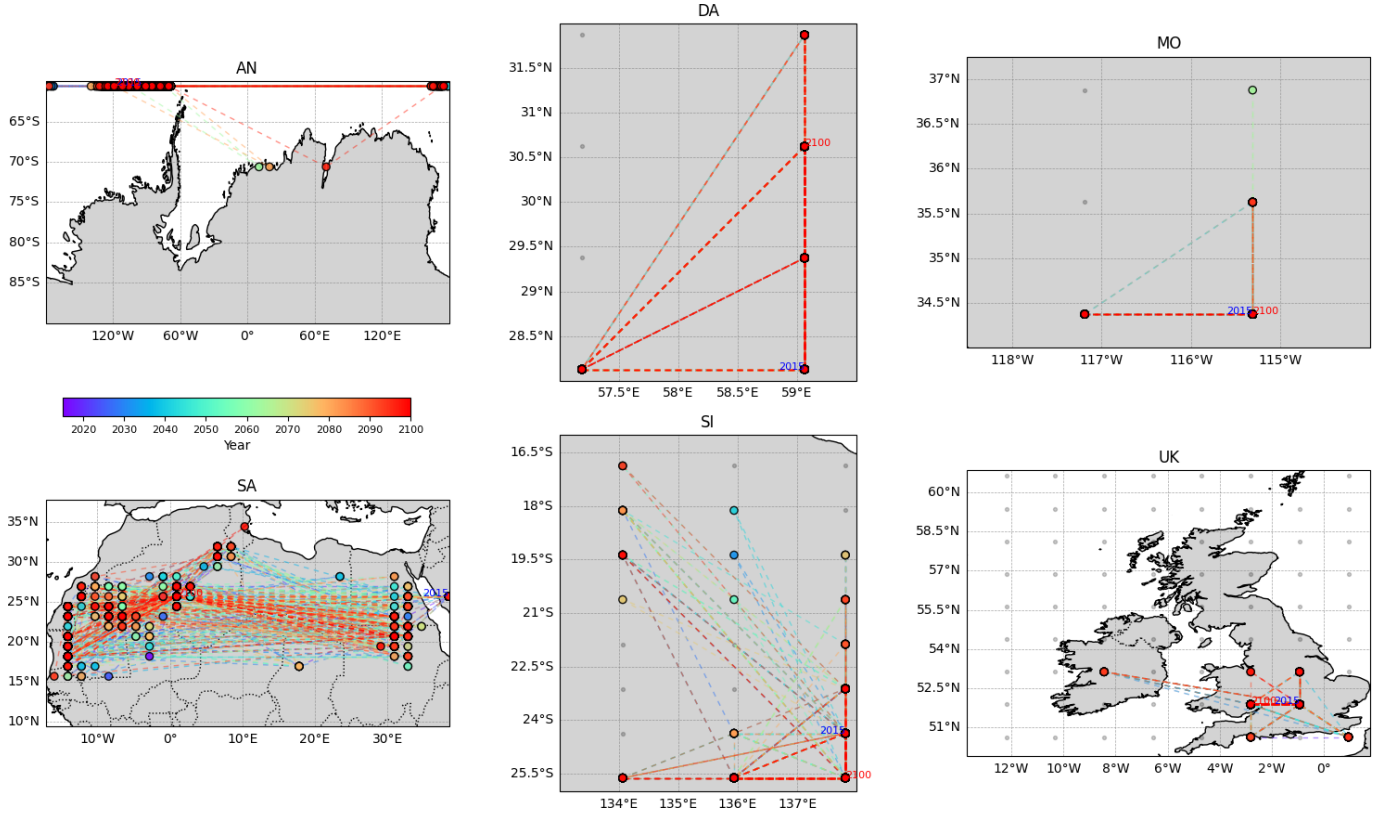


Figure 12: Locations of regional annual maxima (coloured discs) per region (panels) over time for the period (2015,2100) from the UKESM1-0-LL GCM. Lines connect discs corresponding to adjacent years; disc and line colours indicate the year; grey dots indicate GCM grid locations for Dasht-e Lut (DA), Mojave (MO), Simpson (SI) and UK (UK), suppressed for Antarctic (AN) and Sahara (SA).

We have considered annual maxima and minima of **tas** over different spatial domains. It is interesting to also consider whether there are spatial trends in the locations of regional maxima and minima in time for each region. Figure 12 shows the evolution of the location of regional annual maximum in time for the UKESM1-0-LL GCM, with the “time trajectory” reverse-rainbow coloured from blue to red. For example, for the Sahara region, annual maxima tend to cluster in the dune seas south of the Atlas Mountains ($\approx 10^\circ\text{W}, 10^\circ\text{E}$) and to the west of the Red Sea Hills ($\approx 30^\circ\text{E}$). For the Antarctic, regional annual maxima generally occur at the northernmost grid locations within the bounding box. Corresponding plots for regional annual minima are given in Figure SM71, and show obvious differences. For example, for the Antarctic, minima tend to occur around Dome Argus ($\approx 75^\circ\text{E}$). For the Sahara, annual minima tend to occur in two clusters, each at $\approx 32^\circ\text{N}$, in the Atlas Mountains ($\approx 0^\circ$) and the Nafud desert, the Syrian Desert Highlands and the Southeastern Taurus Mountains ($\approx 40^\circ\text{E}$). Differences between the spatial locations of regional annual maxima and minima are clear for the Dasht-e Lut, Mojave, Simpson and UK regions. For comparison, Figures SM72-SM73 present

analogous results for the EC-Earth3 GCM, showing similar gross features. The presence of systematic spatial trends in the locations of extremes suggests, at least in principle, an opportunity for more sophisticated spatial modelling. However, there are no obvious trends in time in the locations of regional extrema.

6.3. Distribution of complexity of fitted models

Numerous model selections are performed in the current analysis. The complexity of optimal model selections over all combinations of region, maximum or minimum, GCM and climate ensemble provides a general indication of the information content of the time series data. For example, the histograms in Figure 13 indicate the frequency with which each of the 11 candidate model complexities is chosen, in application to regional annual maxima (left hand side) and minima, over all combinations of region, GCM and climate ensemble, using BIC3 for model selection. Comparison

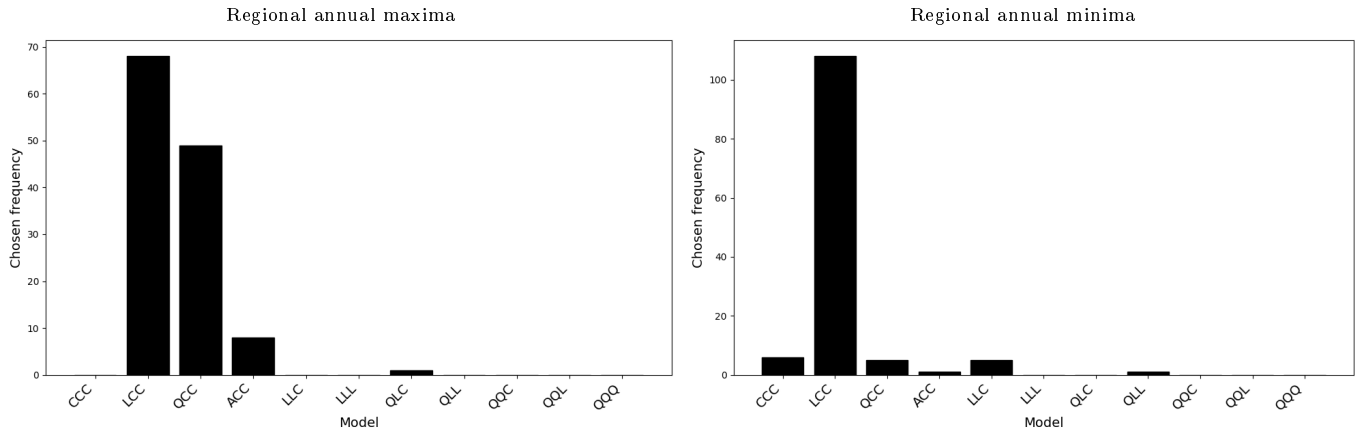


Figure 13: Complexities of optimal fitted models for regional annual maxima (left) and minima (right) using BIC3 for model selection.

of the left and right hand sides of the figure show that more complex models can be justified for regional annual maxima. However, in general, selected models tend to incorporate non-stationarity in the GEV location parameter μ only, and very rarely in GEV scale σ and shape ξ . For regional annual maxima, models QCC and ACC together account for almost half the selected model forms. For comparison, Figure SM74 shows the corresponding histograms for model selection using AIC3. Relative to BIC3, model selection using AIC3 results in more complex model forms; regardless, models stationary with respect to σ and ξ are more prevalent.

6.4. An initial comparison with Bayesian model averaging

The current work has focussed on model selection from a set of 11 candidate models CCC to QQQ with different complexities. An alternative approach, avoiding selection of a single optimal model complexity for prediction of ΔQ , is to estimate a weighted sum of all candidates which has good predictive performance for ΔQ . Here, we provide an initial comparison of our model selection procedure with Bayesian model averaging (BMA).

In BMA, we take a linear combination of posterior predictive densities for ΔQ from each of $n_M = 11$ candidate models $\{CCC, LCC, \dots, QQQ\} = \{M_1, M_2, \dots, M_{11}\}$ in order for convenience. Specifically, for the 3-vector $q = [\Delta Q_1, \Delta Q_2, \Delta Q_3]$, we estimate the average predictive posterior density for q as

$$f_S(q|D) = \sum_{m=1}^{n_M} w_m f(q|M_m, D) \quad (13)$$

where $f(q|M_m, D)$ is the posterior predictive density for q estimated from data D using model M_m , $m = 1, 2, \dots, n_M$. We estimate the set of weights $\{w_m\}$ using the stacking procedure of Yao et al. (2018) outlined in Section SM9.

We compare the performance of Bayesian model averaging to model selection using BIC3, in application to the estimation of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ using the simulation study data from Section 4, and the CMIP6 climate data for the Sahara region and UKESM1-0-LL GCM. Table 4 summarises the distribution of selected model complexities in BIC3-based model selection for different data-generating models. Specifically, the same $n_R = 100$ realisations of each of the 11 data-generating models CCC to QQQ, reported in the simulation study of Section 4, were re-used. Each of the n_M candidate models CCC to QQQ is fitted in turn, and BIC3 used to select the optimal fitted model. Columns 3-13 of the table report the proportion of fitted models of different complexities, for each complexity of data-generating model: thus, for an LLL data-generating model, the LLC fitted model was selected by BIC3 for 93 of the 100 sample

		Data-generating model ($n_R = 100$ realisations)											CMIP6 data	
		CCC	LCC	QCC	ACC	LLC	LLL	QLC	QLL	QQC	QQL	QQQ	LCC	SA-UK
		Proportions of fitted models selected using BIC3											BMA weights w_m , $m = 1, 2, \dots, 11$	
Fitted model	CCC	1.00	0.68	0.10	0.18	0.05							0.14 (0.00,0.59)	0.00
	LCC		0.31	0.90	0.78	0.01		0.02					0.40 (0.00,1.00)	0.00
	QCC				0.03								0.00 (0.00,0.79)	0.21
	ACC				0.02								0.18 (0.00,0.91)	0.42
	LLC		0.01			0.94	0.93	0.98	0.97	0.99	0.84	0.94	0.07 (0.00,0.74)	0.00
	LLL						0.07				0.13	0.06	0.04 (0.00,0.46)	0.00
	QLC									0.01	0.03		0.01 (0.00,0.21)	0.25
	QLL												0.01 (0.00,0.00)	0.09
	QQC												0.01 (0.00,0.12)	0.00
	QQL												0.01 (0.00,0.12)	0.00
	QQQ												0.03 (0.00,0.36)	0.02
RMSE		0.00	3.06	2.82	2.73	4.38	9.30	3.86	10.1	7.38	17.3	17.3	3.98	-

Table 4: Assessment of fitted models: (a) Columns 3-13 give the proportions of optimal selected models (from the 11 candidates CCC to QQQ; rows) using the BIC3 information criterion, corresponding to each of $n_R = 100$ sample realisations from data-generating models with different complexities (CCC to QQQ; columns); (b) Column 14 gives the correspond average BMA weights per fitted model, again estimated using $n_R = 100$ sample realisations, with marginal 95% uncertainty bands; (c) Column 15 gives BMA weights, averaged over climate ensembles, for the CMIP6 sample data of regional annual maxima for the Sahara from the UKESM1-0-LL GCM. Values are rounded to two decimal places, and zero values of proportions are not shown to aid interpretation. (Note the curious BMA weight estimate for model QLL, arising because values for all but one realisation are zero to two decimal places.)

realisations, and LLL for the remaining 7 realisations. It can be seen that realisations of stationary samples (CCC) always result in selection of stationary (CCC) fitted models. When sample realisations include non-stationary variation (i.e. either linear, L or quadratic, Q) of GEV location μ or scale σ , this typically results in the selection of a fitted model with *linear* variation (L) in the corresponding parameter. Fitted models incorporating variation in GEV shape ξ are rarely selected, regardless of the data-generating process. Hence, the optimal fitted model complexity corresponding to all the data-generating models LLL to QQQ is LLC. The fact that fitted models with quadratic (Q) variation in μ and σ , and any non-stationary (i.e. L or Q) with respect to ξ , tend *not* to be fitted, is attributed to the small sample sizes (86 years $\times$ three scenarios) in the current work. It is interesting that the typical literature presumption for parametric GEV regression applied to annual maxima of **tas** in time is linear variation in μ and σ , and stationary ξ . We would expect, were larger samples used, that more complex selected models would occur.

The table also gives optimal BMA weights w_m , $m = 1, 2, \dots, n_M$ estimated from the stacking procedure (Equation 13, Yao et al. 2018 and Section SM9) from $n_R = 100$ realisations of the LCC data-generating model only. The penultimate column of the table gives the average weight (over realisations) attributed to each fitted model complexity, together with empirical marginal 95% uncertainty bands for each weight. It is intuitively reassuring that the largest weights correspond to the LCC and ACC fits. The estimated RMSE over the n_R sample realisations for BIC3-selected models is 3.06, calculated using Equation 11; the corresponding estimate for Bayesian model averaging is 3.98, calculated using Equation SM8. Finally, the table gives BMA weights (averaged over the 5 climate ensembles) for the CMIP6 data corresponding to annual maxima from the Sahara region and the UKESM1-0-LL GCM, noting from Figure 6 that BIC3 selects the QCC model for these data. The largest weights are seen to correspond to the ACC, QLC and QCC models. It appears from these preliminary results that the stacking BMA approach favours somewhat more complex models than BIC3, perhaps more like AIC3, resulting in poorer performance in estimating ΔQ . The authors plan a further study to examine the performance the stacking BMA method thoroughly.

6.5. Conclusions

When competing models of different complexity are considered in non-stationary extreme value modelling using small samples, care must be taken in model selection. The relative performance of different “information criteria” (including AIC, BIC, DIC and WAIC) for model selection with respect to a specific prediction task cannot be easily anticipated. We recommend that a simulation study is undertaken, using relevant data, to identify which information criteria perform best for the prediction task. For the current work, focussing on predicting the difference ΔQ in the 100-year return value over the period (2015,2125), of regional annual maxima and minima of **tas** using Bayesian inference, we find that the Bayesian information criterion (BIC) provides optimal predictive performance. We also demonstrate that Bayesian model averaging provides a feasible alternative to model selection, but - using the stacking approach considered here - at considerably increased computational cost.

Using optimal model selection, for regional annual maxima and minima of **tas** in desert regions (and UK “control” region), there is general consistency across inferences for ΔQ from different climate scenarios, for a given combination

of region and GCM. There is further general consistency across GCMs for a given region. The general pattern is of ΔQ increasing with climate forcing, and that higher increases are seen in the Dasht-e Lut, Sahara, Simpson and UK regions under the SSP585 scenario. Using inferences aggregated over GCM and climate ensemble, there is evidence for significant increases in ΔQ for regional annual maxima under scenarios SSP245 and SSP585 for all desert regions. Trends for regional annual minima are generally similar, but evidence is weaker. For the Antarctic region, the estimated median difference between ΔQ for annual maxima and minima decreases with increasing forcing, suggesting that 100-year return values of annual minima are increasing more quickly than those for annual maxima.

Acknowledgements

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Supplementary Material

Changes in extreme temperatures of the Earth's desert regions over the next 100 years

Callum Leach, Kevin Ewans, Philip Jonathan

Overview

This supplementary material provides supporting information for the article referenced above.

Section SM1 provides further discussion of the literature on information criteria (such as AIC, BIC, DIC and WAIC), and non-stationary parametric GEV regression, to complement Section 1.

Section SM2 provides illustrations of regional annual minima time series for comparison with Figure 3.

Section SM3 provides a brief outline of the MCMC scheme for model parameter estimation, discussed in Section 3.2.

Section SM4 provides visual summaries of model fits for regional annual maxima (to be compared with Figure 6), and box-whisker plots of differences in return values ΔQ (to be compared with Figures 7-8).

Section SM5 provides visual summaries of model fits for regional annual minima (to be compared with corresponding figures for regional annual maxima in Figure 6 and Section SM4), and box-whisker plots of differences in return values for regional annual minima (to be compared with Figures 7-8).

Section SM6 gives box-whisker plots of $\Delta Q(\text{for maxima}) - \Delta Q(\text{for minima})$, comparing ΔQ for regional annual maxima and minima.

Section SM7 investigates the spatial distribution of regional annual maxima and minima (to be compared with Figure 12)

Section SM8 illustrates the distribution of complexity of fitted models (to be compared with Figure 13)

Section SM9 provides some background to the Bayesian model averaging performed in Section 6.3.

SM1 Literature review

This section should be read in conjunction with Section 1 of the main text.

SM1.1 Information criteria

Zhang et al. (2023) gives a more recent review of the use of information criteria for statistical model selection, focussing on the Akaike Information Criterion (AIC, Akaike 1974) and the so-called Bayesian Information Criterion (BIC, Schwarz 1978). The authors note that in application, adoption of different information criteria can result in the selection of different “optimal” models, yet it is generally unclear which criterion should be favoured. They further note that the choice of the most appropriate information criterion is problem-dependent, influenced by one or more of the underlying data-generating process, the nature of the postulated model forms, sample size and model performance criterion. For a Bayesian inference generating a sample from the joint posterior distribution of estimated model parameters, the Divergence Information Criterion (DIC, Spiegelhalter et al. 2002, Gelman et al. 2004) and the Widely Applicable Information Criterion (WAIC, Watanabe 2013, Vehtari et al. 2017) are often used. In comparing AIC and BIC, Zhang et al. (2023) notes that AIC tends to select more complex models, but that it is not generally possible to foresee which of AIC or BIC would yield models with best out-of-sample predictive performance for a particular model selection problem. Indeed, the authors recommend performing a study involving direct quantification of out-of-sample predictive performance using cross-validation, to quantify the relative performance of different information criteria on problems of the relevant type, as a rational basis for selecting the most appropriate criterion for that problem type. This suggestion was adopted by us in the current work to assess which of a range of criteria based on AIC, BIC, DIC and WAIC yields best performance in a specific extreme value prediction problem involving relatively small samples of CMIP6 climate model output for **tas**, below. The earlier article of Gelman et al. (2014) arrives at a similar conclusion regarding predictive information criteria for Bayesian models, including AIC, BIC, DIC and WAIC. The authors state that none of AIC, BIC, DIC and WAIC performs well universally: that AIC is poor in settings with prior information, that DIC is poor when the posterior distribution is not well summarised by its mean, and that WAIC relies on data partition and cross-validation, themselves problematic procedures in the presence of dependence. The authors lean towards cross-validation as their favoured approach. Kim et al. (2017) describes a simulation study to assess the relative performance of AIC, the corrected AIC (Hurvich and Tsai 1989), BIC and the likelihood ratio test (LRT) in identifying underlying stationary and non-stationary models with differing characteristics, from samples of varying sizes. The authors note that AIC tends to perform better for small samples (sample size ≤ 40), whereas BIC and LRT performance is better for larger samples. The driver of this difference in performance is that AIC tends to select more complex models than BIC and LRT.

We note that many other information criteria for model selection have been proposed and are used, including minimum description length (MDL, Rissanen 1978; related to BIC), the risk inflation criterion (RIC, Foster and George 1994; with an even stronger model complexity penalty than BIC, used in high-dimensional settings), and the Hannan–Quinn Information Criterion (HQIC, Hannan and Quinn 1979; used in time series modelling).

SM1.2 GEV regression for extreme temperatures

In a non-stationary extreme value setting, generalised extreme value (GEV) regression is often used to relate variation of block maxima of some environmental variable with respect to covariates. In the current work, we apply parametric GEV regression to understand temporal changes in the distribution of annual maxima of **tas**. In related work, Kharin and Zwiers (2005) uses parametric GEV regression, with linear variation of all GEV parameters in time, to quantify non-stationarity of annual maxima of various temperature indices. The regression is estimated using L-moments and maximum likelihood, and bootstrapping employed to provide a quantification of uncertainty. The authors show that spatially-averaged parameter estimates for GEV shape and scale show little change in time, whereas increases in temperature extremes can be predominantly explained by increases in the GEV location parameter: that is, global changes in temperature extremes tend to be associated primarily with the overall shift of distribution of annual extremes towards a warmer mean climate, and with only relatively small changes in the actual shape of the extreme temperature distribution. Changes in the distribution of extreme precipitation are more intricate. Zwiers et al. (2011) also uses GEV regression, now with non-stationary GEV location only, to quantify the influence on long return period daily temperature extremes at regional scales. Kharin et al. (2013) again uses GEV regression to update the analysis of Kharin and Zwiers (2005) for CMIP5 model outputs, estimated using both L-moments and maximum likelihood. Now, GEV location and scale are assumed to vary linearly in time, but GEV shape assumed time-invariant. Kharin et al. (2018) is a further follow-up paper, comparing CMIP5 and CMIP6 return values. Li et al. (2021) examines annual extremes of daily temperature from CMIP6 models, by fitting stationary GEV

models independently to each interval of a partition of the time domain into consecutive blocks. This is done, since the authors claim that it is not possible to fit non-stationary GEV models reliably to time series of climate model output with short length; we hope that the current work demonstrates that this claim is generally not true. Abdelmoaty and Papalexiou (2023) use a mixture of model selection information criteria, including AIC, BIC and the Anderson-Darling statistic, to select models for extreme precipitation in CMIP6 projections. Models considered involve linear representations for GEV regression location and scale. No conclusions are made about the best choice of information criterion to use in their study; the output of all criteria are used for model selection, but details are not given.

SM1.3 Related literature

A number of software packages for R and other programming languages provide functionality for parametric and non-parametric GEV regression (see e.g. Belzile et al. 2023). Diop and Niang (2023) use a bootstrap procedure for variable selection in GEV regression. Phatak et al. (2010) adopt a variable selection approach first proposed by Kiiveri (2008), incorporating a prior specification favouring sparse covariate descriptions, to characterise the covariate dependence of the location parameter in a GEV regression. Faulkner et al. (2024) use BIC to select physical covariates in non-stationary extreme value models of flood frequency in England and Wales. They note however that AIC may be a useful information criterion when taking a “more nuanced view of model selection”. The python software developed for the scenario-coupled parametric GEV regression analysis is available via GitHub (at Leach and Jonathan 2026).

In a semi-parametric GEV regression setting, Nasri et al. (2013) report a B-spline model for extreme U.S. rainfall. Gardini (2023) proposes the use of Bayesian P-splines to characterise the non-linear effects of covariates on GEV parameters for samples of annual maxima of river discharge. Choice of functional form for covariate dependence is achieved using a grouped horseshoe prior to encourage shrinkage of non-relevant covariates. Richards and Huser (2026) model spatio-temporal extremes of wildfires using neural networks. In the related field of non-stationary peaks over threshold modelling, there are numerous examples of non-stationary non-parametric generalised Pareto regression in the environmental and engineering literature (see e.g. Jones et al. 2016, Randell et al. 2016). More generally, Lee et al. (2015) propose the use of Bayesian measures of surprise to determine suitable thresholds for extreme value models. These quantify the level of support for the proposed extremal model and threshold, without the need to specify any model alternatives, and allow direct comparison of competing threshold candidates with different numbers of threshold exceedances. Matear and Reddy (2025) describes a tool for sample size determination in stationary GEV fitting for climate applications, to ensure that estimates of extreme quantiles are obtained with the required precision.

A number of authors have explored different aspects of Bayesian inference in a parametric GEV regression setting. For example, Friederichs and Thorarinsdottir (2012) use the method of Hoff (2009) for Bayesian covariate selection in GEV regression. Castillo-Mateo et al. (2023) note that covariate selection in GEV regression is generally challenging, and use stochastic search variable selection for the selection of atmospheric covariates in modelling annual maximum temperature series for locations in Spain using GEV regression. Auld et al. (2023) examine whether the concentration of atmospheric carbon dioxide explains variation in the distribution of annual maximum daily maximum temperature in Europe. Model selection is performed using a hold-out sample with respect to various scoring rules for probabilistic forecasts, and AIC. The authors find good agreement in optimal model choice (from five candidates, with different combinations of no trends or of linear trends in GEV location and scale) across the scoring rules and AIC. Piironen and Vehtari (2017) provides a comparison of Bayesian predictive methods for model selection.

SM2 Illustrations of regional annual maxima and minima time series

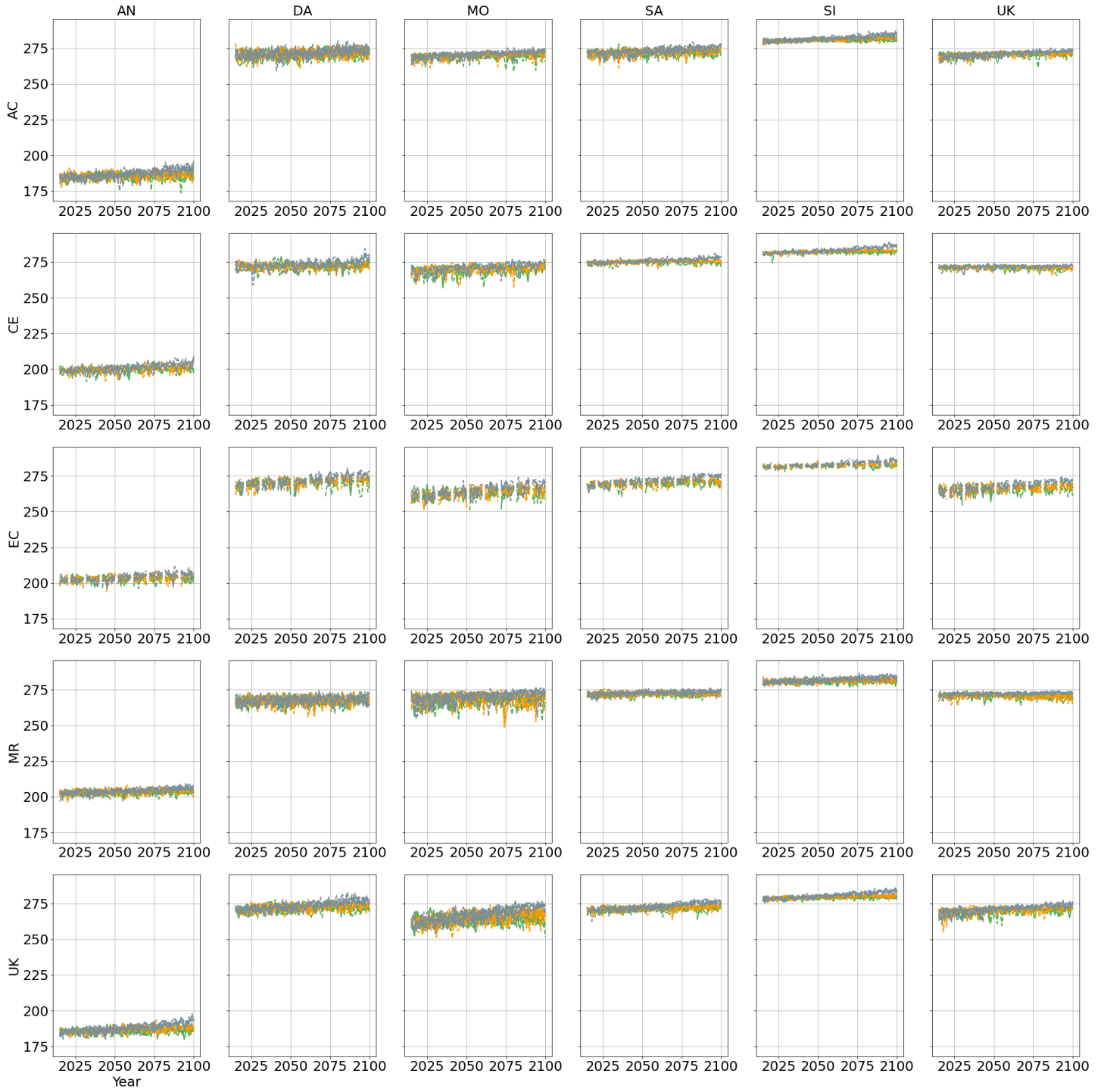


Figure SM1: Time series of regional annual minima of tas (K) by GCM (rows: ACCESS-CM2, CESM2, EC-Earth3, MRI-ESM2-0 and UKESM1-0-LL) and region (column: : Antarctic, Dasht-e Lut, Mojave, Sahara, Simpson and UK). In each panel, climate scenarios are distinguished by colour: SSP126 (green), SSP245 (orange), SSP245 (grey). Climate ensemble runs for each scenario are distinguished by line style. Corresponding spatial annual maxima time series are given in Figure 3 of the main text.

SM3 Bayesian inference

Inference for the GEV regression models described in Section 3.2 is performed using Markov chain Monte Carlo (MCMC, see e.g. Gamerman and Lopes 2006) following the method of Roberts and Rosenthal (2009). This procedure was reported previously in Ewans and Jonathan (2023), but is summarised here for completeness and ease of reference. All the parameters $\boldsymbol{\theta}$ of the model are jointly updated for a sequence of $n_B + n_S$ MCMC iterations. At each iteration, a new set of parameter values is proposed, and accepted according to the Metropolis-Hastings acceptance criterion based on (a) the sample likelihood evaluated at the current and candidate states, and (b) the values of the prior densities for parameters at the current and candidate states. Following n_B burn-in iterations, the Markov chain is judged to have converged, so that the subsequent n_S iterations provide a valid sample from the joint posterior distribution of parameters. Prior distributions were specified as follows: $\xi \sim U(-1, 0.2)$; $\sigma \sim U(0, \infty)$; $\mu \sim U(-\infty, \infty)$. Likelihoods for the models are available from the distributions given in the main text. An appropriate starting solution $\boldsymbol{\theta}_1$ for the MCMC inference was obtained by random sampling from the prior distributions of parameters, ensuring a valid likelihood.

For the first $n_S < n_B$ iterations, candidate parameter values $\boldsymbol{\theta}_k^c$ are proposed (independently) from $\boldsymbol{\theta}_k^c \sim N(\mathbf{0}, 0.1^2 \mathbf{I})$ following Roberts and Rosenthal (2009). Thereafter $\boldsymbol{\theta}_k^c \sim (1 - \beta)N(\boldsymbol{\theta}_{k-1}, 2.38^2 \Sigma_k) + \beta N(\boldsymbol{\theta}_{k-1}, 0.1^2/4)$, where $\beta = 0.05$, Σ_k is the empirical variance-covariance matrix of parameters from the past k iterations, and $\boldsymbol{\theta}_{k-1}$ is the current value of parameters. Throughout, a candidate state is accepted using the standard Metropolis-Hastings acceptance criterion. Since prior distributions for parameters are uniform, and proposals symmetric, this criterion is effectively just a likelihood ratio. That is, we accept the candidate state with probability $\min(1, L(\boldsymbol{\theta}^c)/L(\boldsymbol{\theta}))$, where $L(\boldsymbol{\theta})$ and $L(\boldsymbol{\theta}^c)$ are the likelihoods evaluated at the current and candidate states respectively, with candidates lying outside their prior domains rejected.

SM4 Results for regional annual maxima

Location: AN | GCM: AC | Agg: Mxm

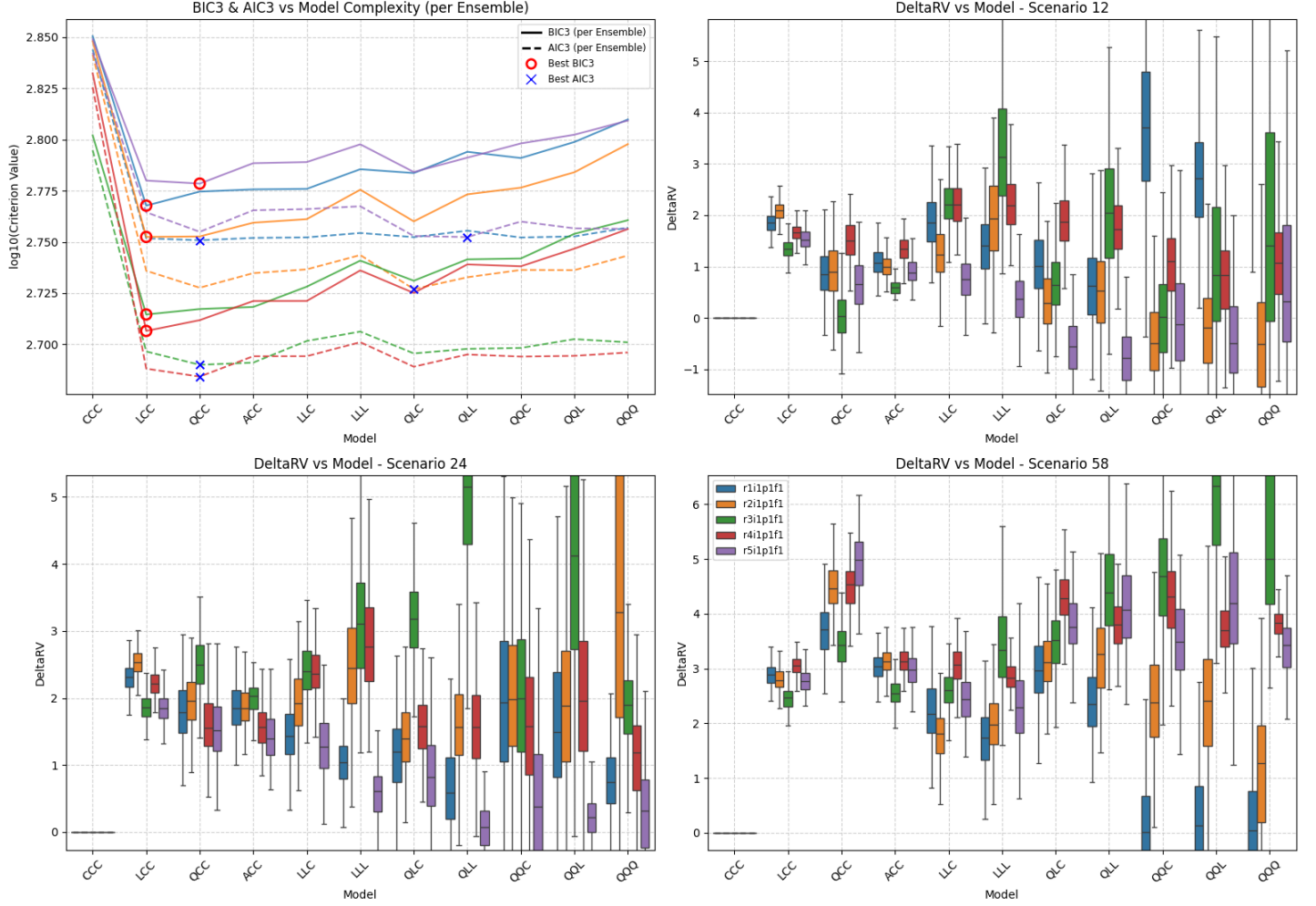


Figure SM2: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Antarctic region using ACCESS-CM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: AN | GCM: CE | Agg: Mxm

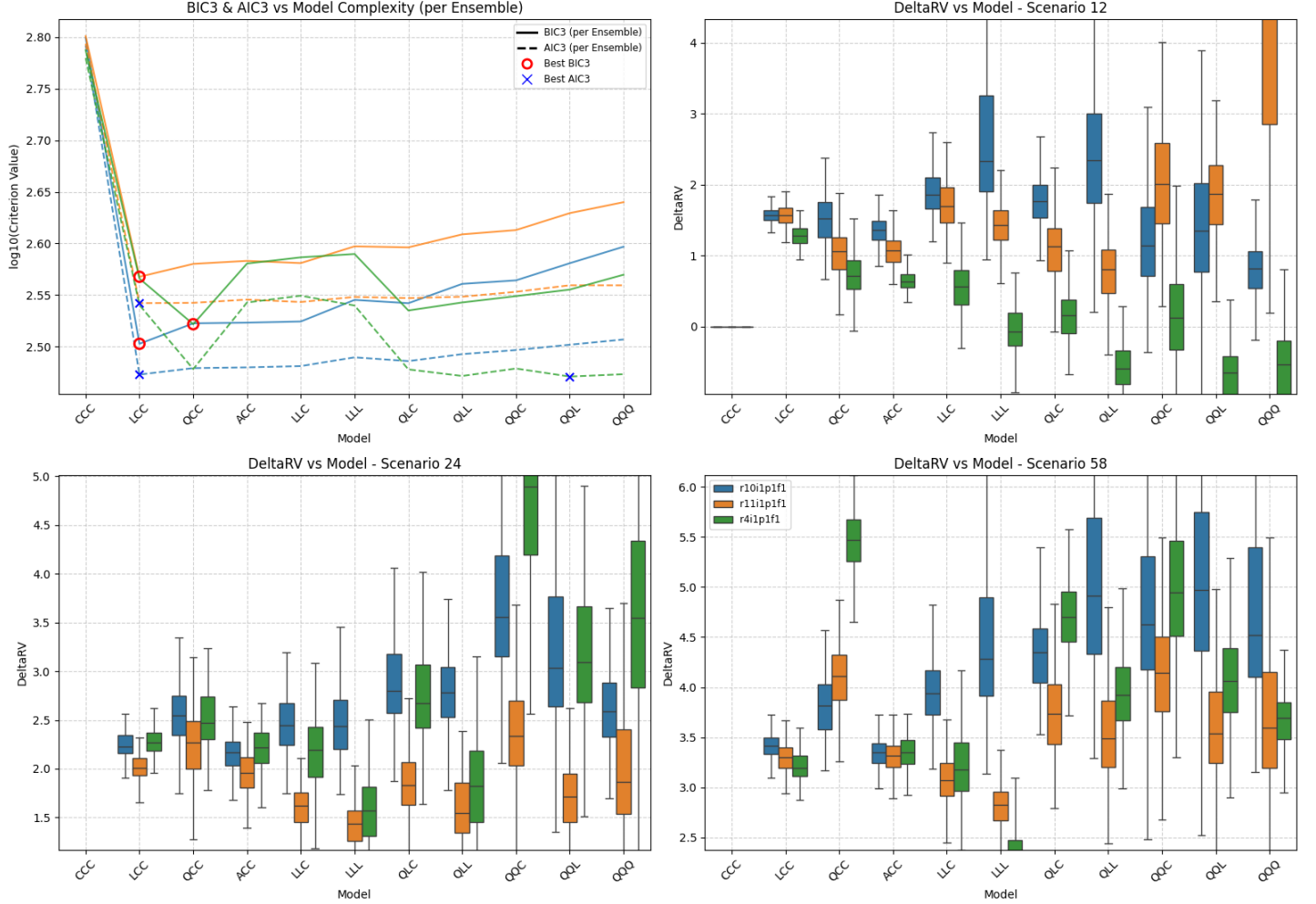


Figure SM3: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Antarctic region using CESM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: AN | GCM: EC | Agg: Mxm

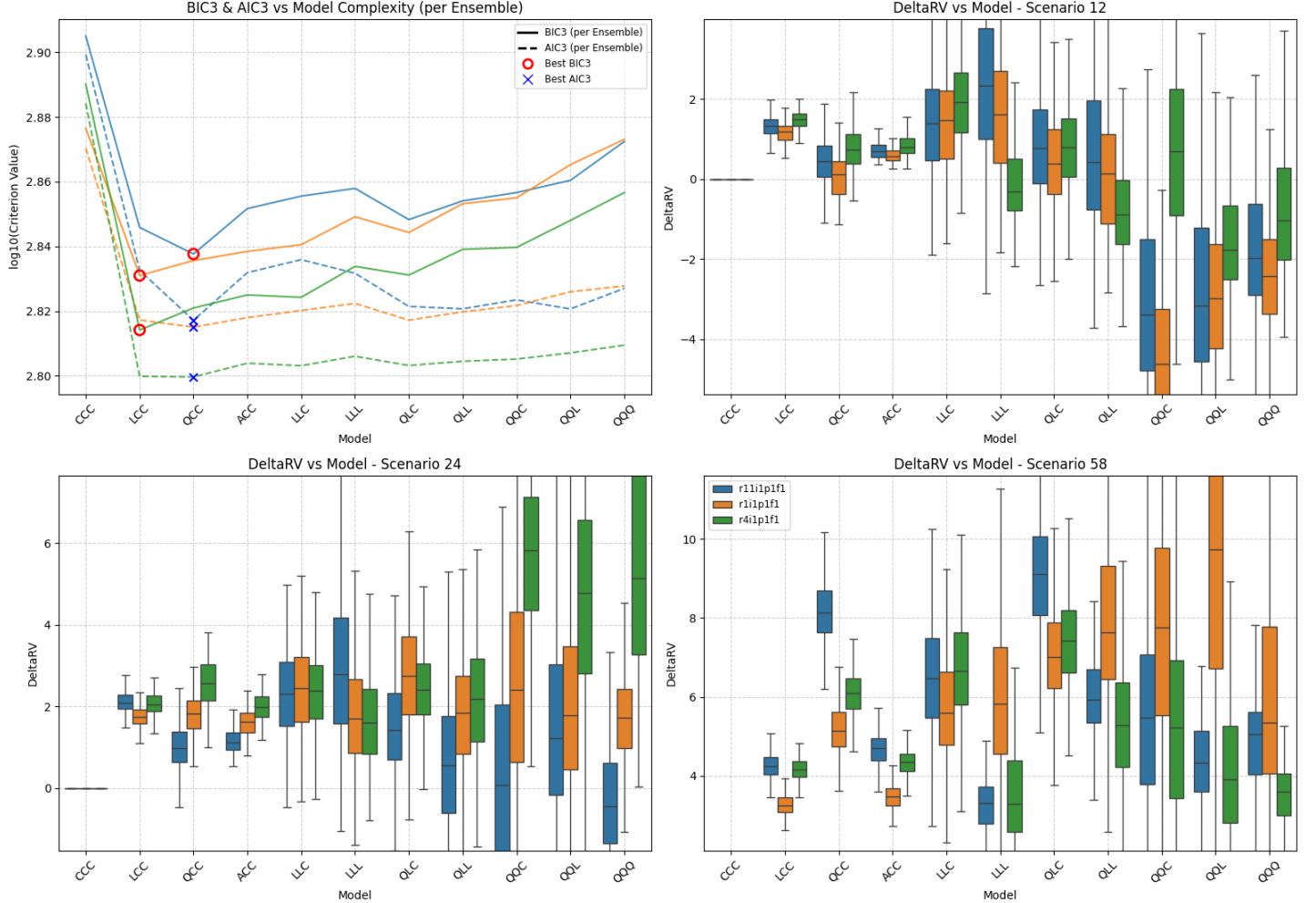


Figure SM4: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Antarctic region using **EC-Earth3** GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario **SSP126** as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios **SSP245** (ΔQ_2) and **SSP585** (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: AN | GCM: MR | Agg: Mxm

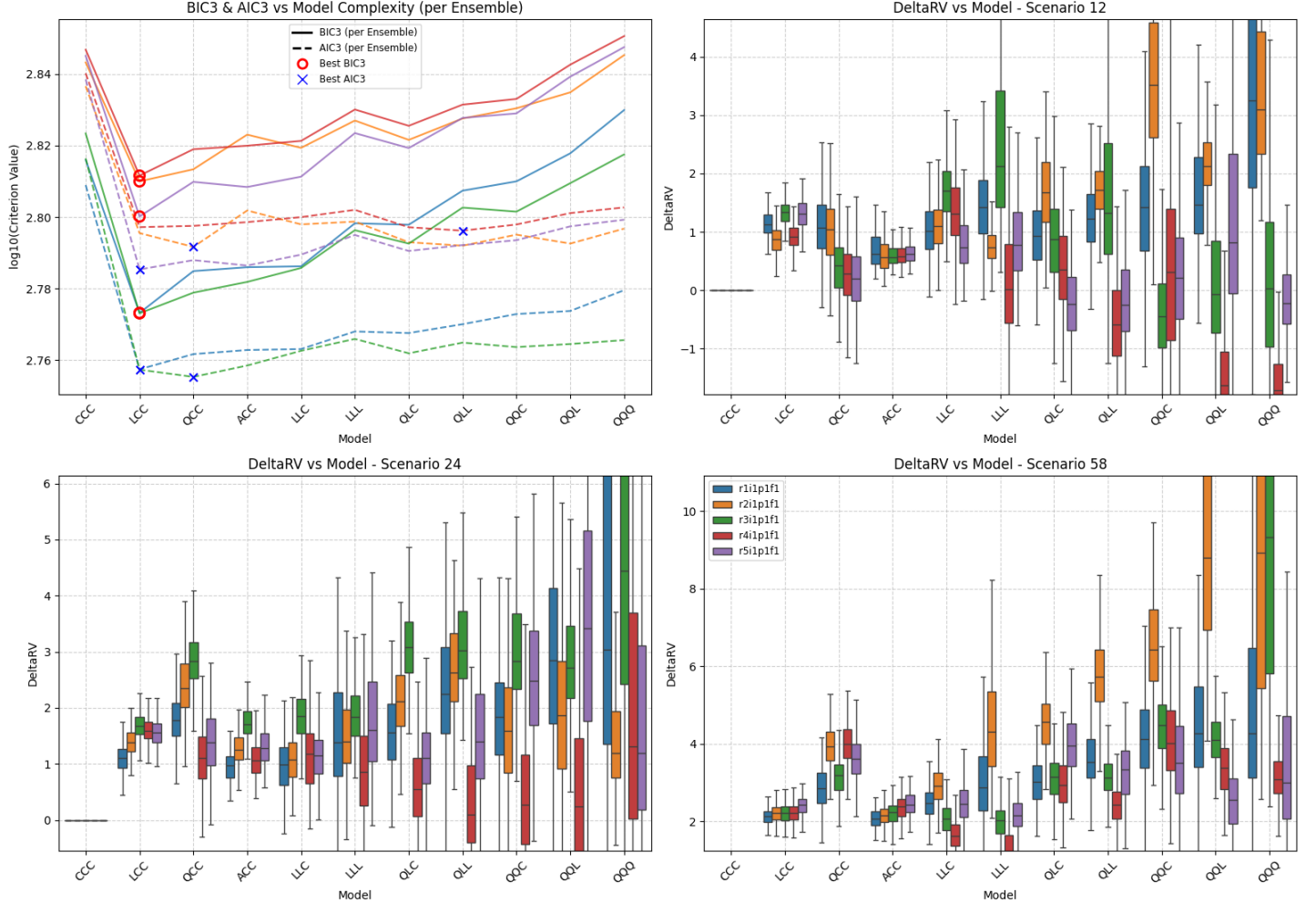


Figure SM5: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Antarctic region using MRI-ESM2-0 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: AN | GCM: UK | Agg: Mxm

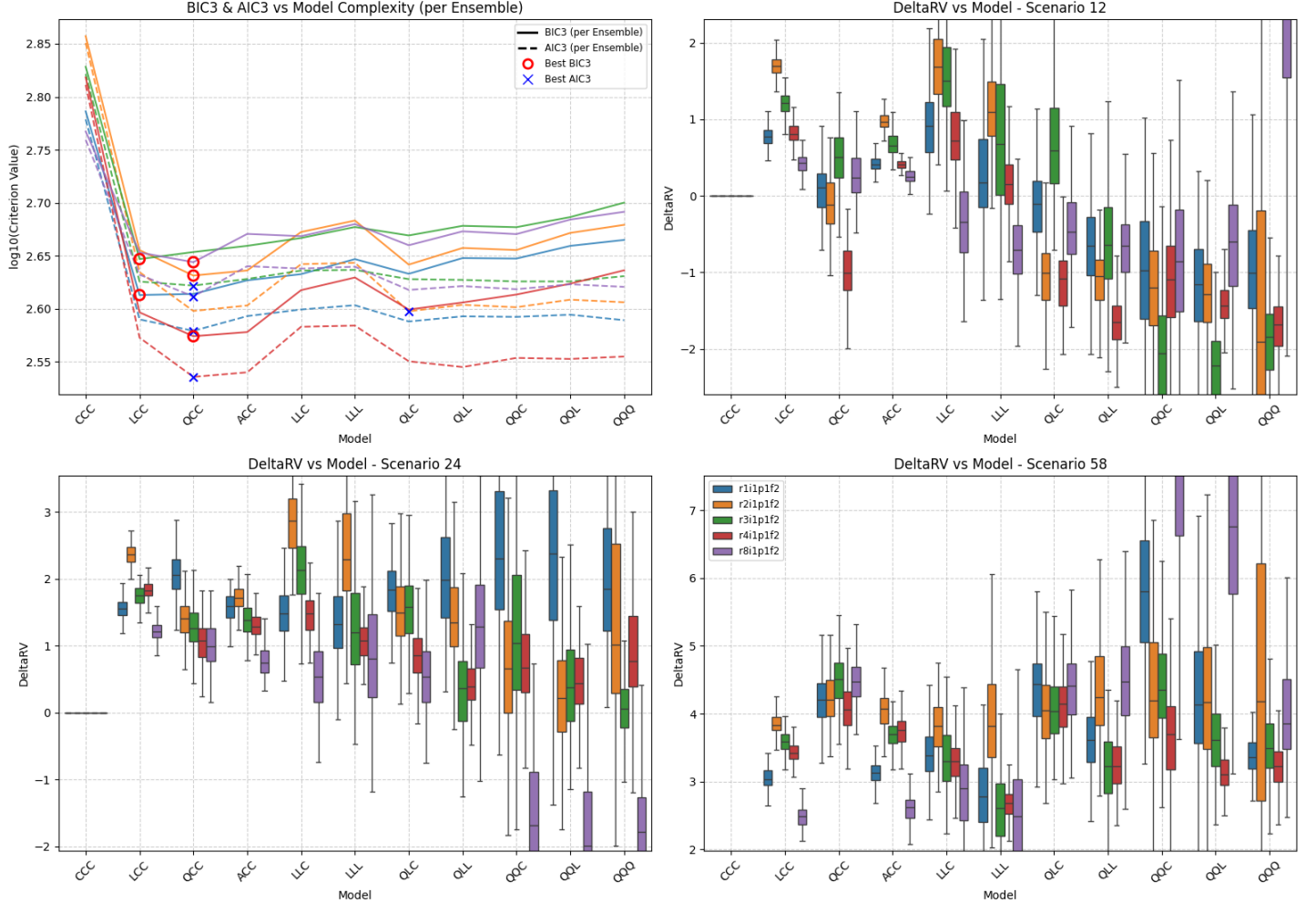


Figure SM6: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Antarctic region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: DA | GCM: AC | Agg: Mxm

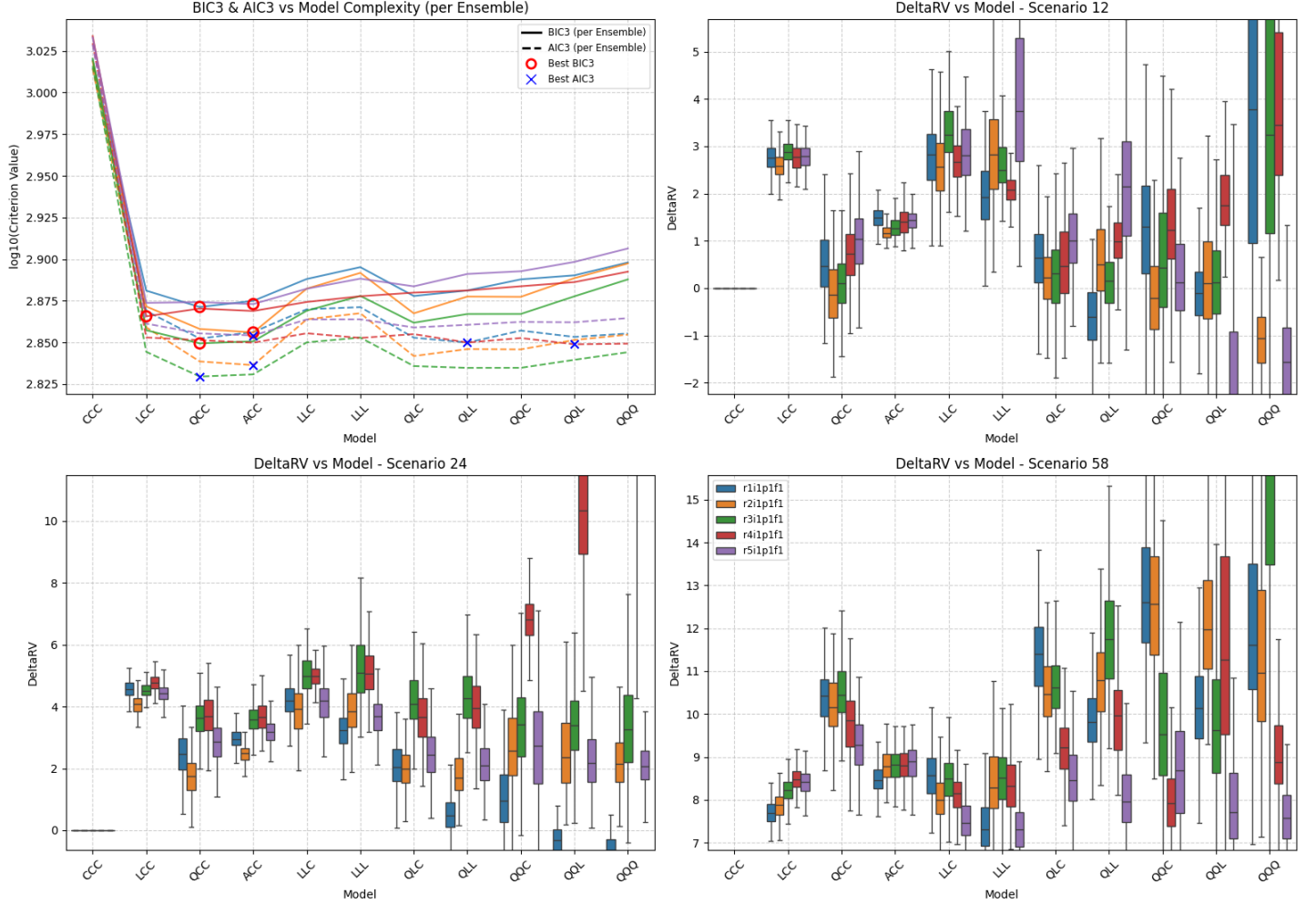


Figure SM7: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Dasht-e Lut region using ACCESS-CM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: DA | GCM: CE | Agg: Mxm

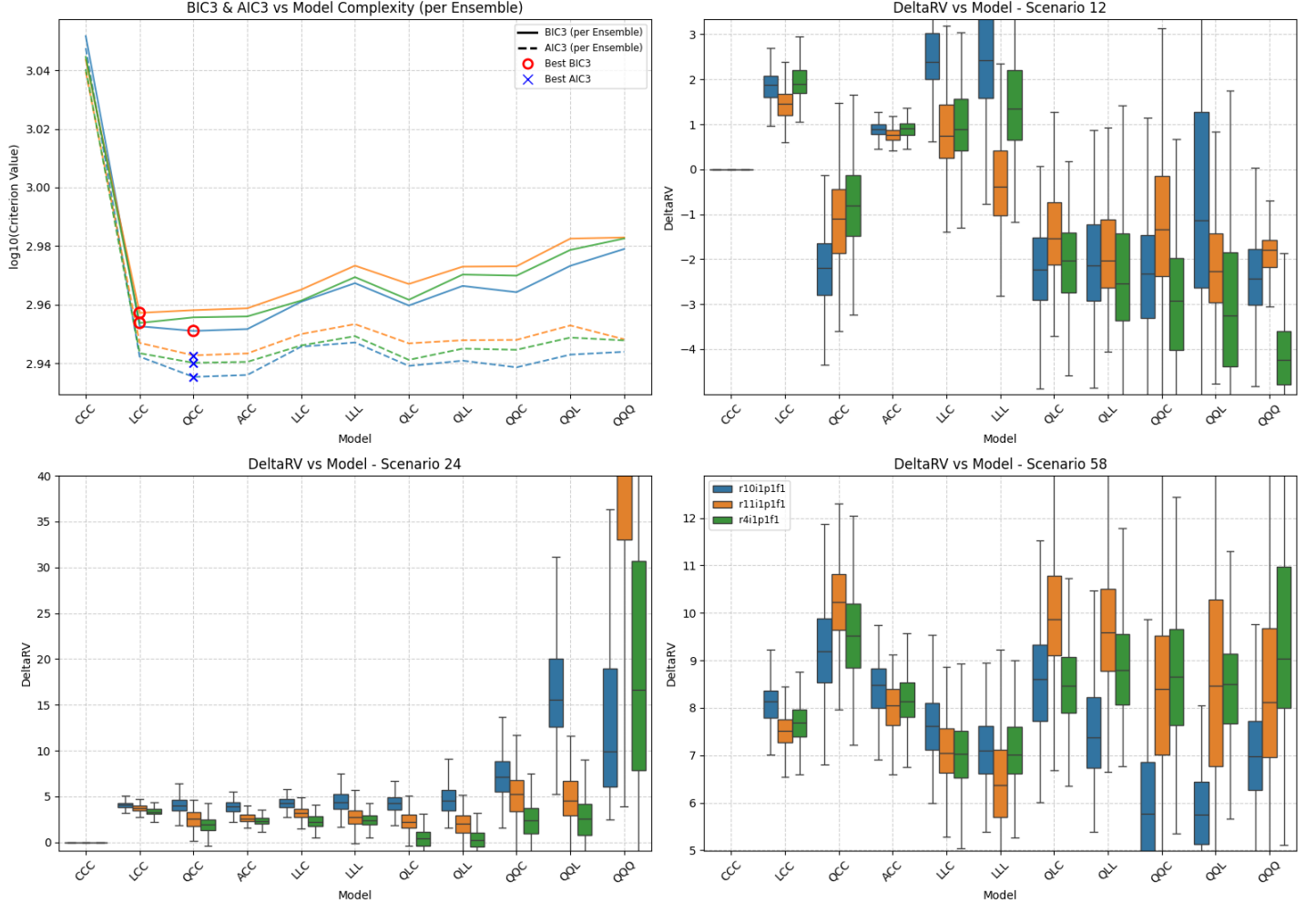


Figure SM8: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Dasht-e Lut region using CESM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: DA | GCM: EC | Agg: Mxm

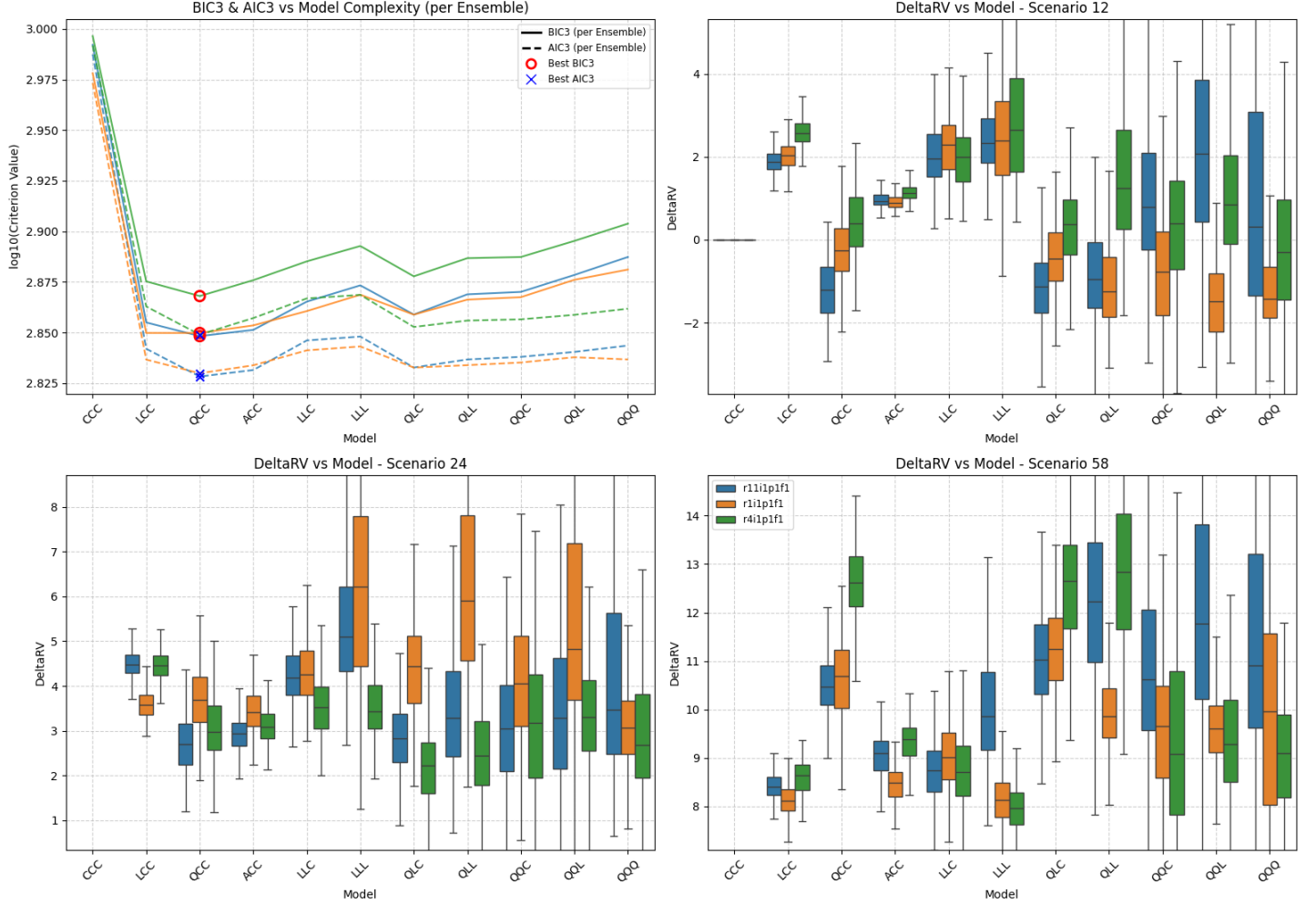


Figure SM9: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Dasht-e Lut region using EC-Earth3 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: DA | GCM: MR | Agg: Mxm

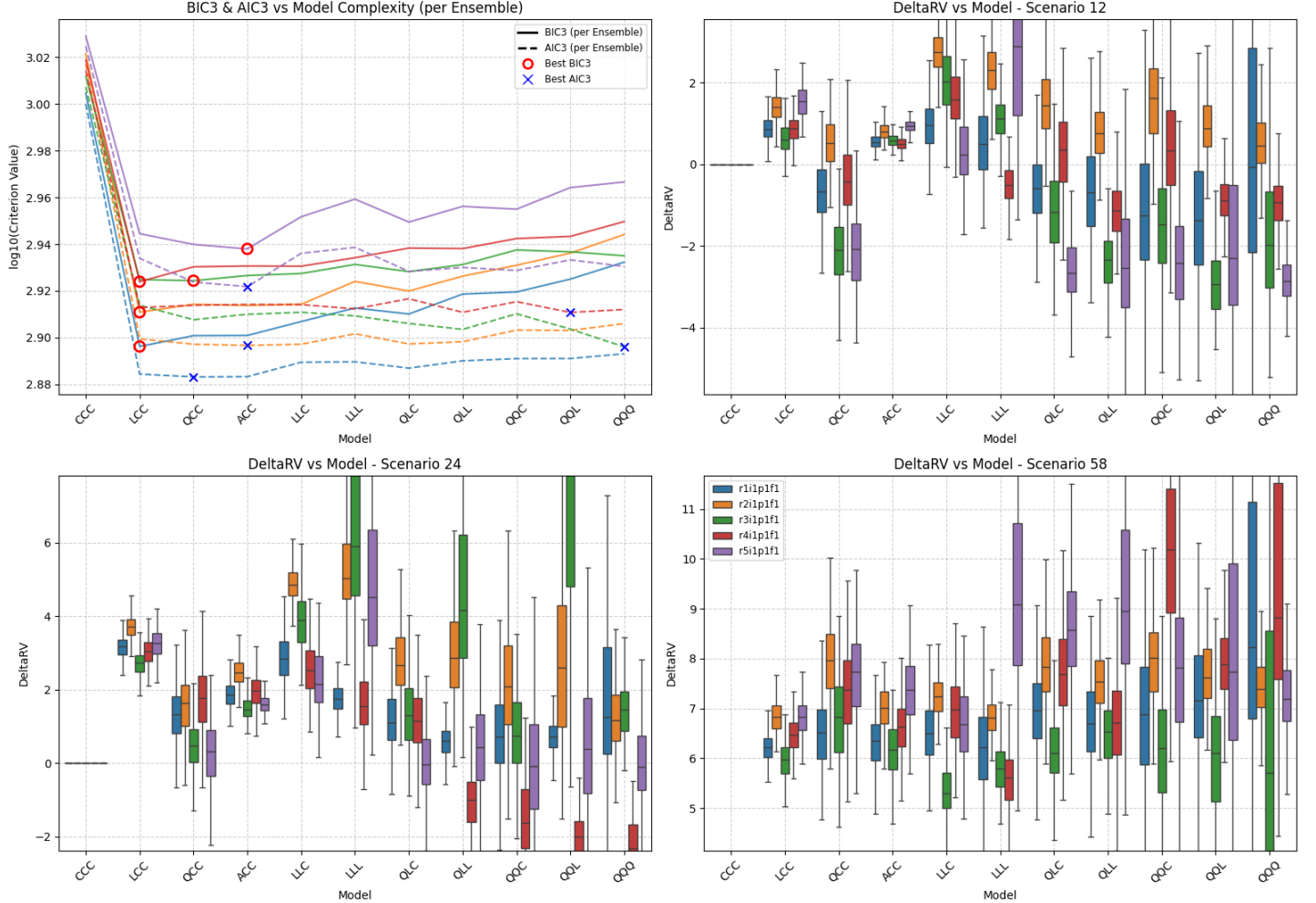


Figure SM10: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Dasht-e Lut region using MRI-ESM2-0 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: DA | GCM: UK | Agg: Mxm

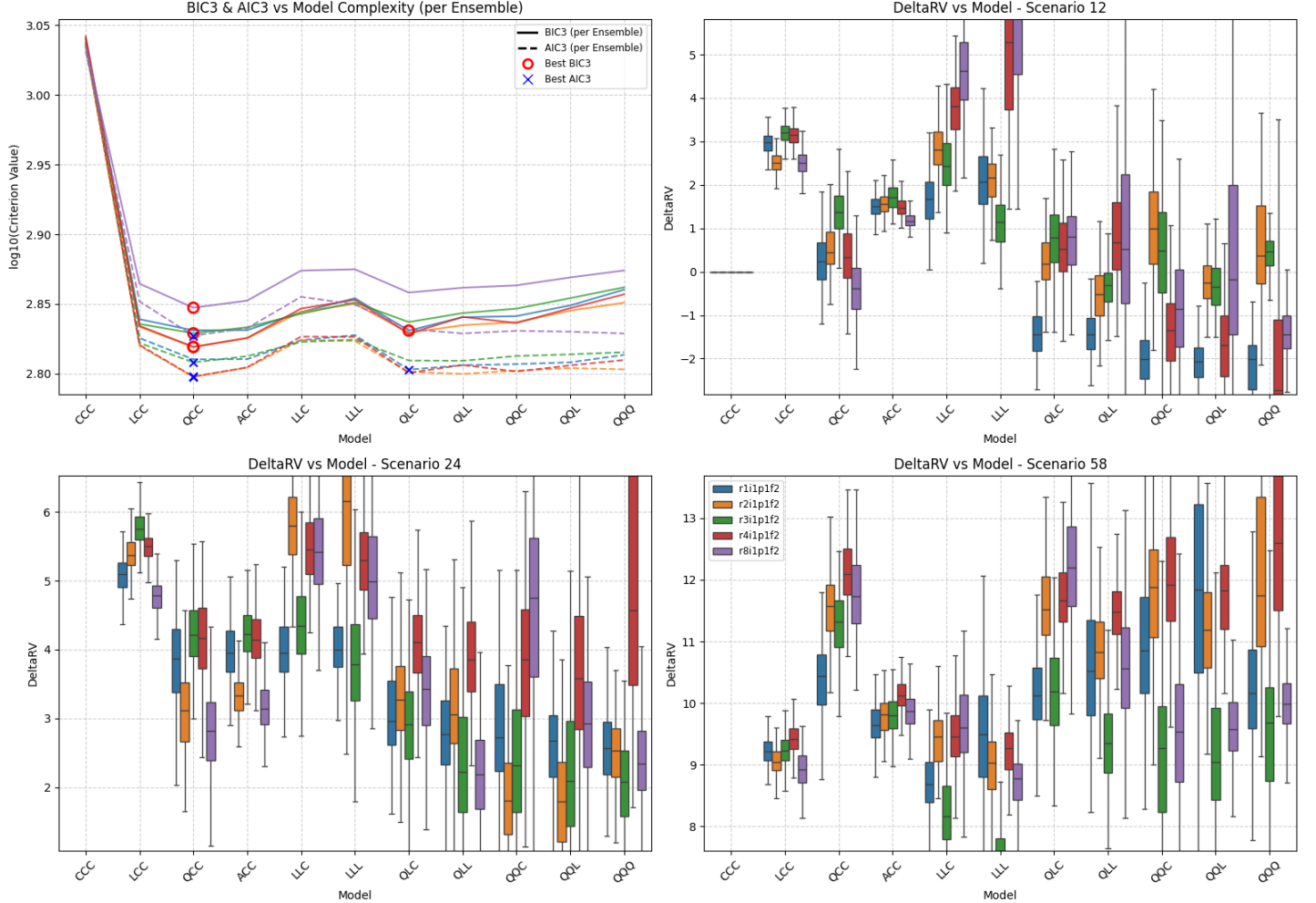


Figure SM11: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Dasht-e Lut region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: MO | GCM: AC | Agg: Mxm

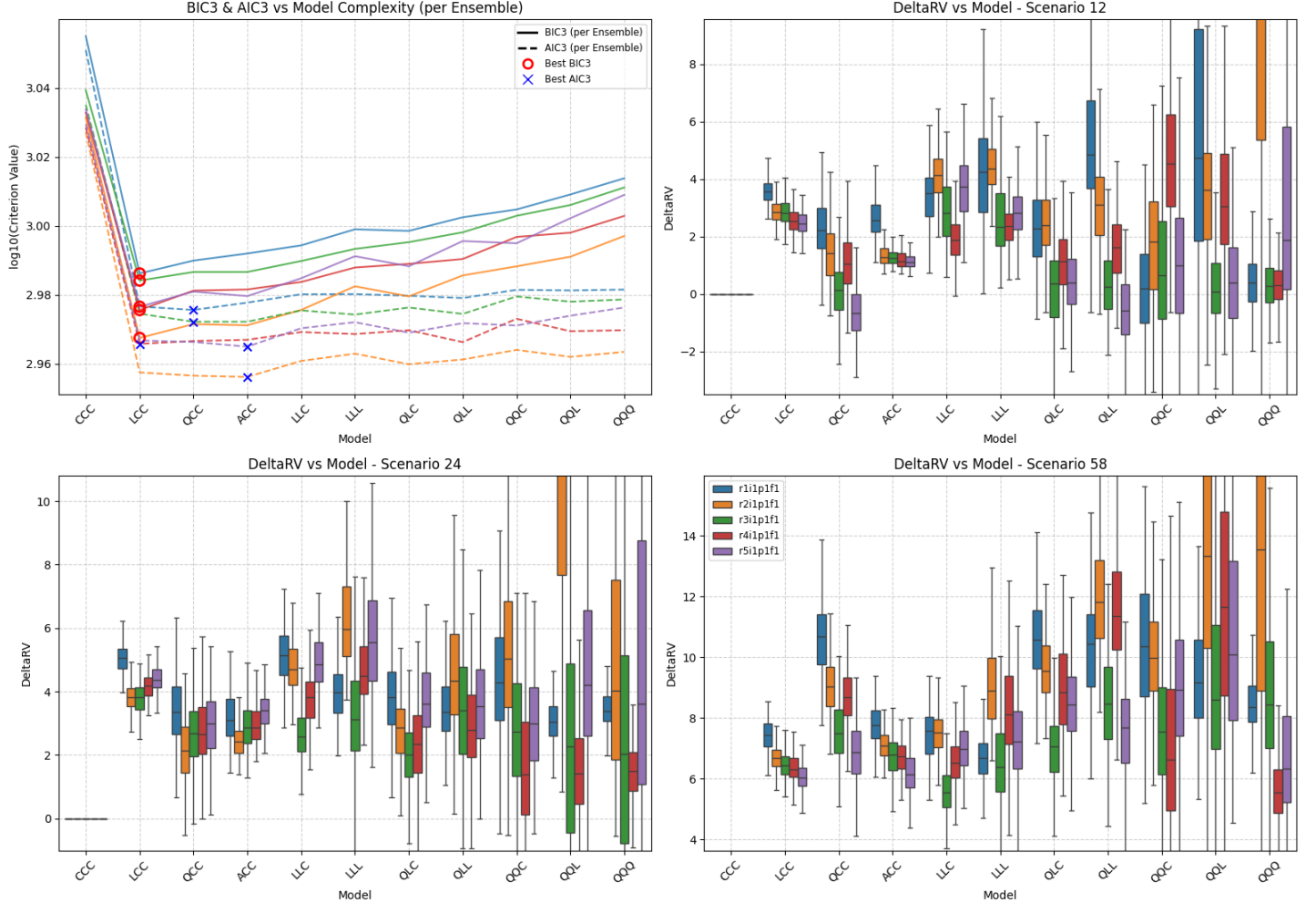


Figure SM12: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Mojave region using ACCESS-CM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: MO | GCM: CE | Agg: Mxm

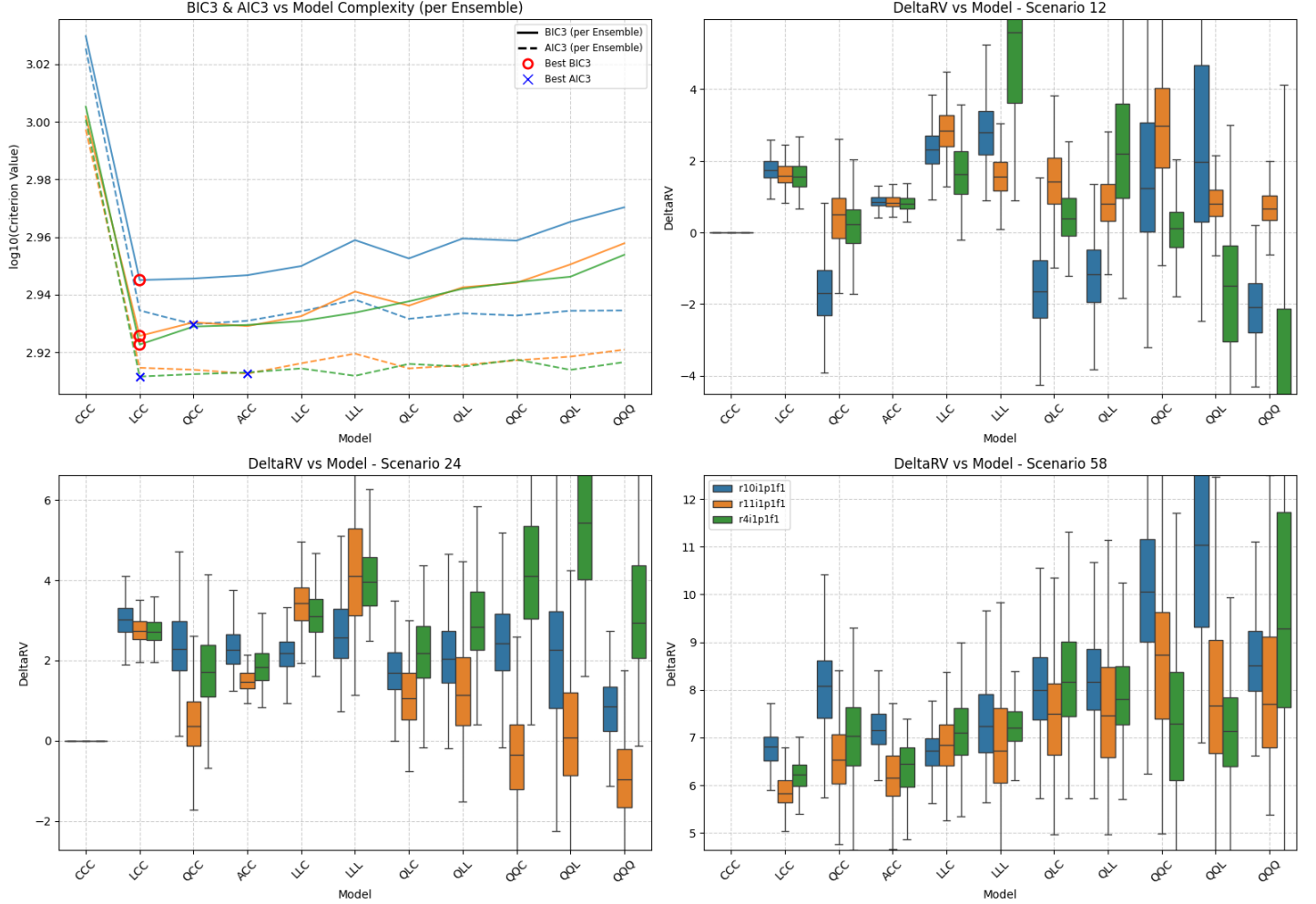
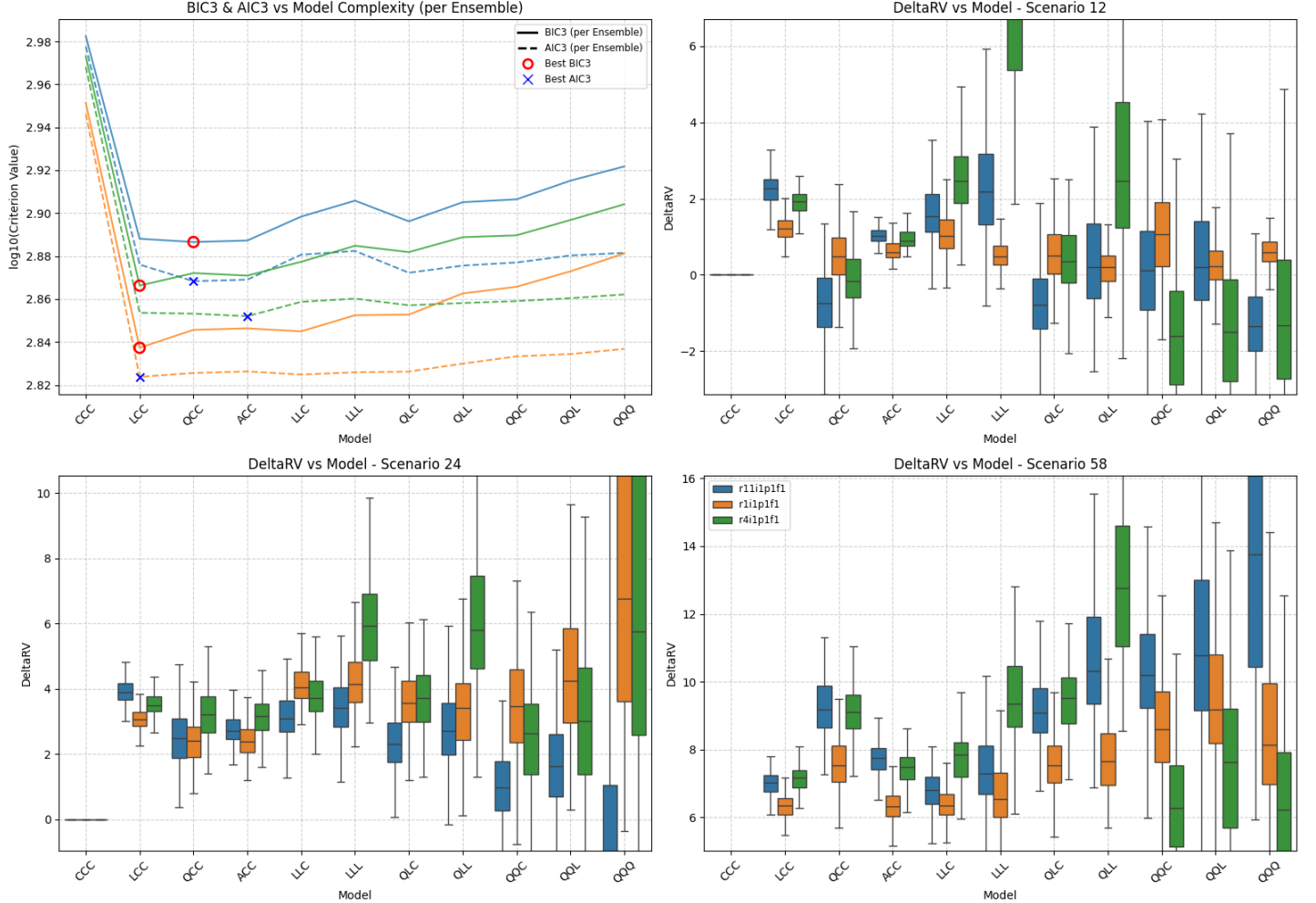


Figure SM13: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Mojave region using CESM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: MO | GCM: EC | Agg: Mxm



Location: MO | GCM: MR | Agg: Mxm

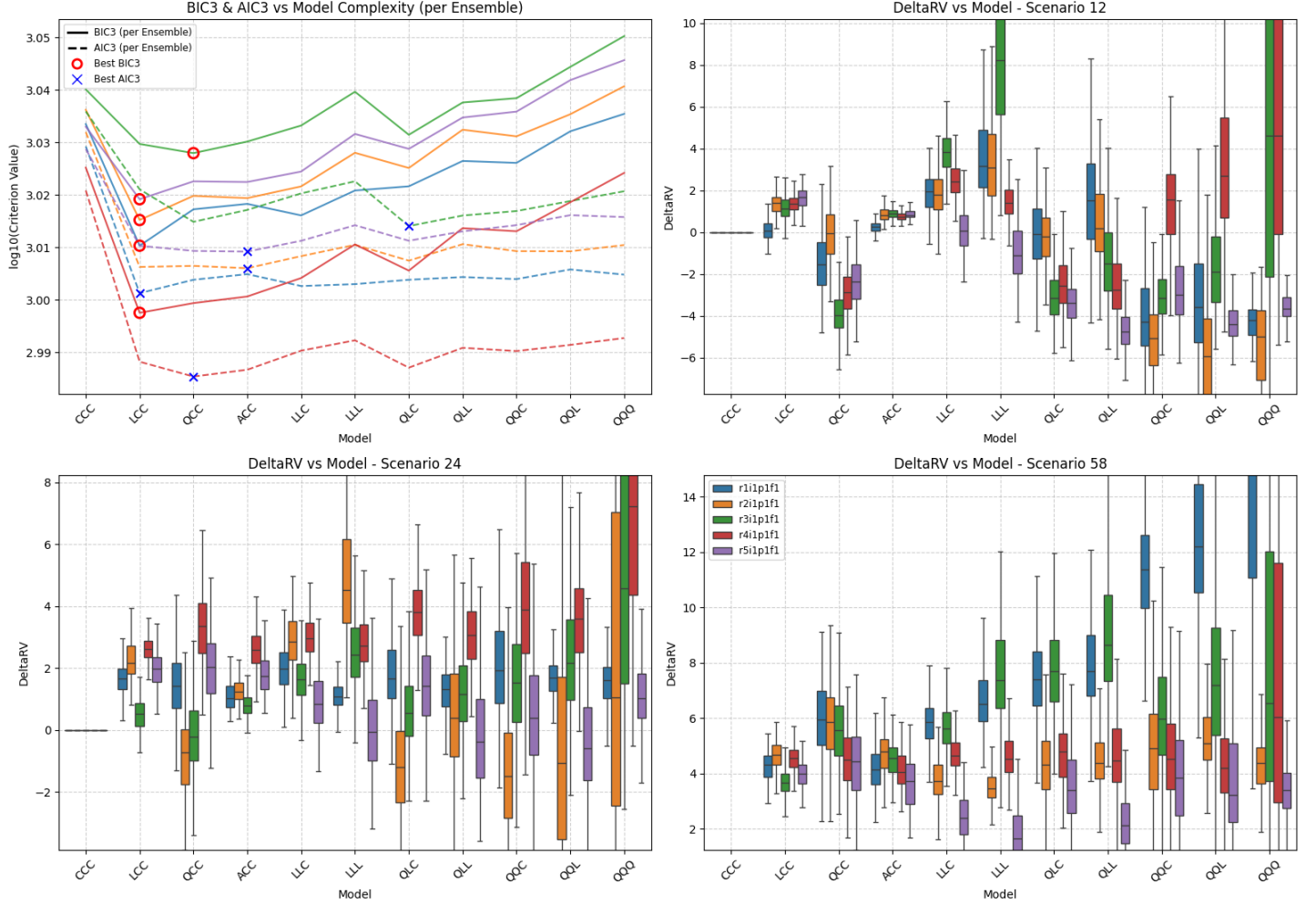


Figure SM15: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Mojave region using MRI-ESM2-0 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: MO | GCM: UK | Agg: Mxm

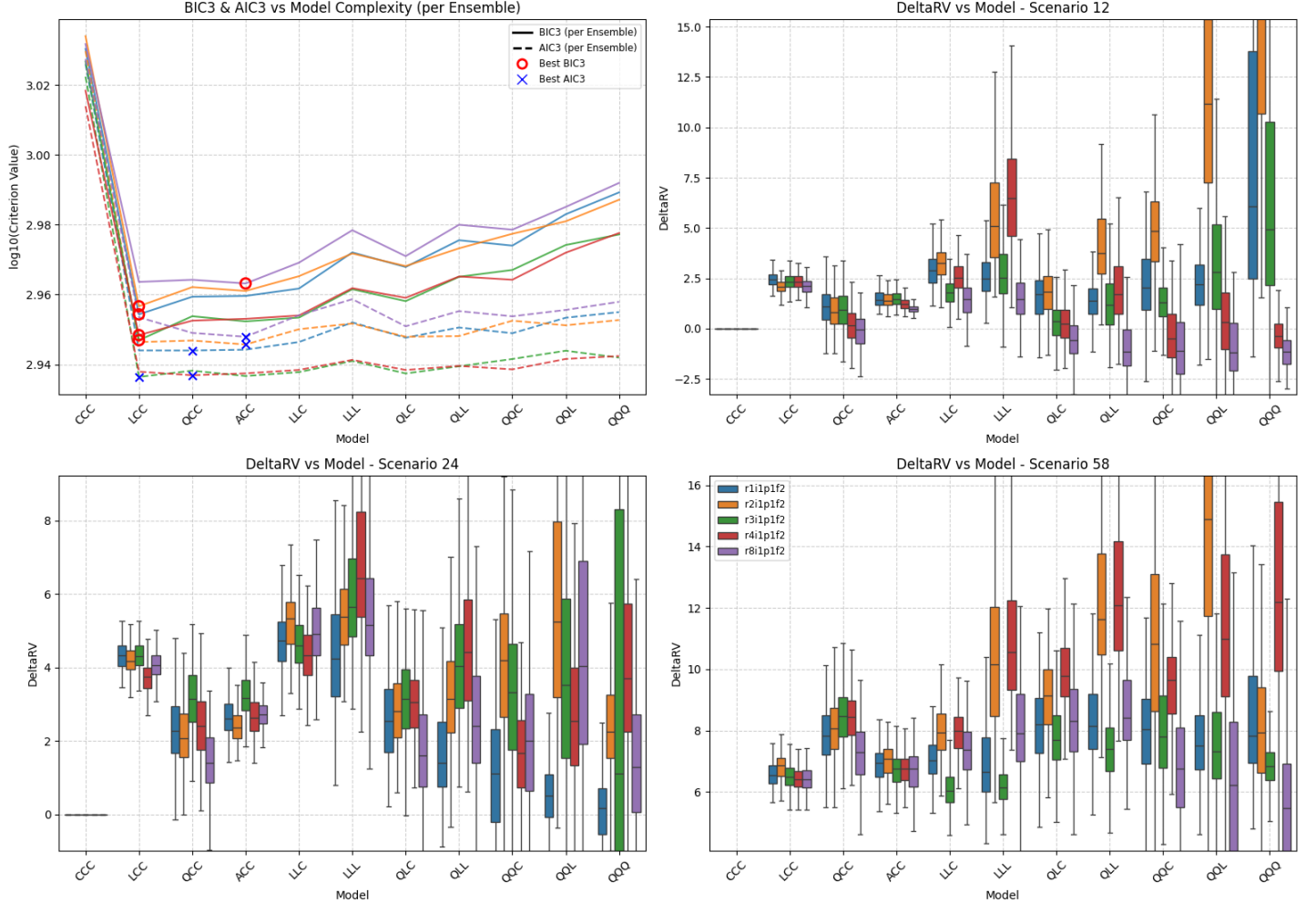


Figure SM16: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Mojave region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SA | GCM: AC | Agg: Mxm

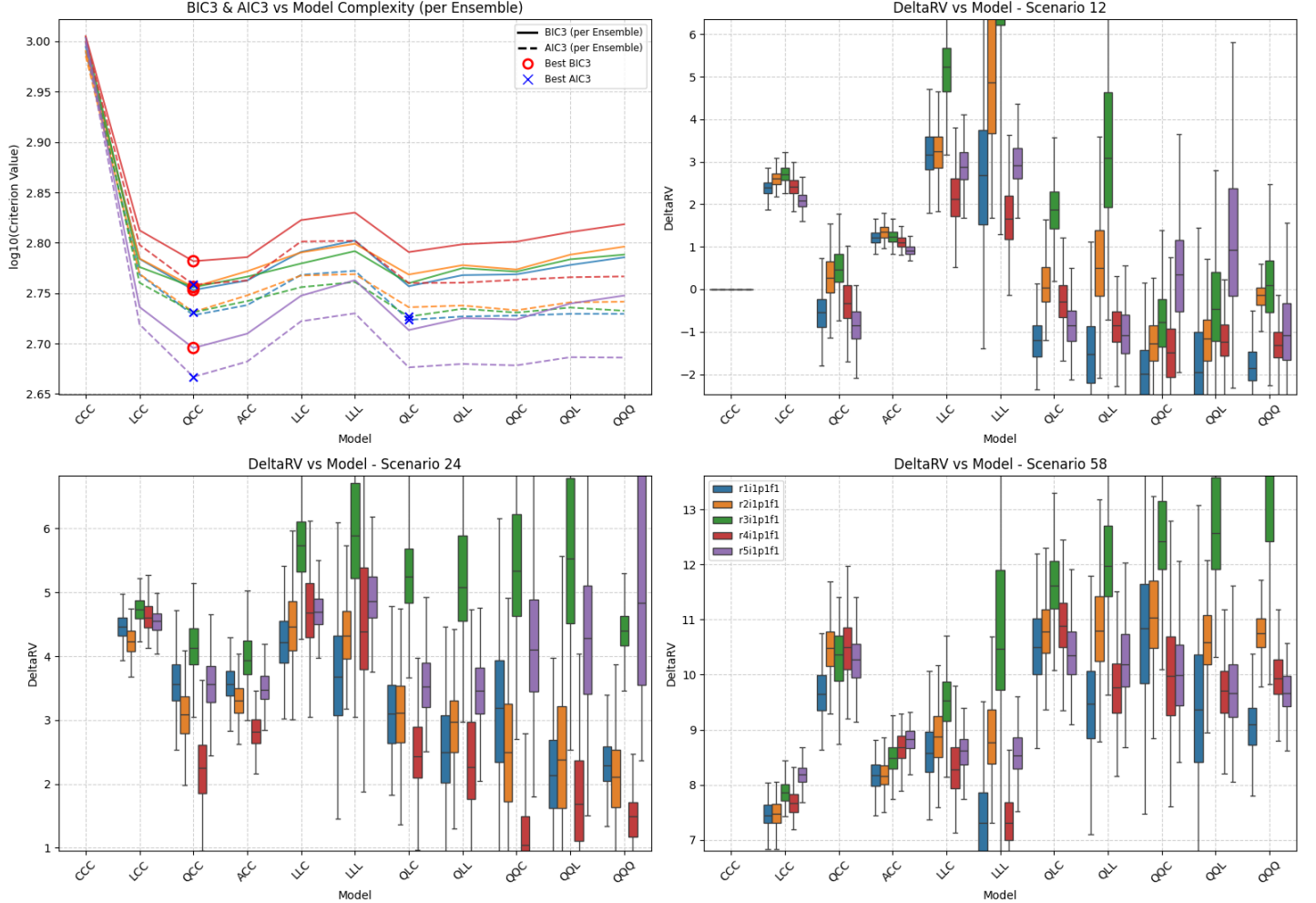


Figure SM17: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Sahara region using ACCESS-CM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SA | GCM: CE | Agg: Mxm

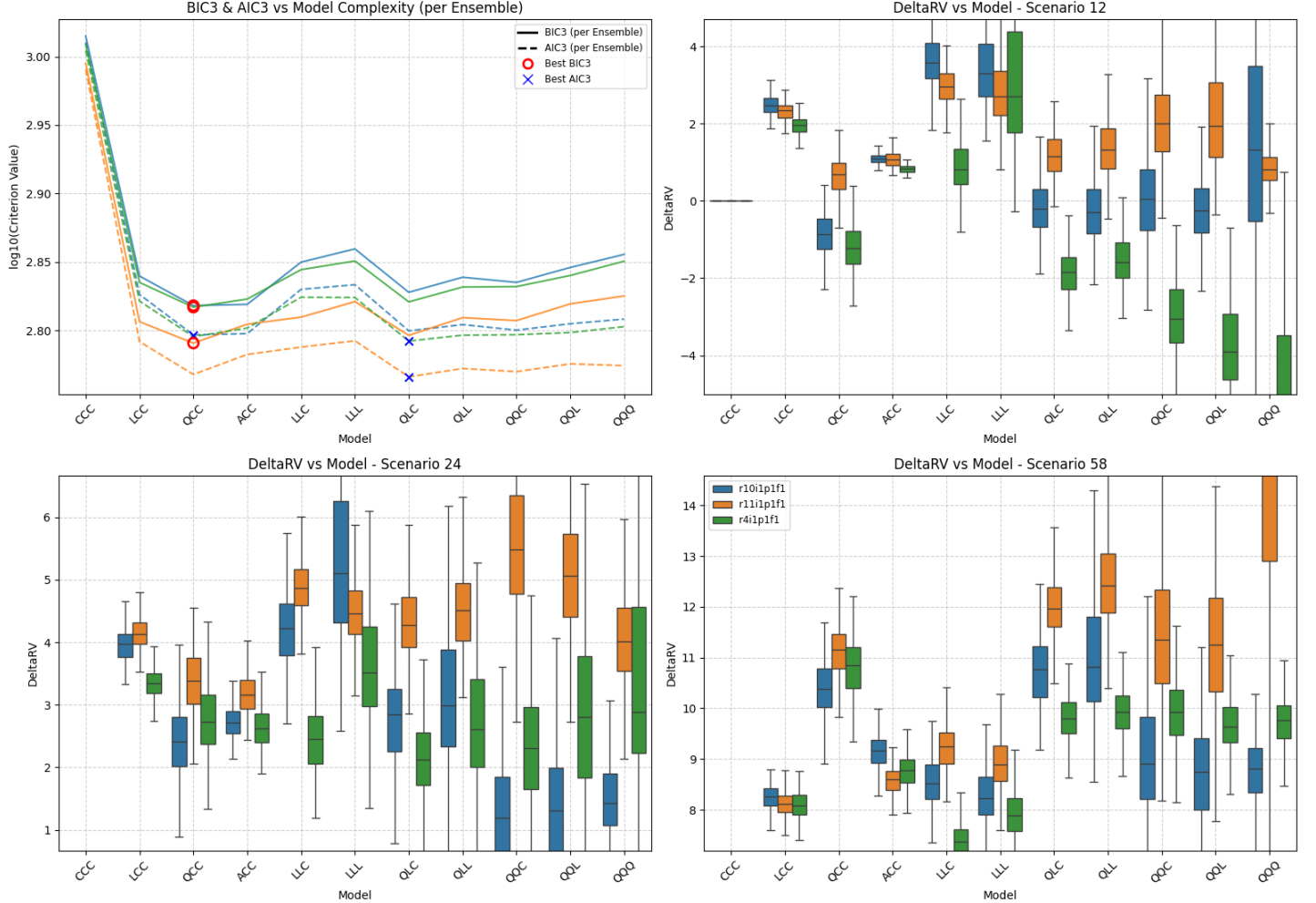


Figure SM18: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Sahara region using CESM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SA | GCM: EC | Agg: Mxm

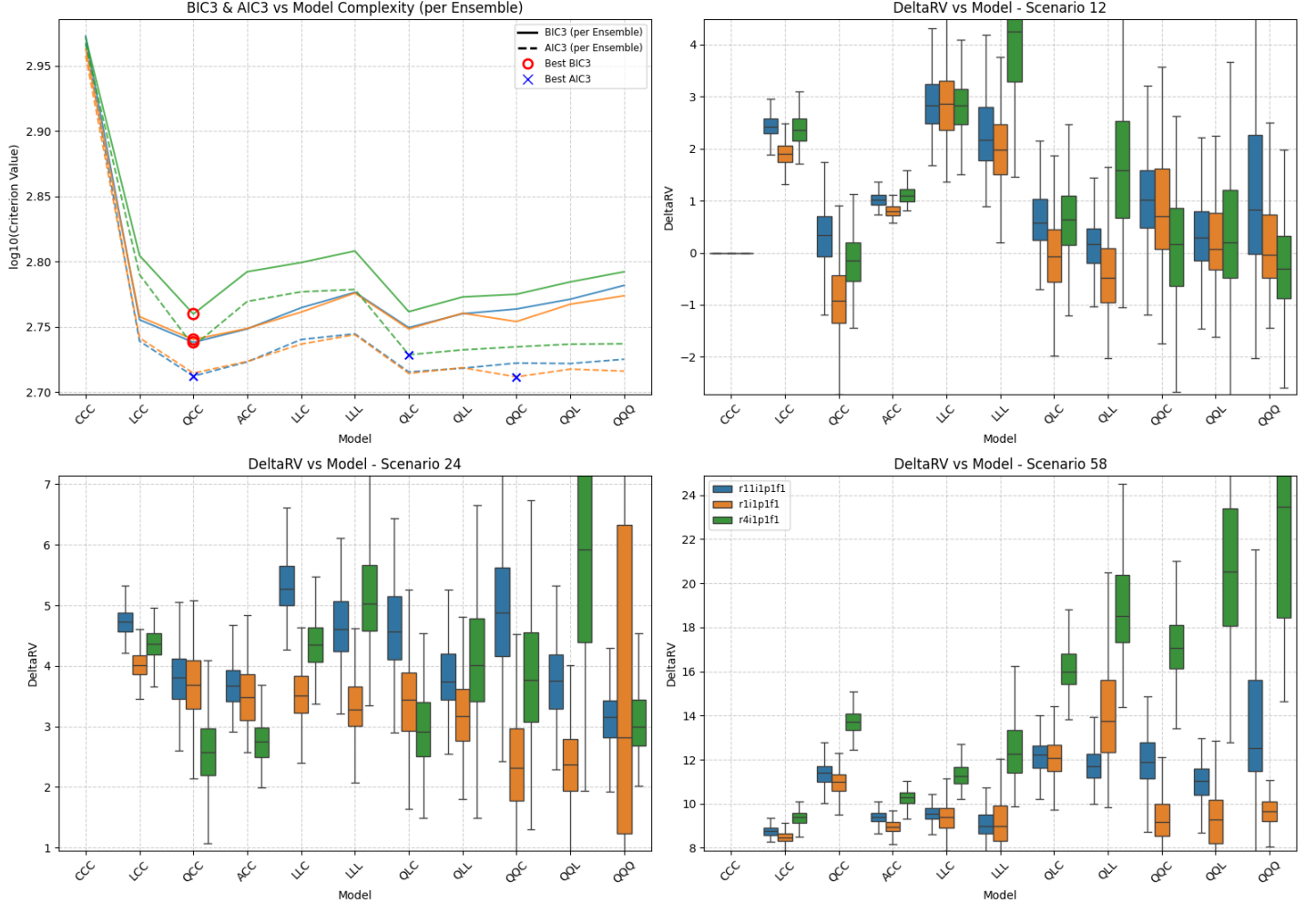


Figure SM19: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Sahara region using EC-Earth3 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SA | GCM: MR | Agg: Mxm

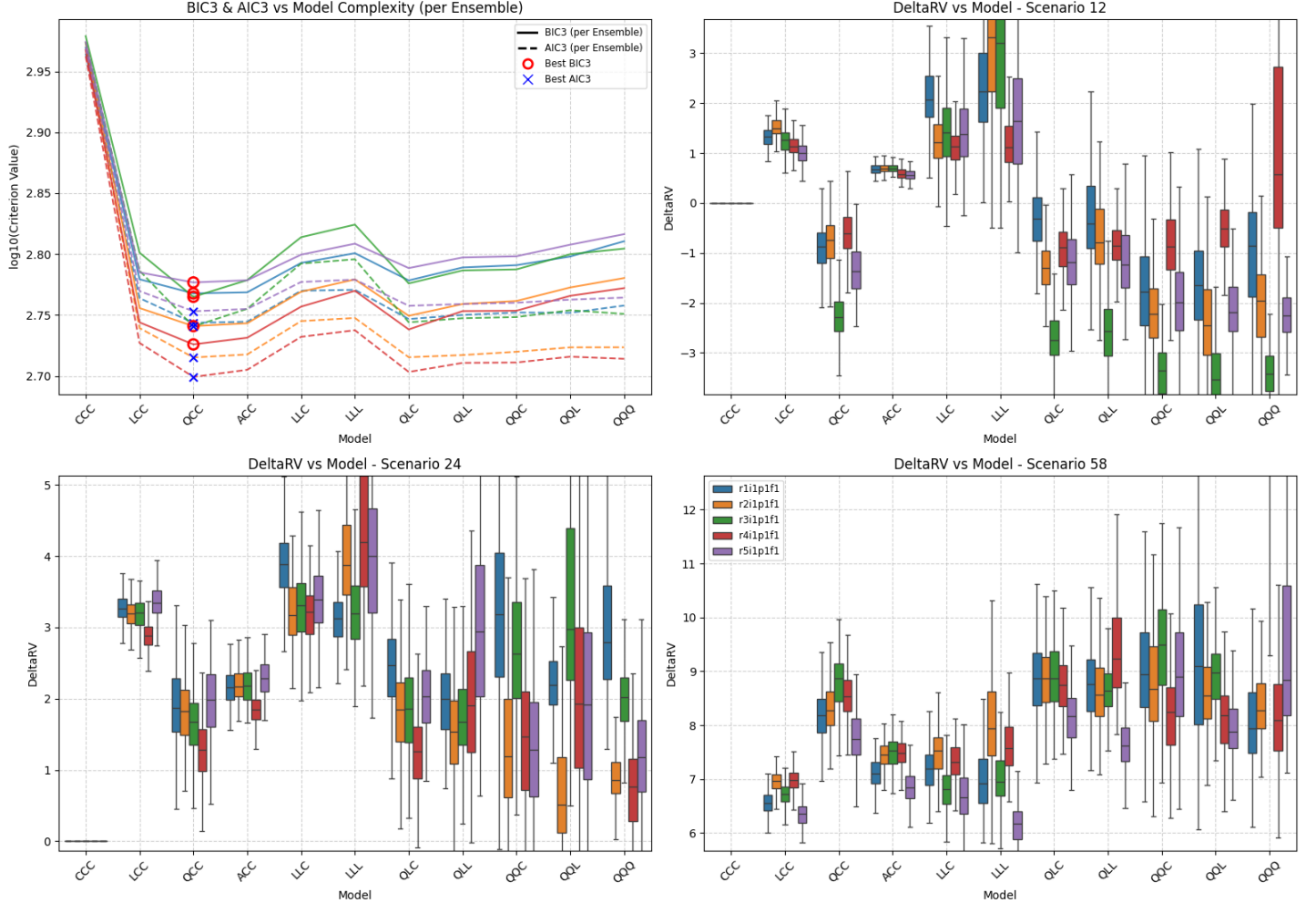


Figure SM20: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Sahara region using MRI-ESM2-0 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SA | GCM: UK | Agg: Mxm

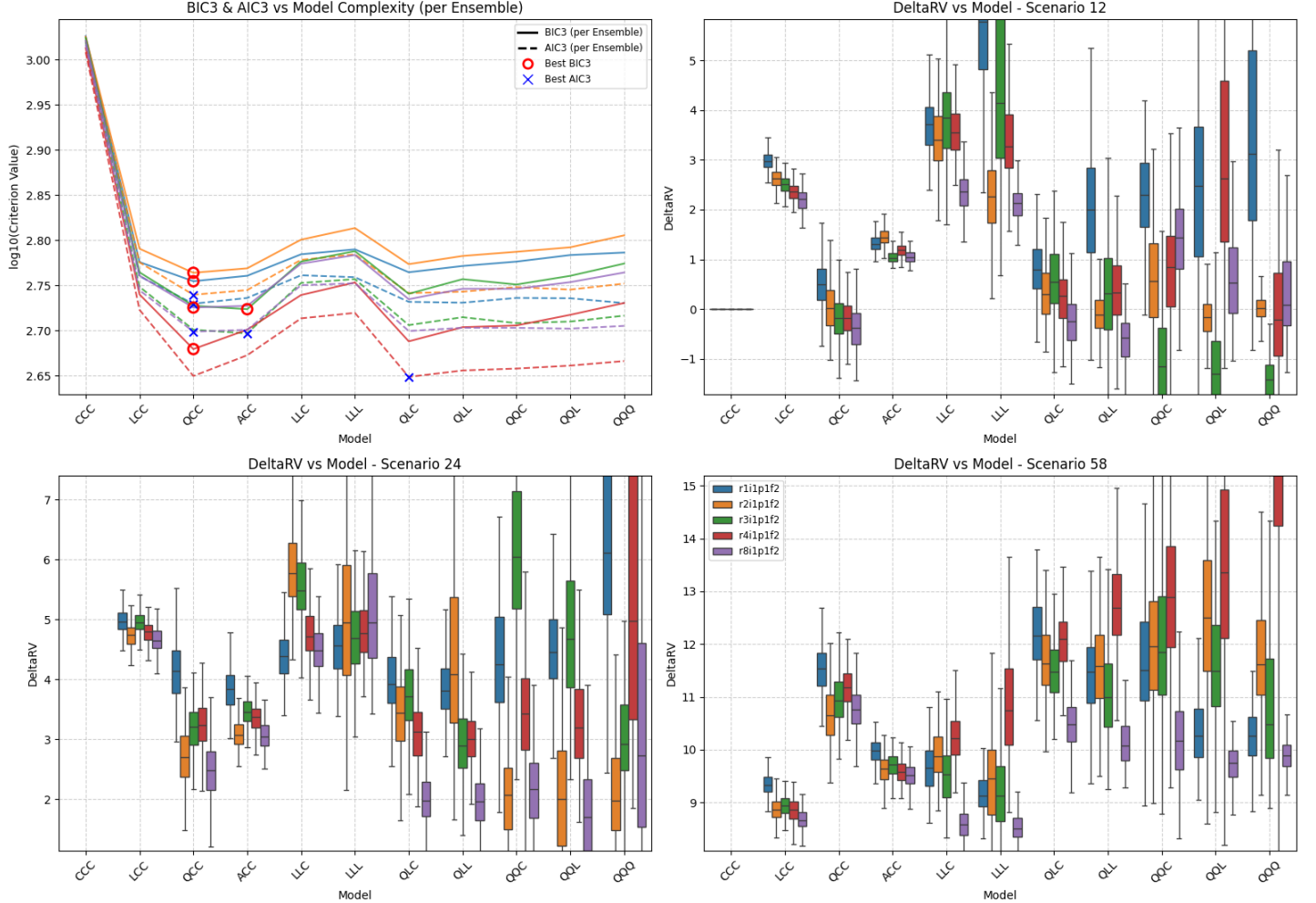


Figure SM21: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Sahara region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SI | GCM: AC | Agg: Mxm

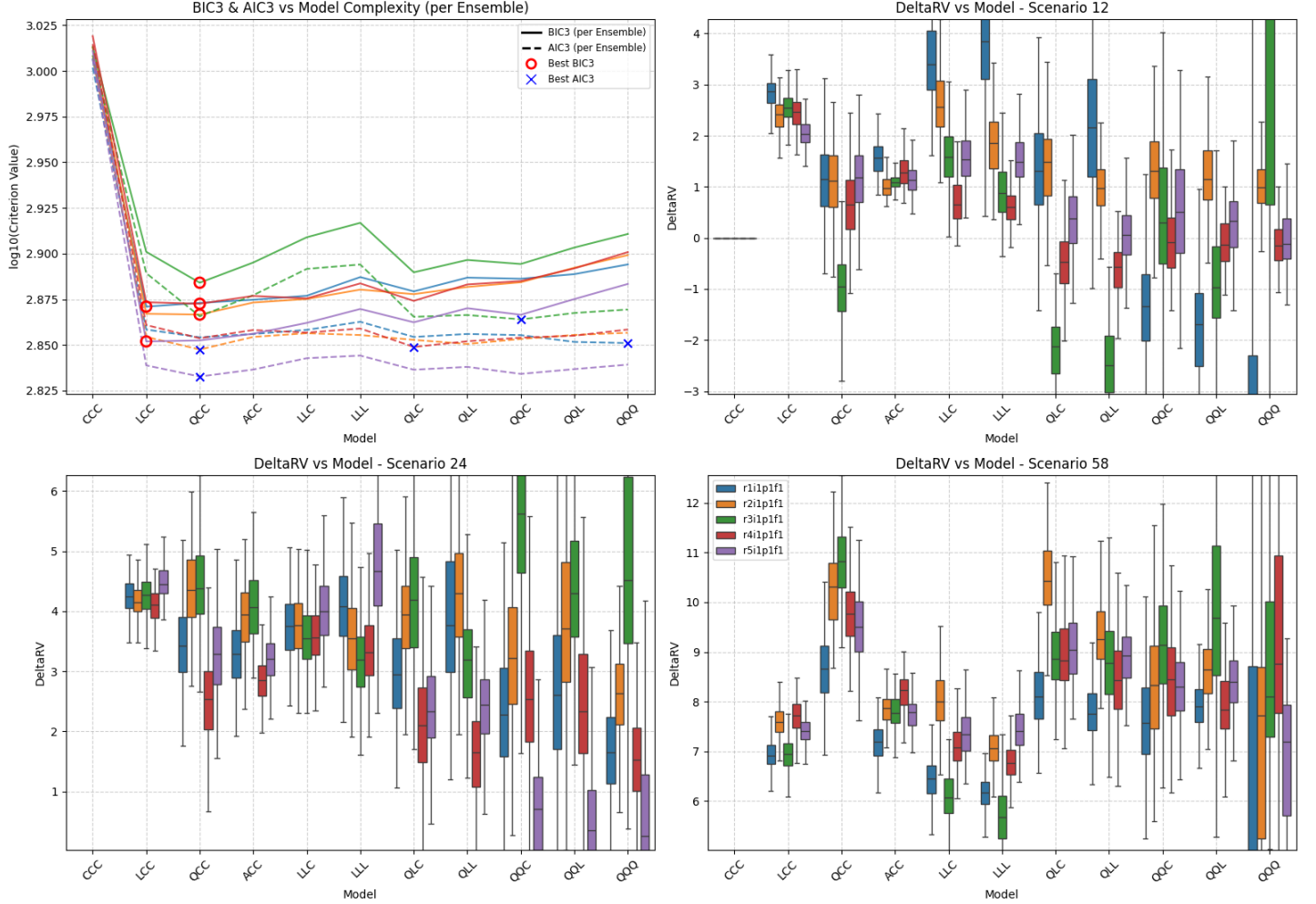


Figure SM22: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Simpson region using ACCESS-CM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SI | GCM: CE | Agg: Mxm

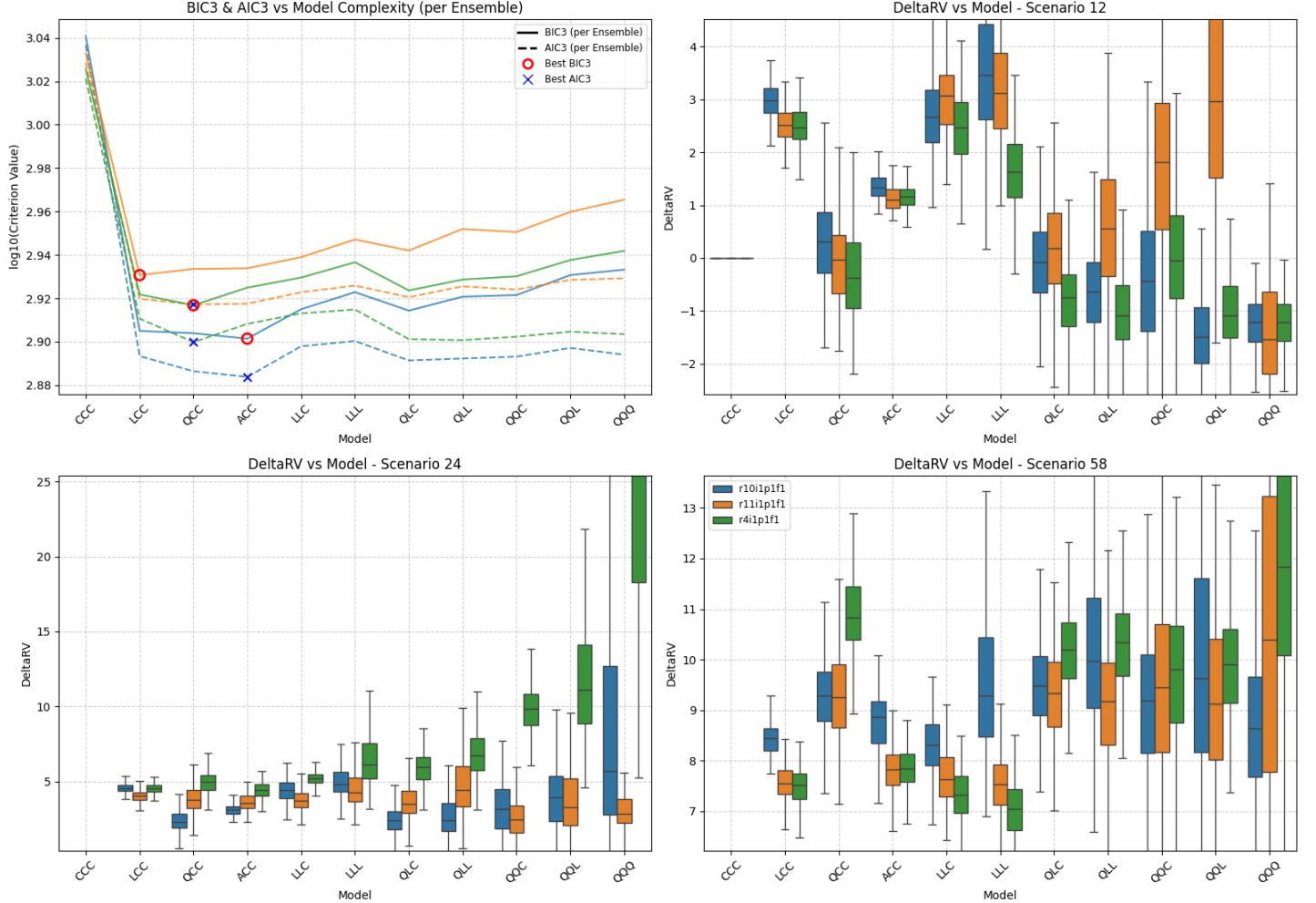


Figure SM23: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Simpson region using CESM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SI | GCM: EC | Agg: Mxm

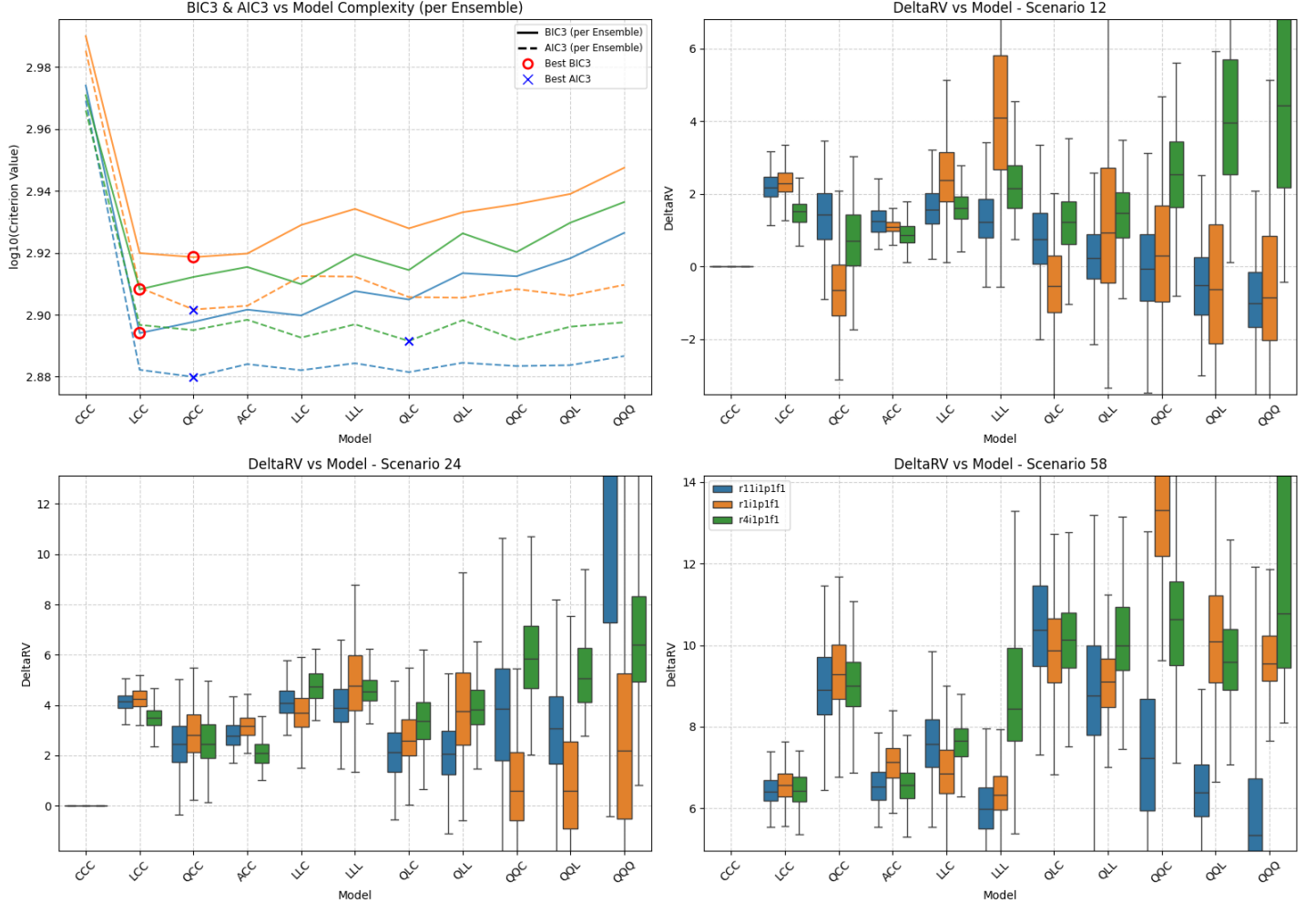
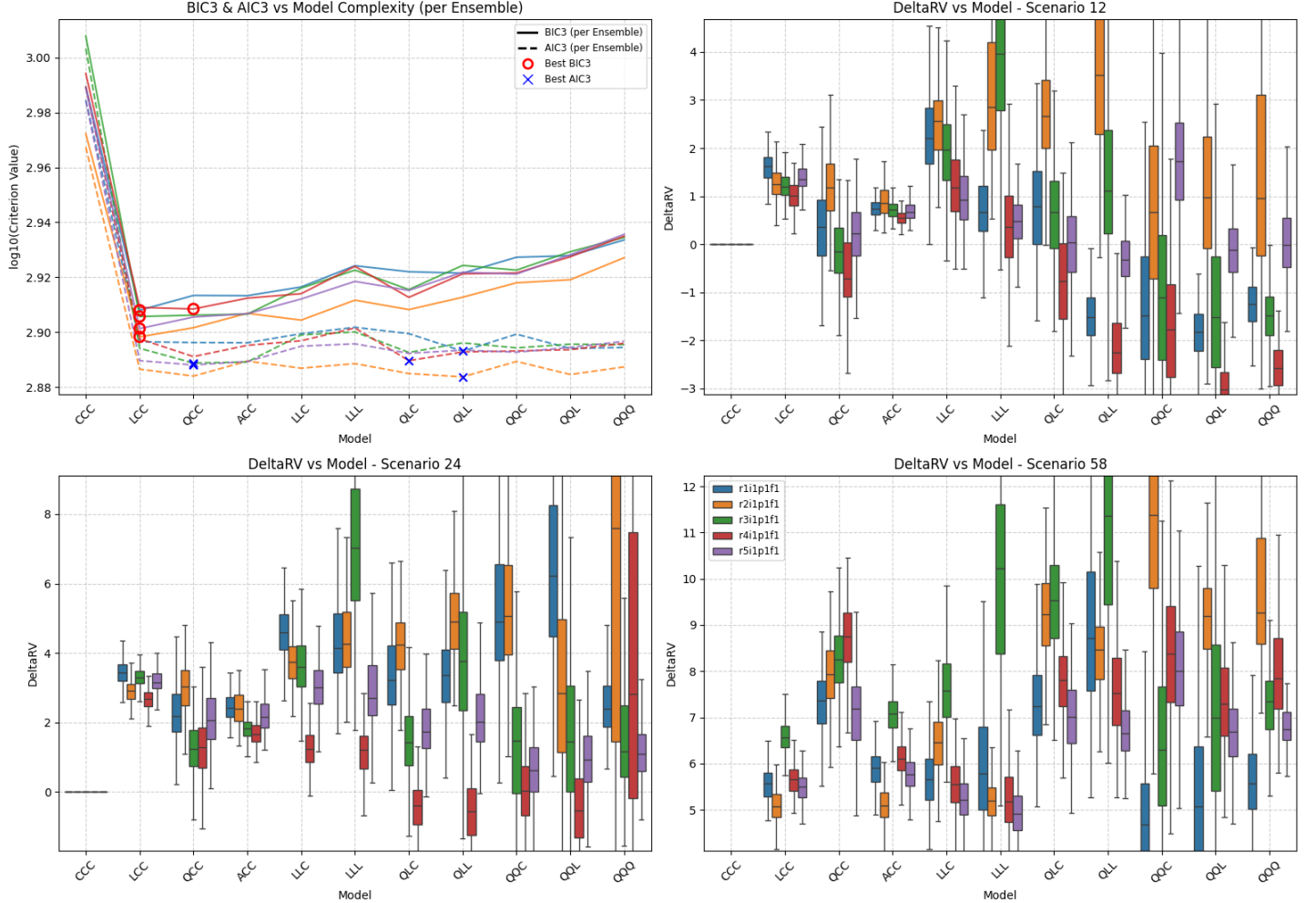


Figure SM24: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Simpson region using EC-Earth3 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SI | GCM: MR | Agg: Mxm



Location: SI | GCM: UK | Agg: Mxm

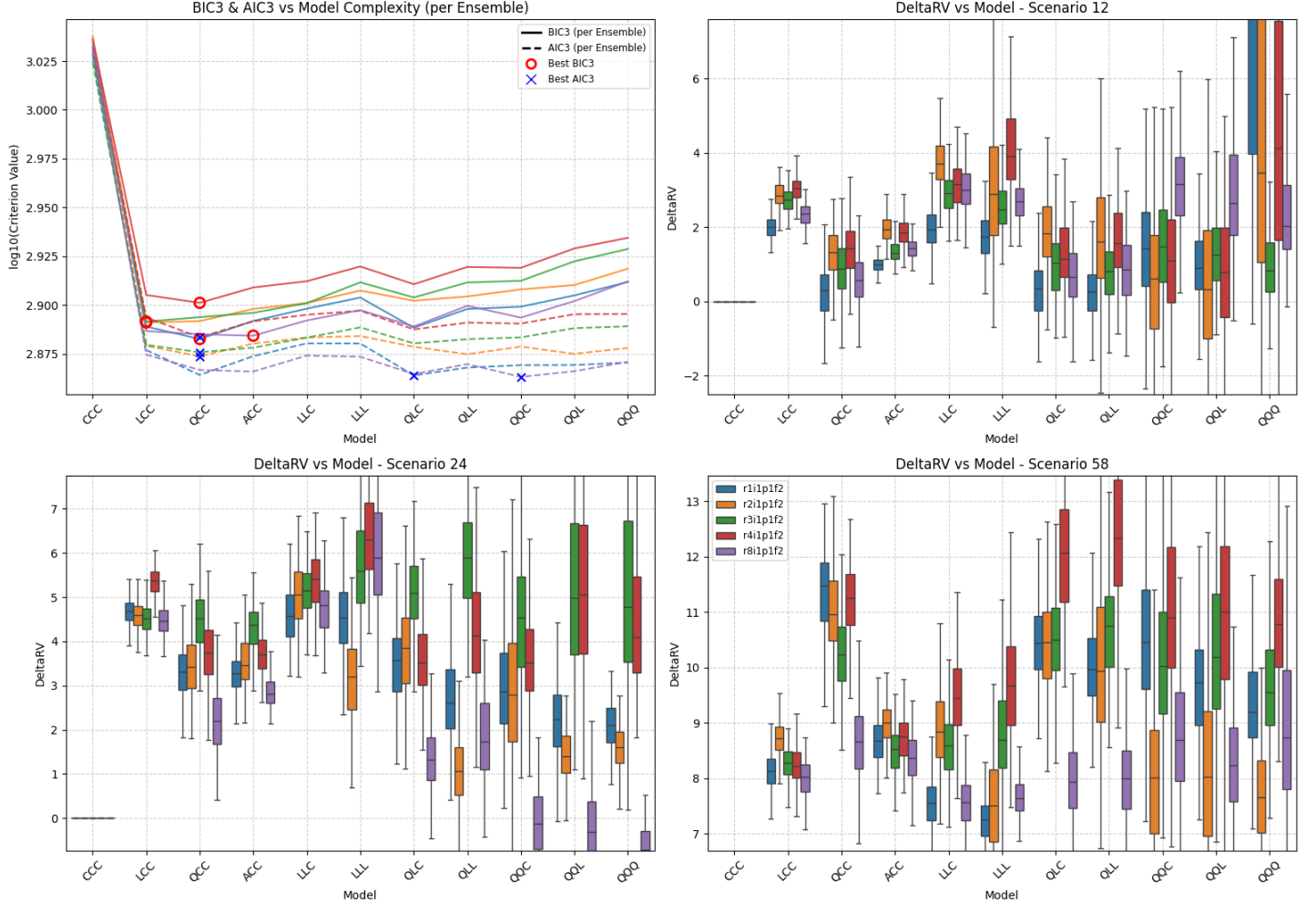


Figure SM26: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the Simpson region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: UK | GCM: AC | Agg: Mxm

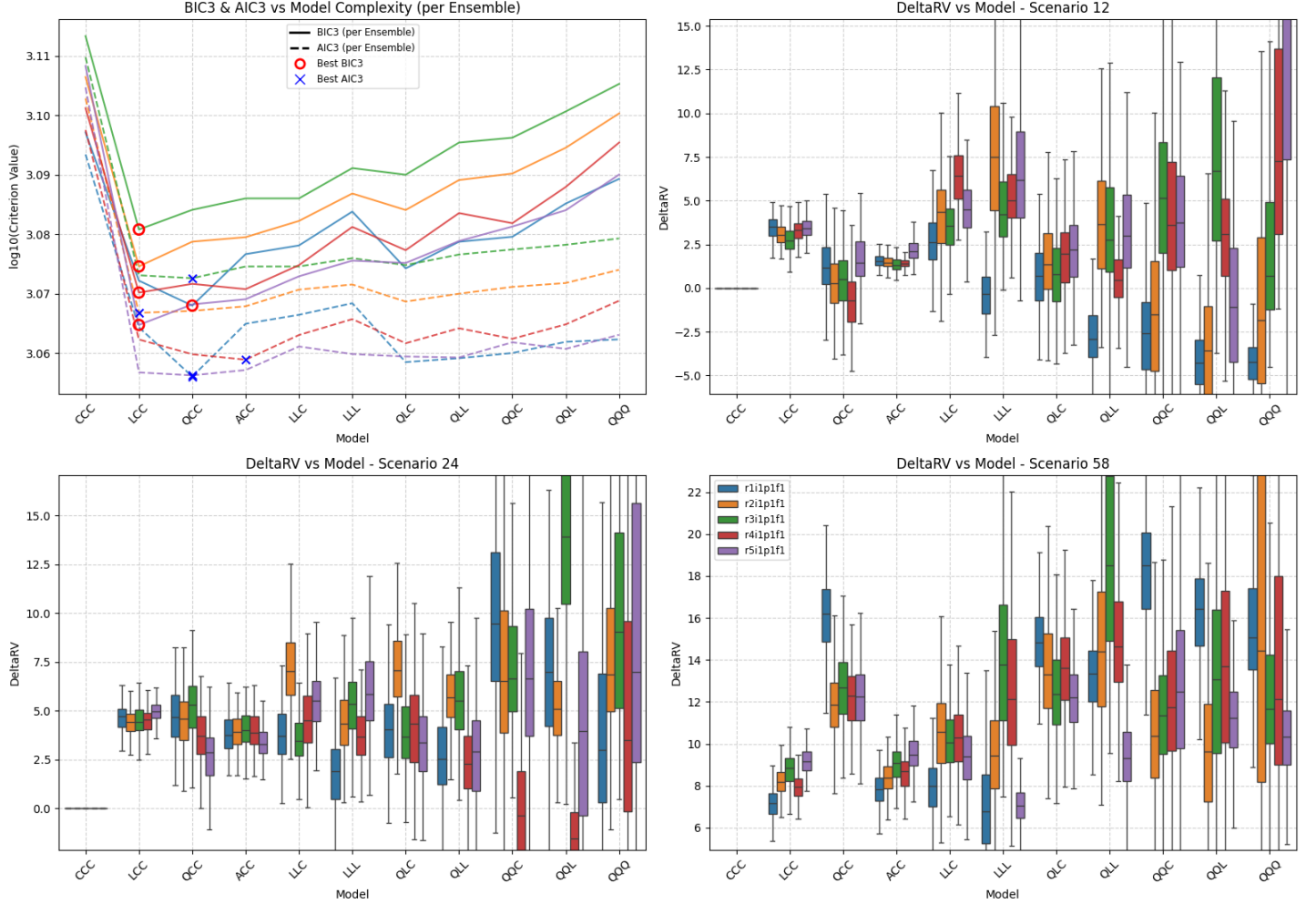


Figure SM27: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the UK region using ACCESS-CM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: UK | GCM: CE | Agg: Mxm

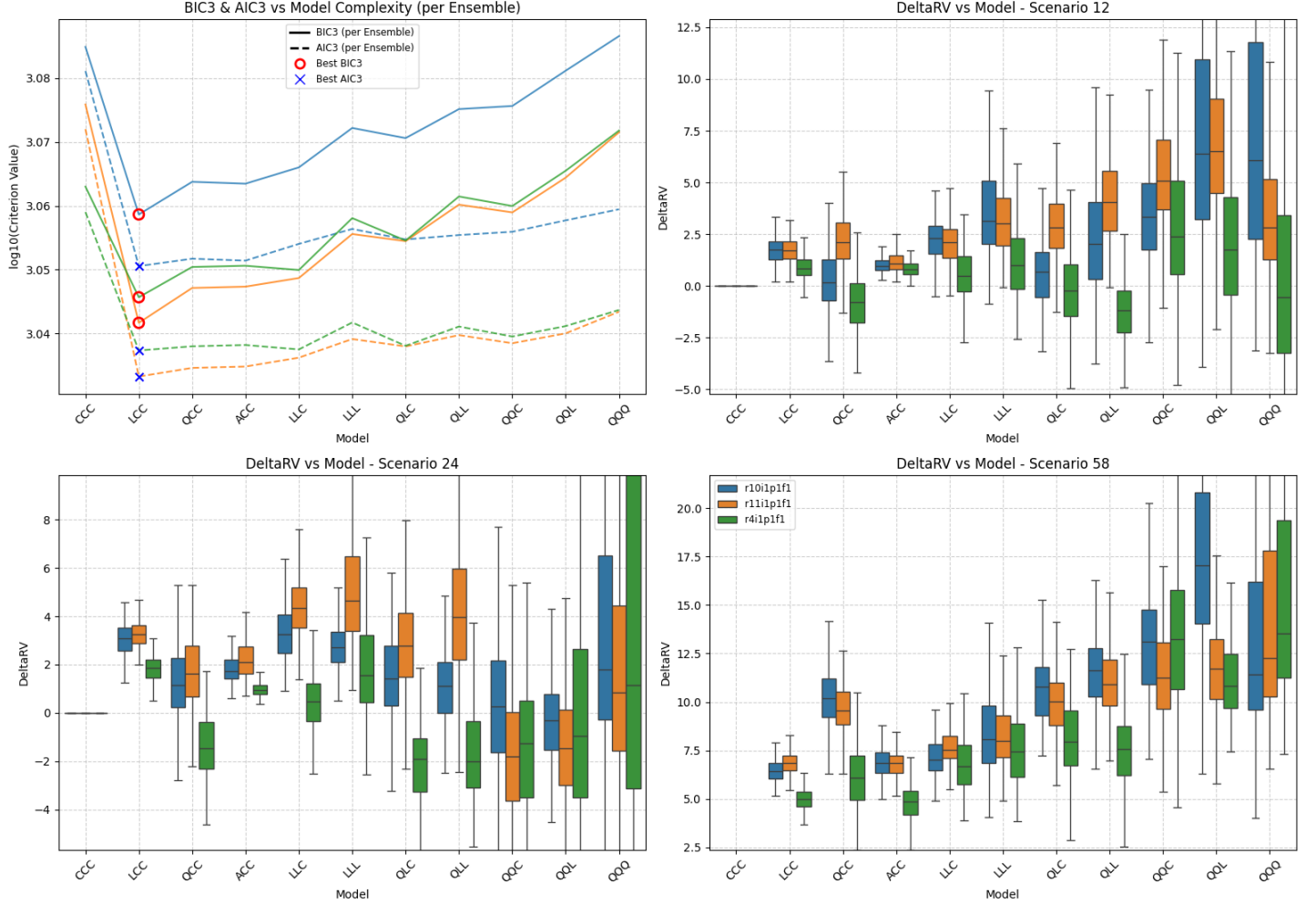


Figure SM28: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the UK region using CESM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: UK | GCM: EC | Agg: Mxm



Location: UK | GCM: MR | Agg: Mxm

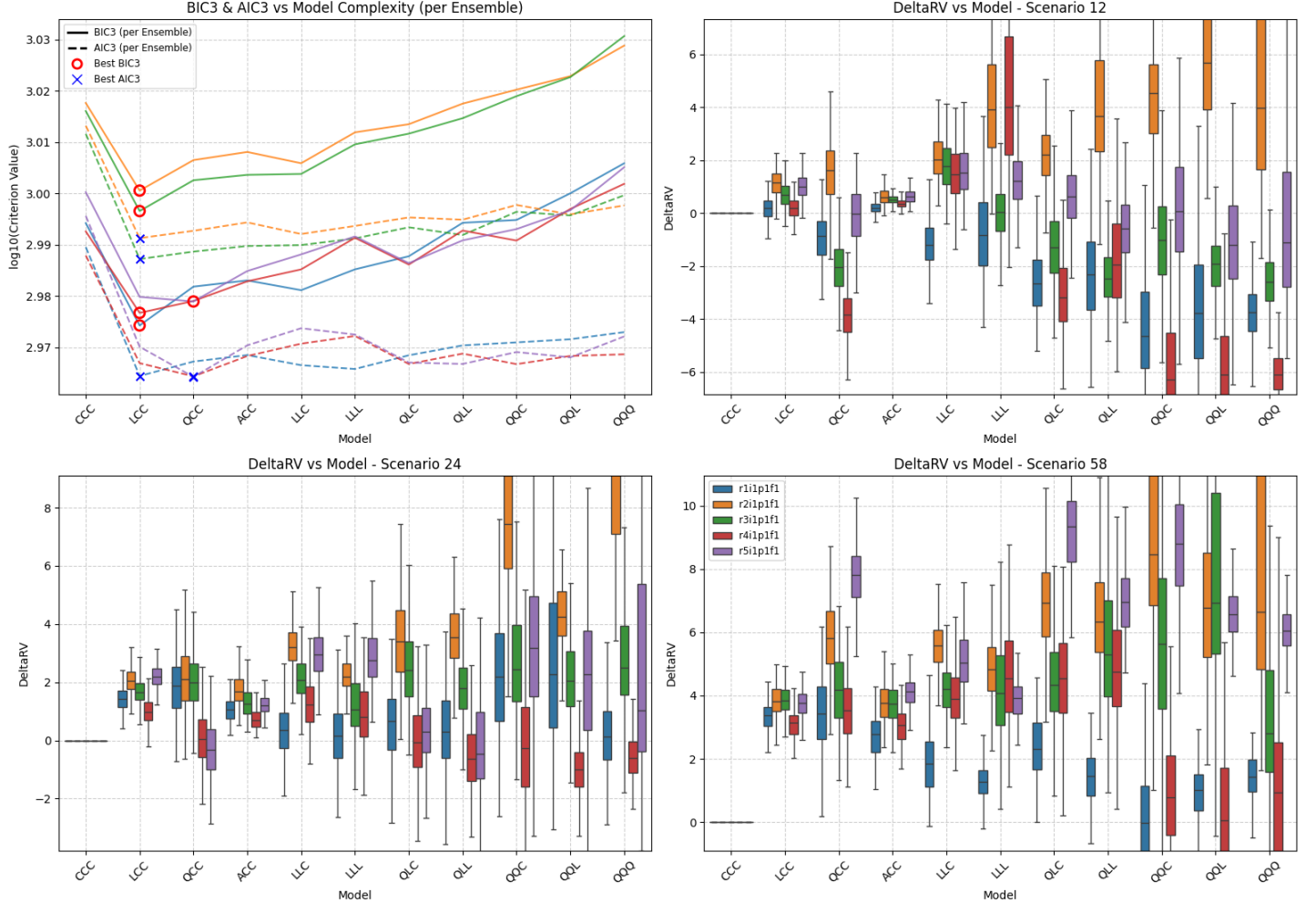


Figure SM30: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the UK region using MRI-ESM2-0 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: UK | GCM: UK | Agg: Mxm

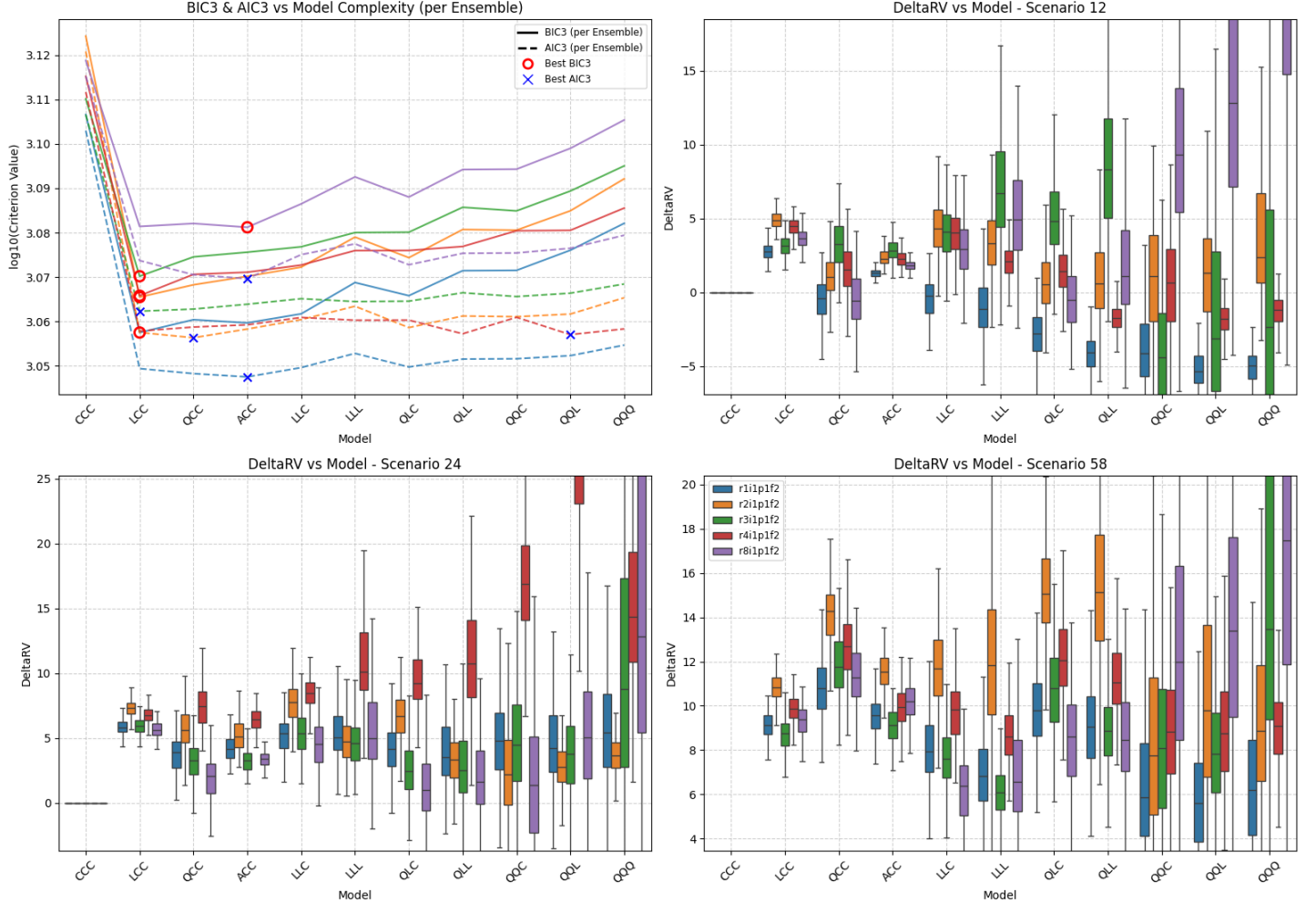


Figure SM31: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual maxima of the UK region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

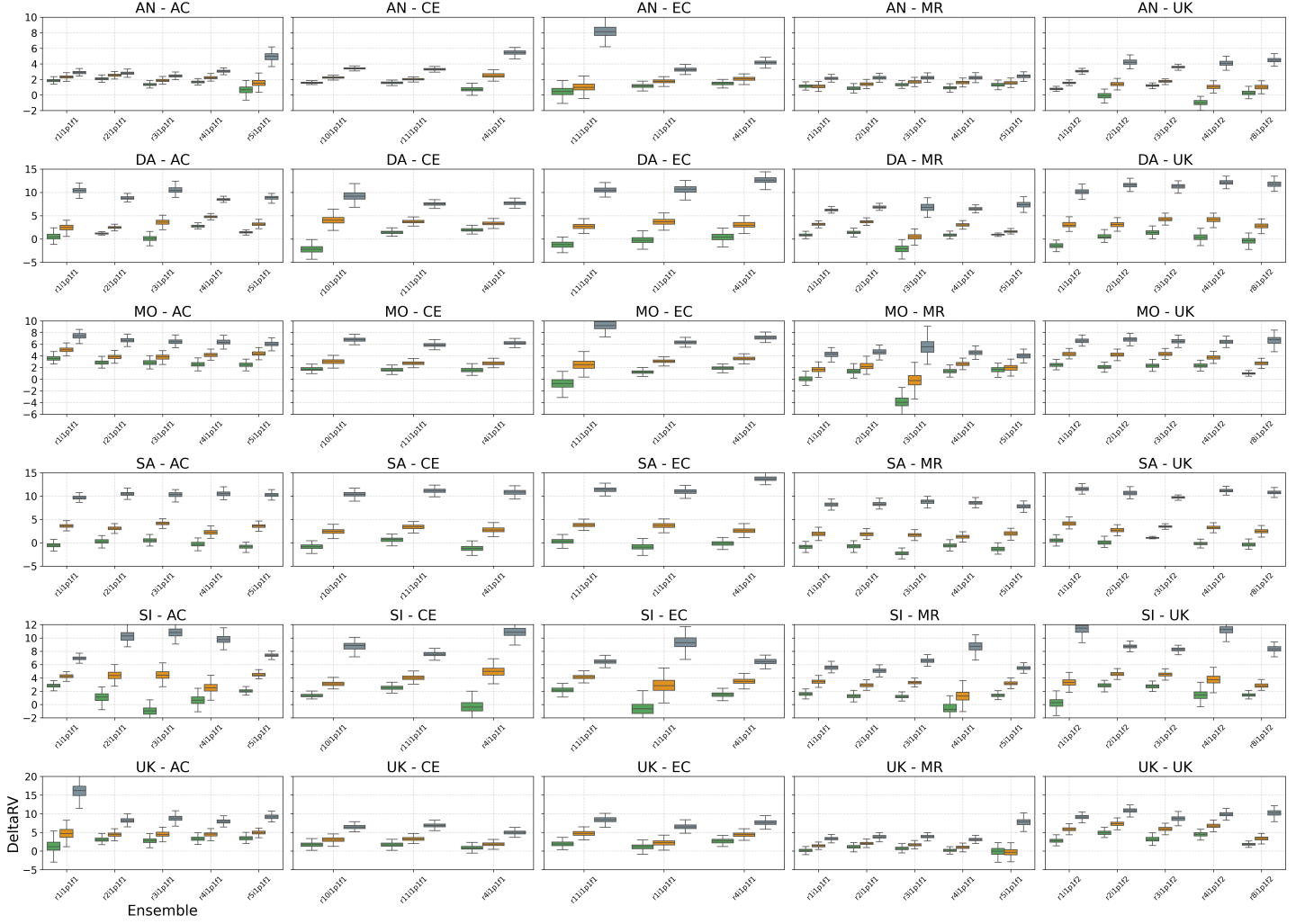


Figure SM32: Summary of inferences for return value differences ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 7) of regional annual maxima using BIC3 for model selection. Each panel shows box-whisker plots summarising the posterior distribution of ΔQ for climate scenarios SSP126 ($j = 1$, green), SSP245 ($j = 2$, orange) and SSP585 ($j = 3$, grey) for each of up to five climate ensembles. Different panels show inferences for specific combinations of regions and locations; see Tables 1 and 2 for region and GCM acronyms.

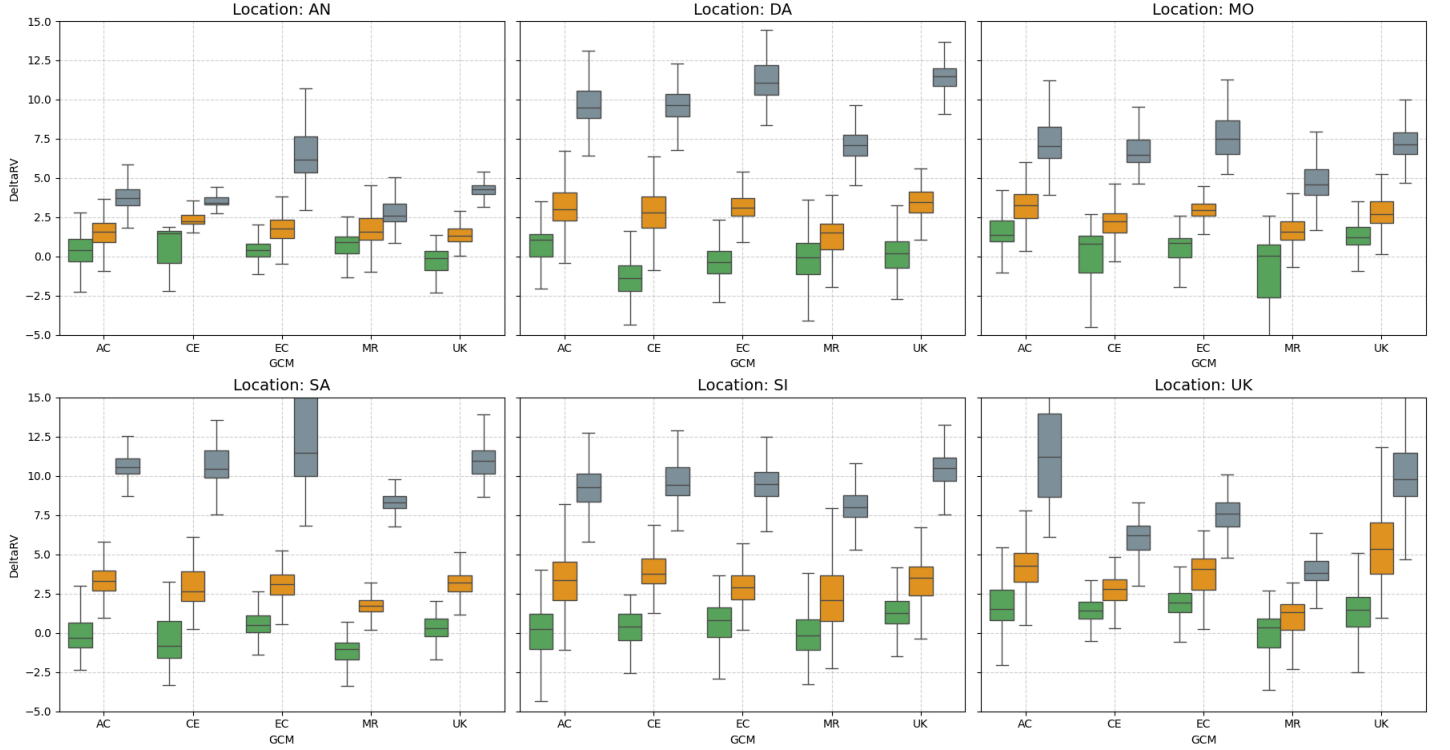


Figure SM33: Summary of inferences for return value differences ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 7) of regional annual maxima using AIC3 for model selection, aggregated over climate ensemble. Each panel shows box-whisker plots summarising the posterior distribution of ΔQ for climate scenarios SSP126 ($j = 1$, green), SSP245 ($j = 2$, orange) and SSP585 ($j = 3$, grey) and each of five GCMs (ACCESS-CM2, CESM2, EC-Earth3, MRI-ESM2-0, UKESM1-0-LL). Left to right, top to bottom, panels show inferences for the Antarctic, Dasht-e Lut, Mojave, Sahara, Simpson and UK regions. For comparison with Figure 7.



Figure SM34: Summary of inferences for return value differences ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 7) of regional annual maxima using AIC3 for model selection. Each panel shows box-whisker plots summarising the posterior distribution of ΔQ for climate scenarios SSP126 ($j = 1$, green), SSP245 ($j = 2$, orange) and SSP585 ($j = 3$, grey) for each of up to five climate ensembles. Different panels show inferences for specific combinations of regions and locations; see Tables 1 and 2 for region and GCM acronyms.

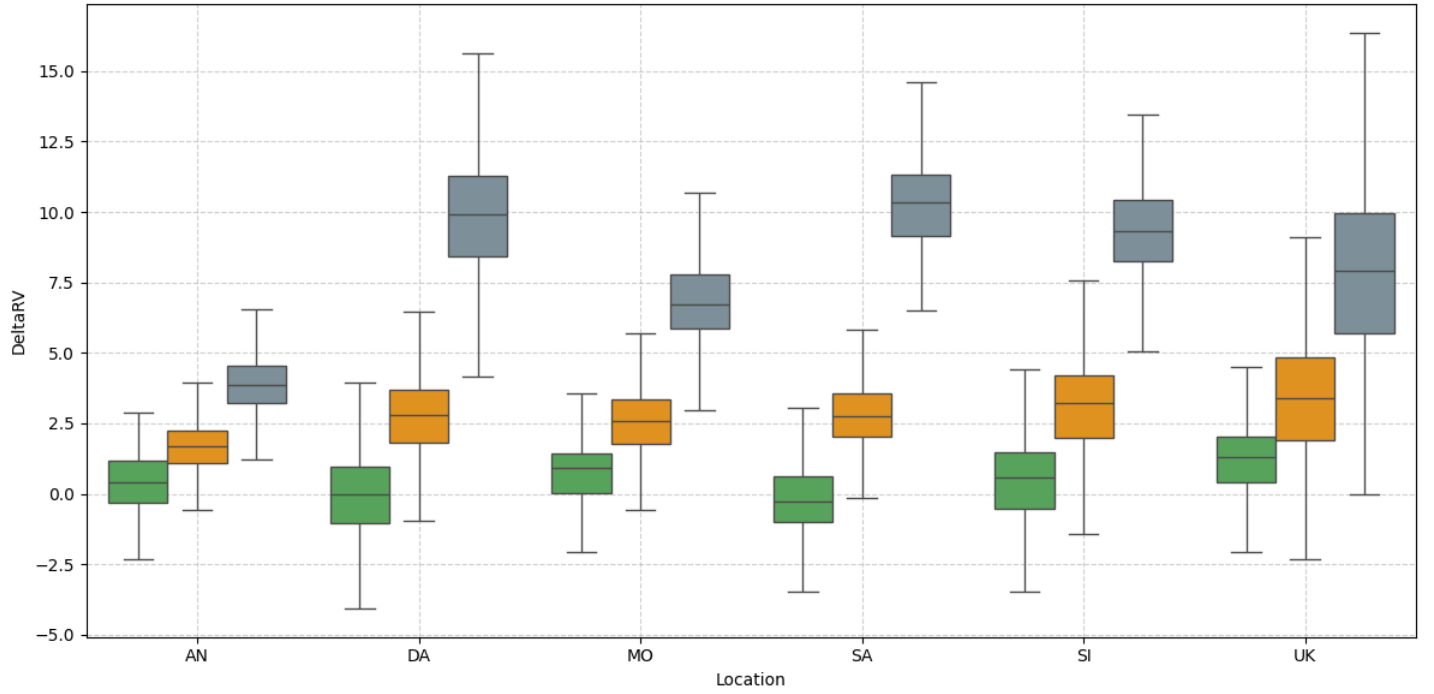
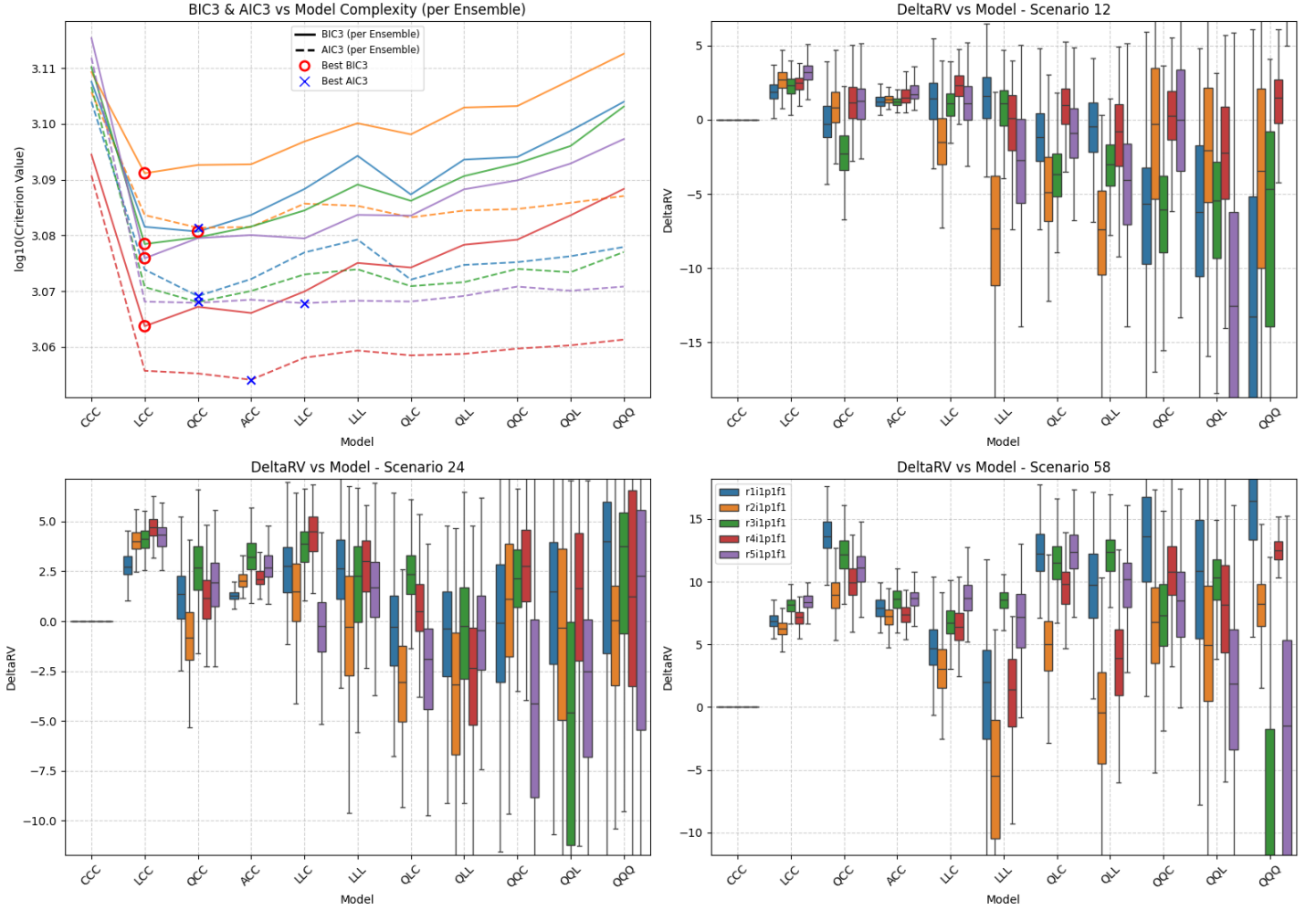


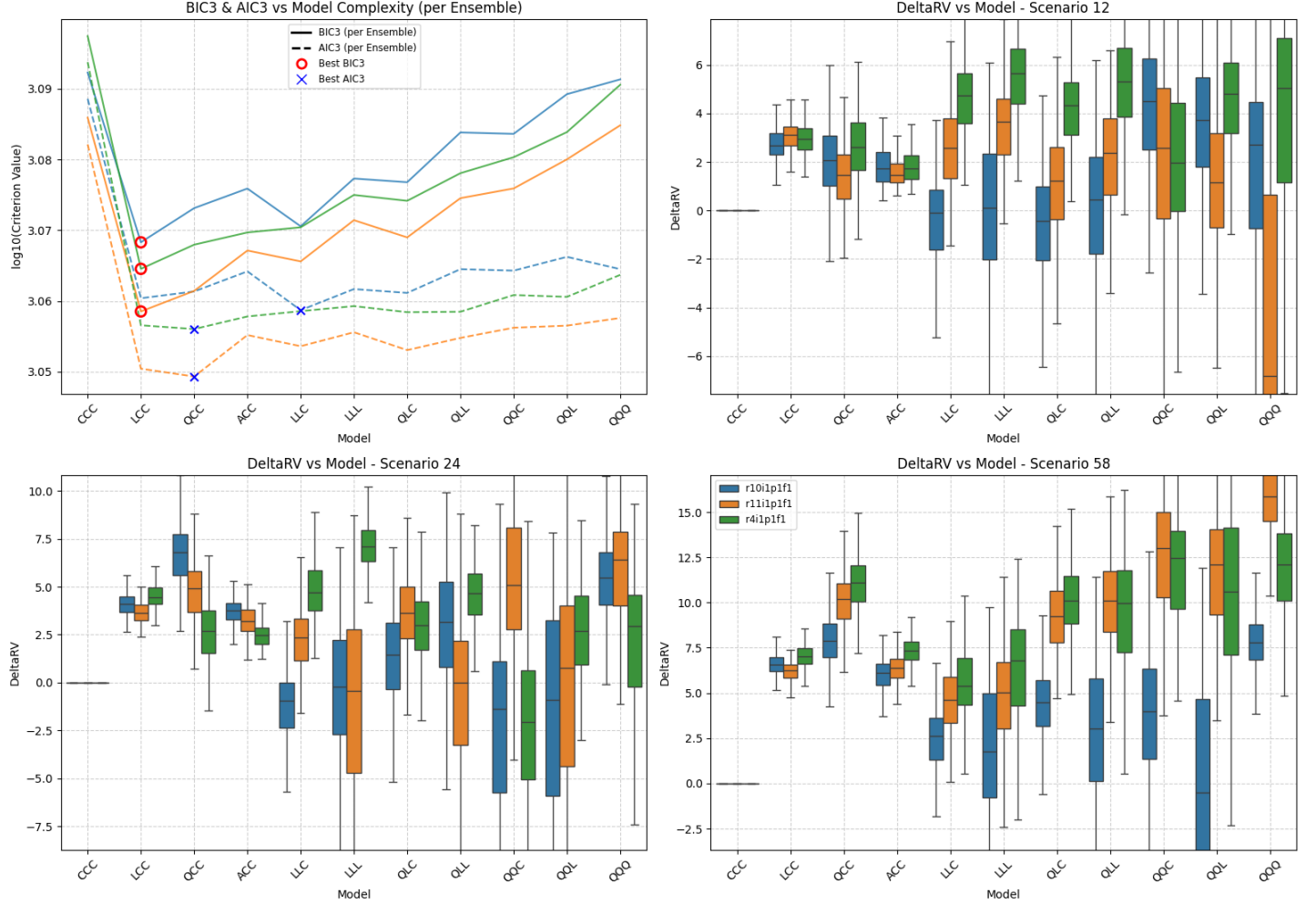
Figure SM35: Summary of inferences for return value differences ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 7) of regional annual maxima using AIC3 for model selection, aggregated over climate ensemble and GCM. Box-whisker plots summarise the posterior distribution of ΔQ for climate scenarios SSP126 ($j = 1$, green), SSP245 ($j = 2$, orange) and SSP585 ($j = 3$, grey) for the Antarctic, Dasht-e Lut, Mojave, Sahara, Simpson and UK regions.

SM5 Results for regional annual minima

Location: AN | GCM: AC | Agg: Mnm



Location: AN | GCM: CE | Agg: Mnm



Location: AN | GCM: EC | Agg: Mnm

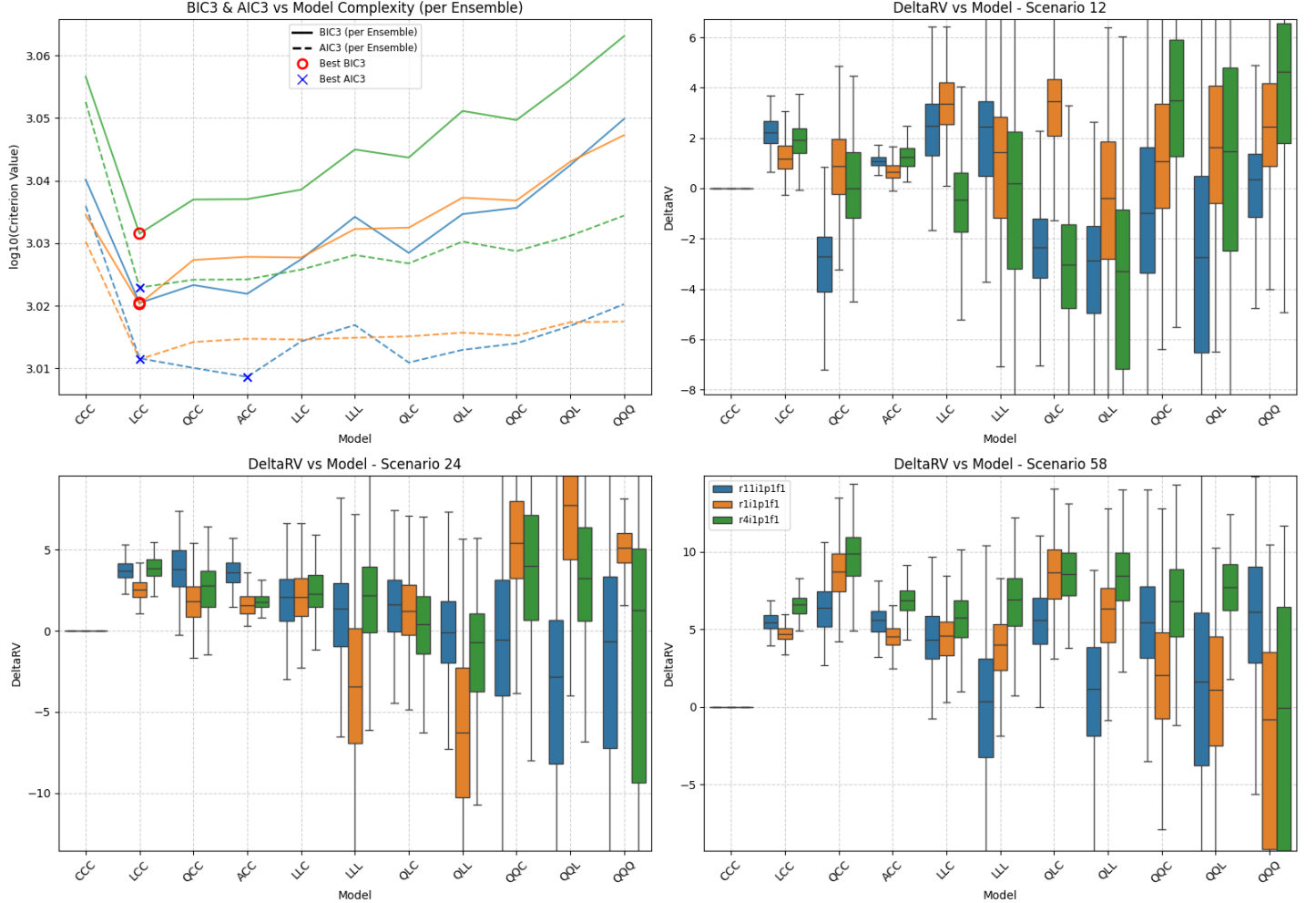


Figure SM38: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Antarctic region using EC-Earth3 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: AN | GCM: MR | Agg: Mnm

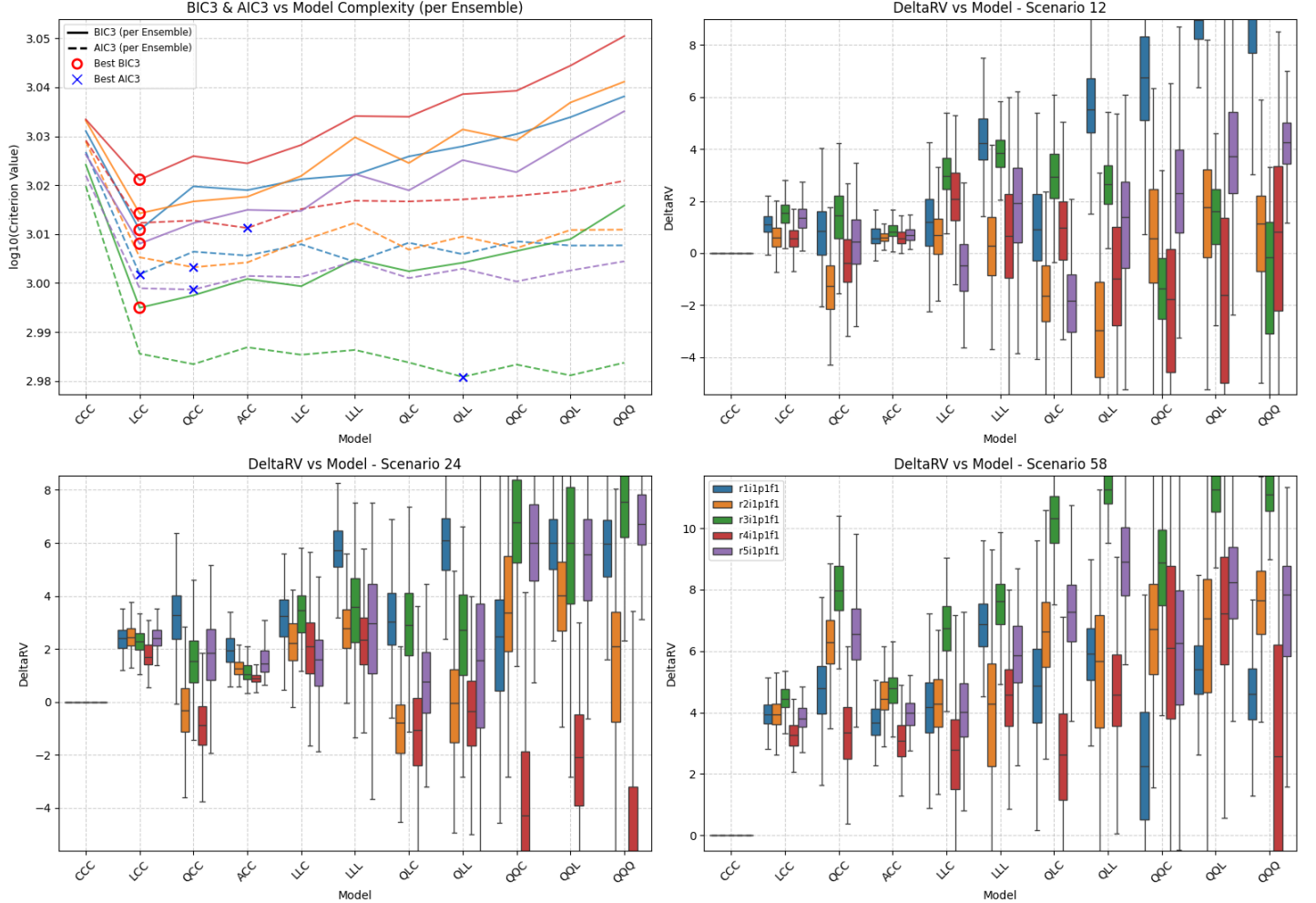


Figure SM39: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Antarctic region using MRI-ESM2-0 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: AN | GCM: UK | Agg: Mnm

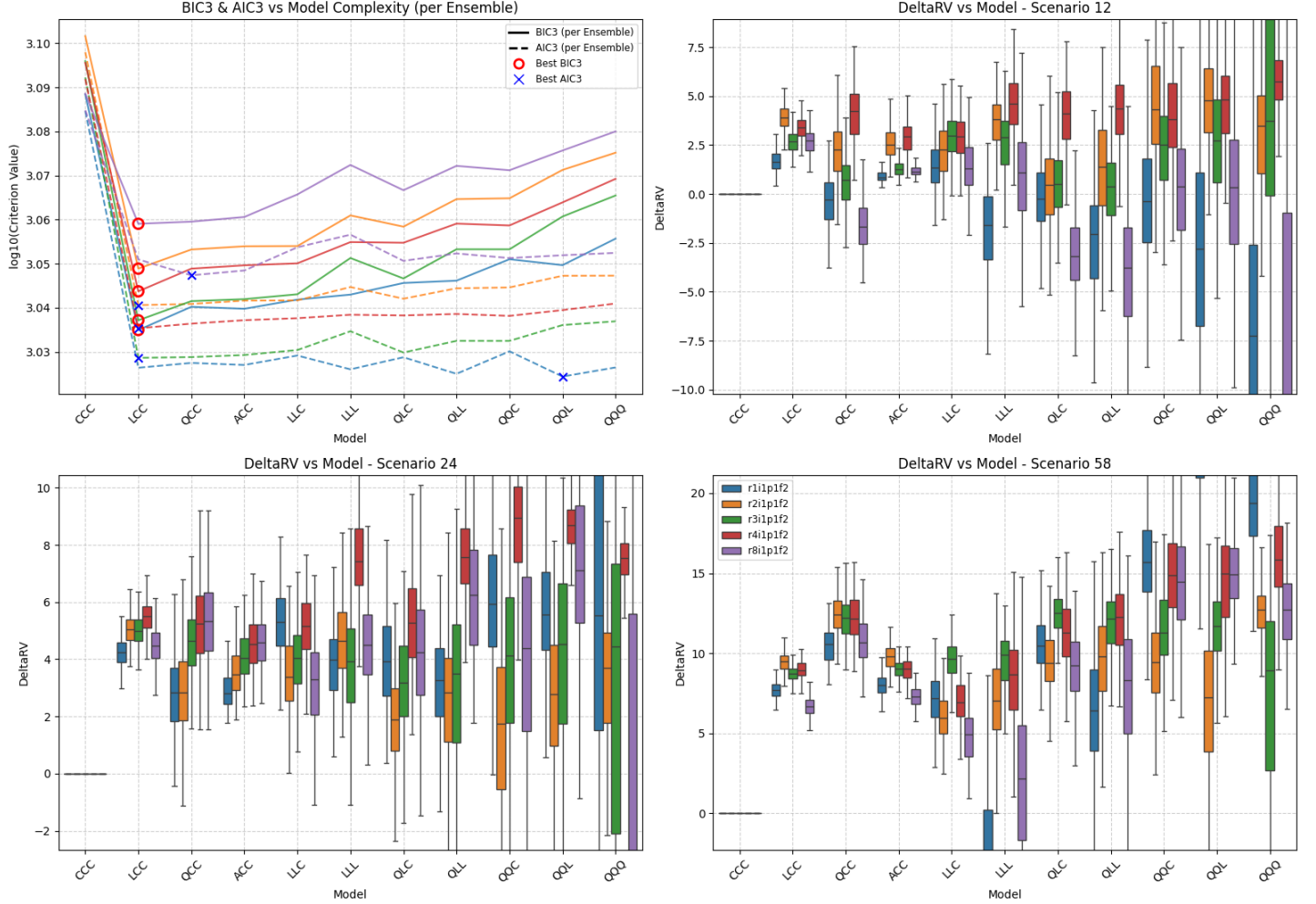


Figure SM40: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Antarctic region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: DA | GCM: AC | Agg: Mnm

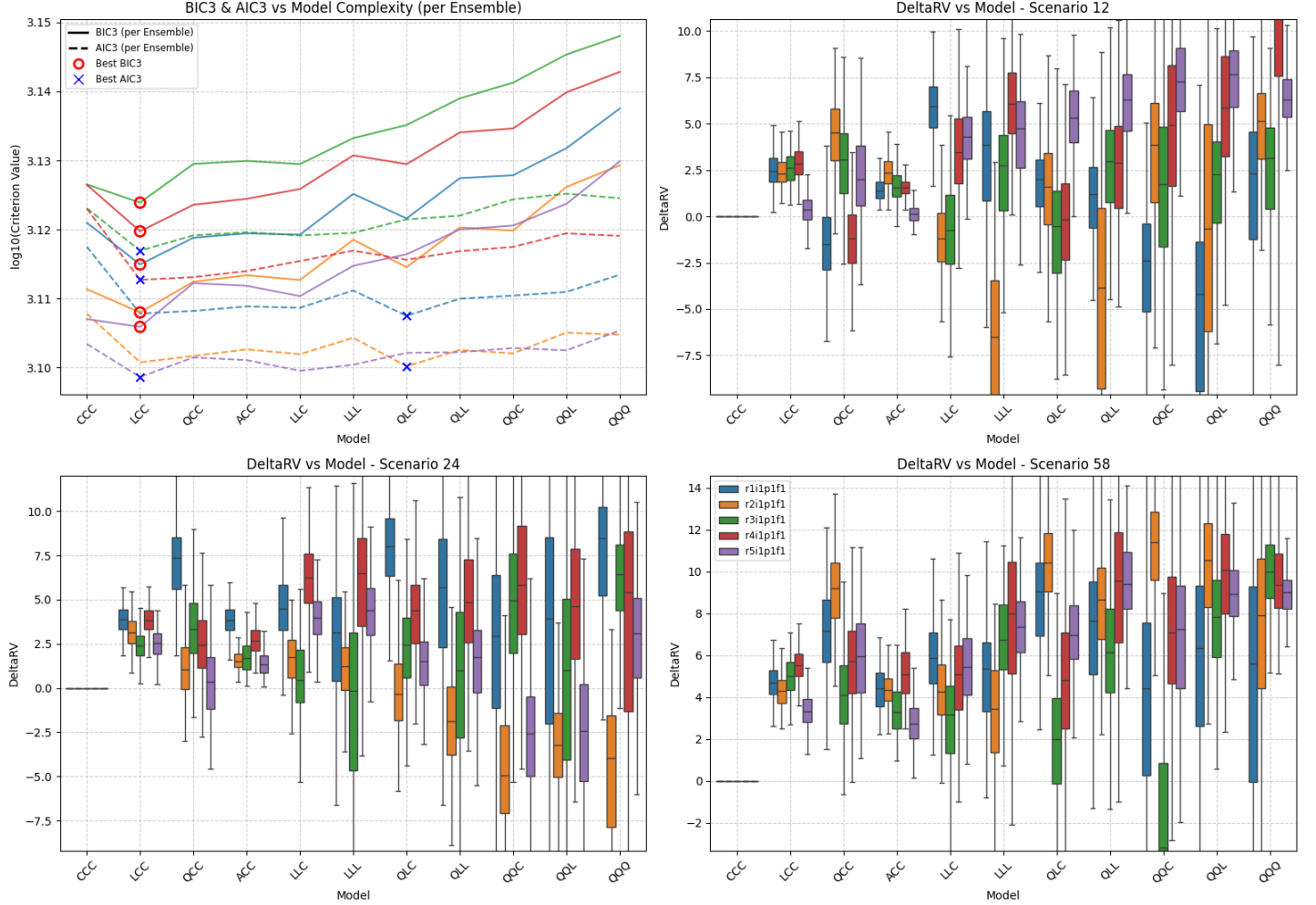


Figure SM41: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Dasht-e Lut region using ACCESS-CM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: DA | GCM: CE | Agg: Mnm

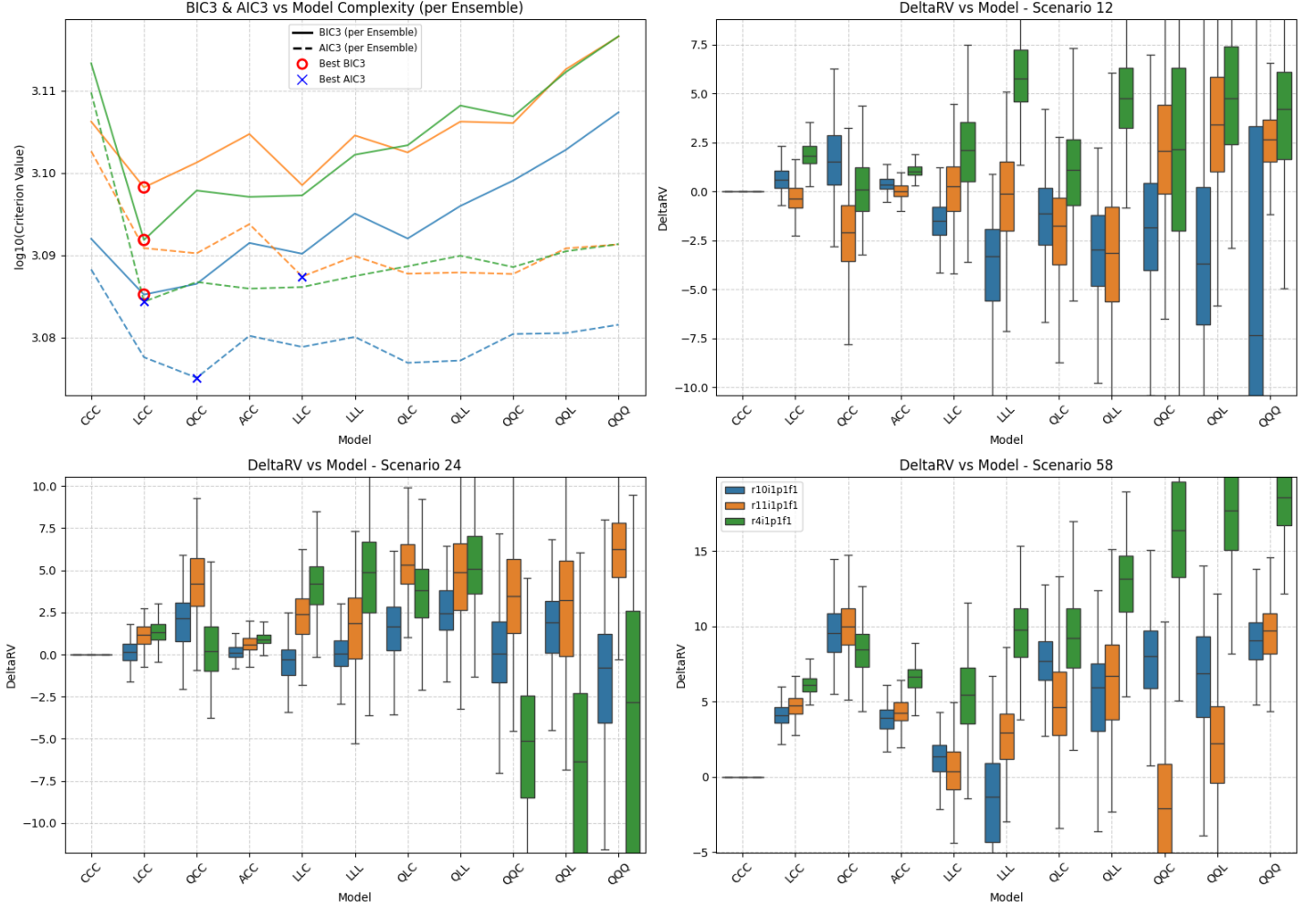


Figure SM42: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Dasht-e Lut region using CESM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: DA | GCM: EC | Agg: Mnm

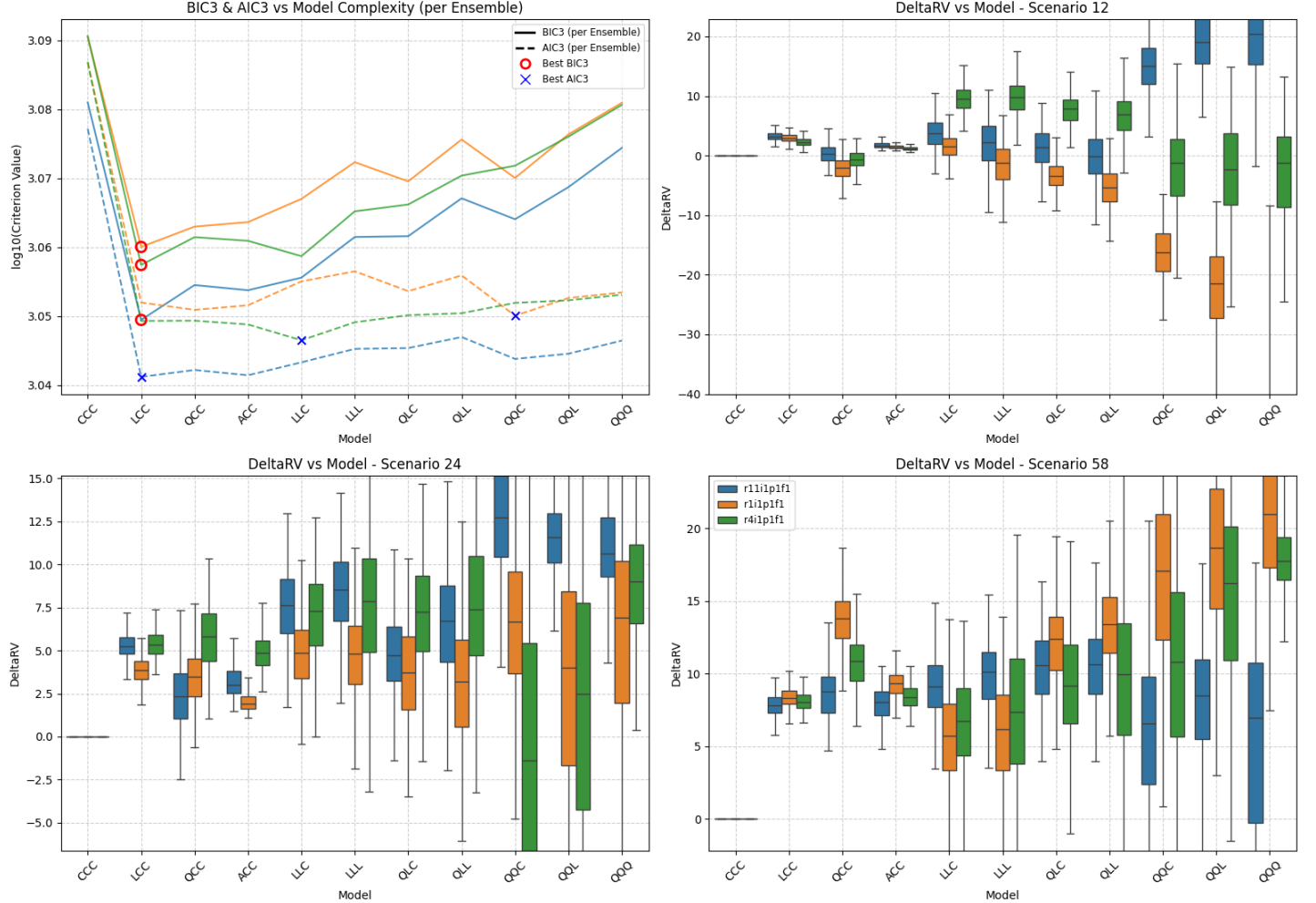


Figure SM43: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Dasht-e Lut region using **EC-Earth3** GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario **SSP126** as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios **SSP245** (ΔQ_2) and **SSP585** (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: DA | GCM: MR | Agg: Mnm

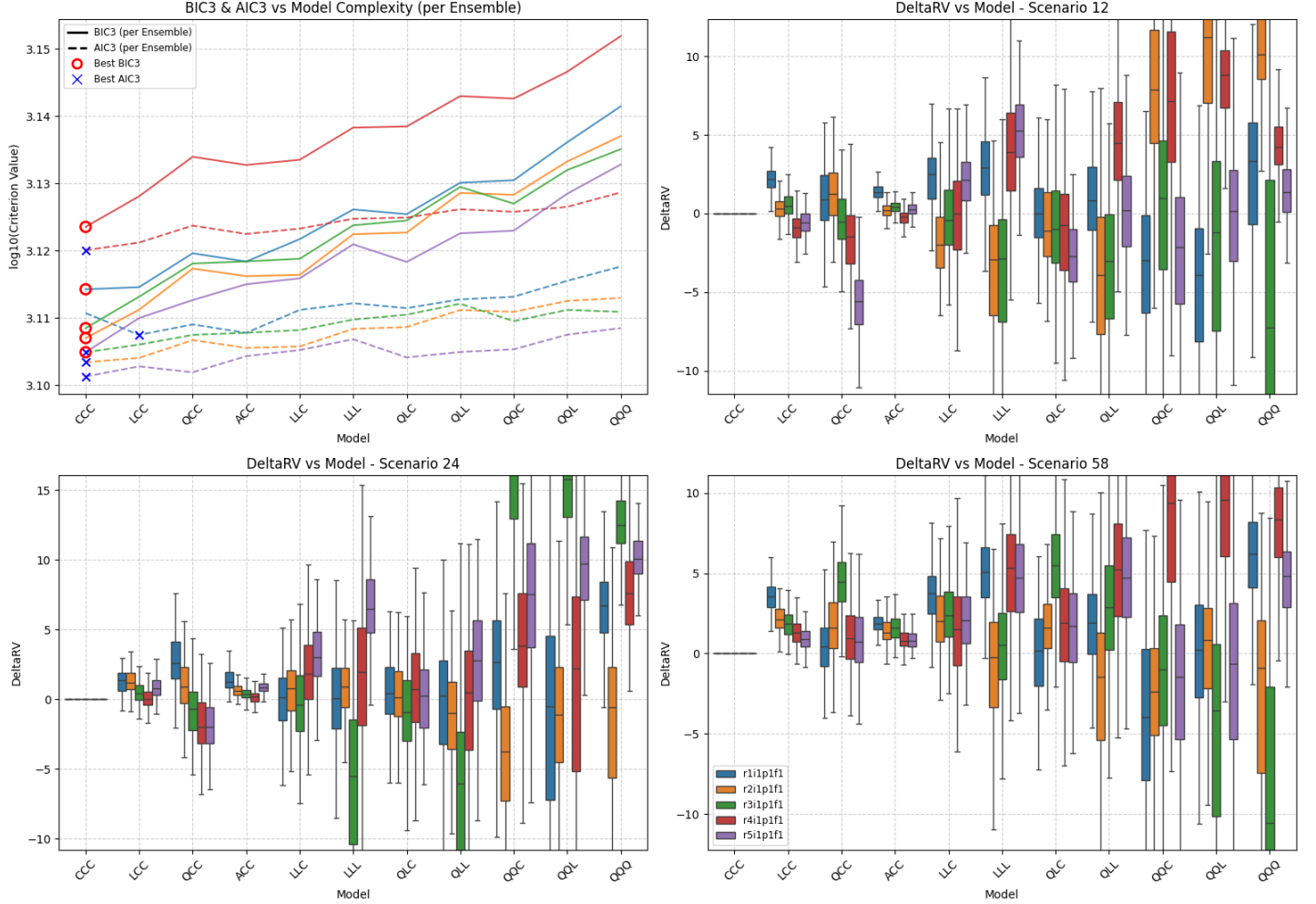


Figure SM44: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Dasht-e Lut region using MRI-ESM2-0 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

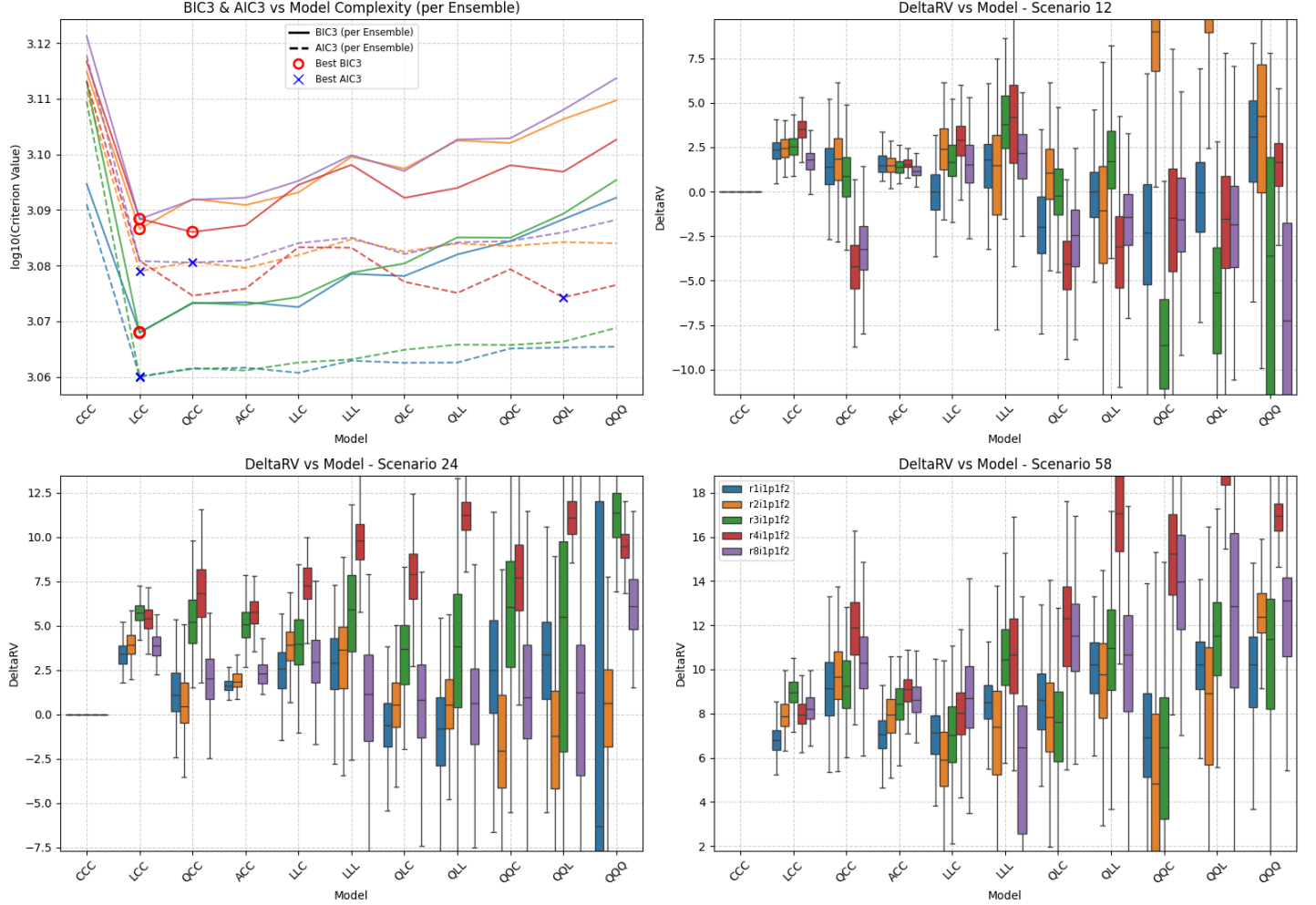


Figure SM45: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Dasht-e Lut region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: MO | GCM: AC | Agg: Mnm

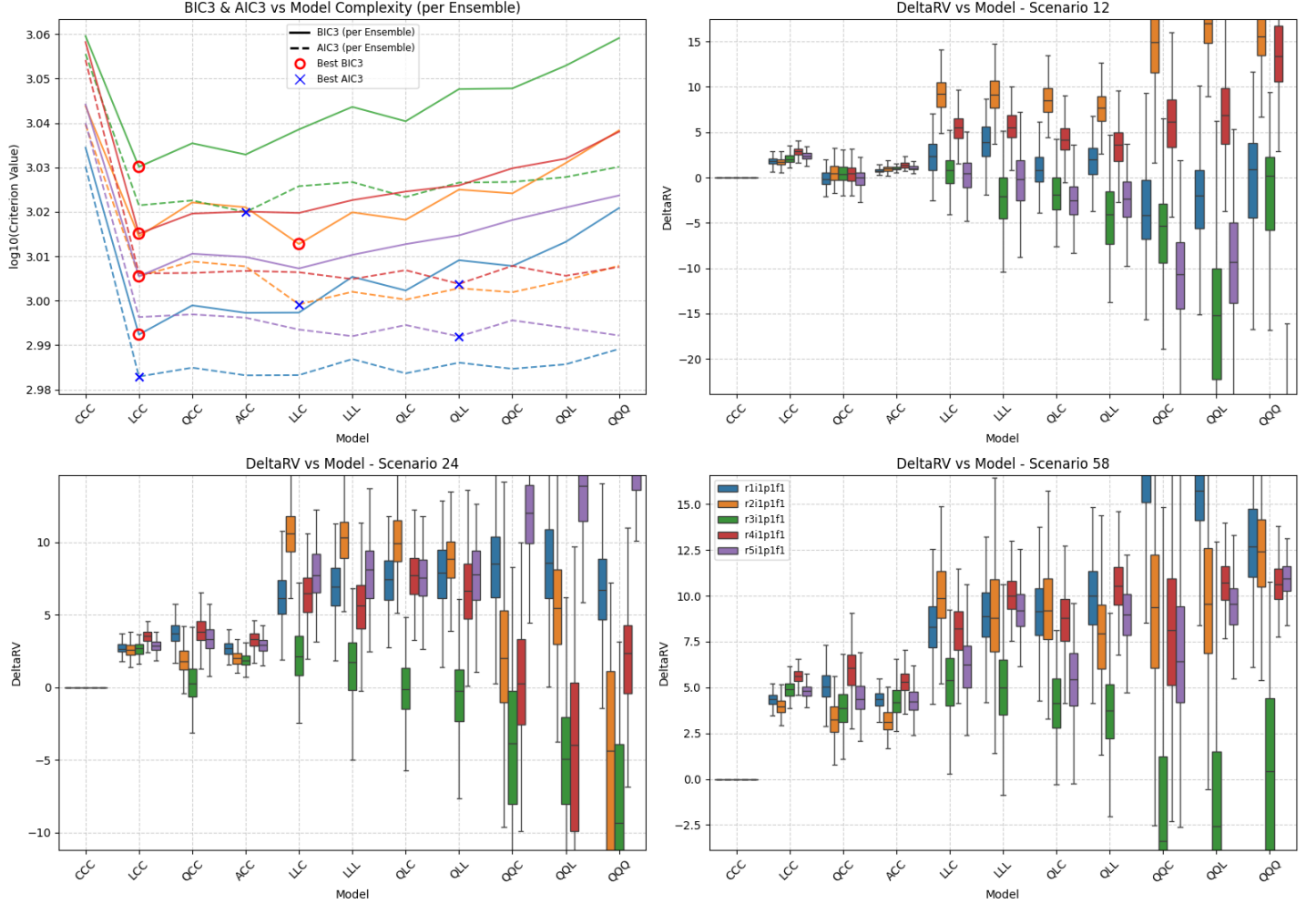
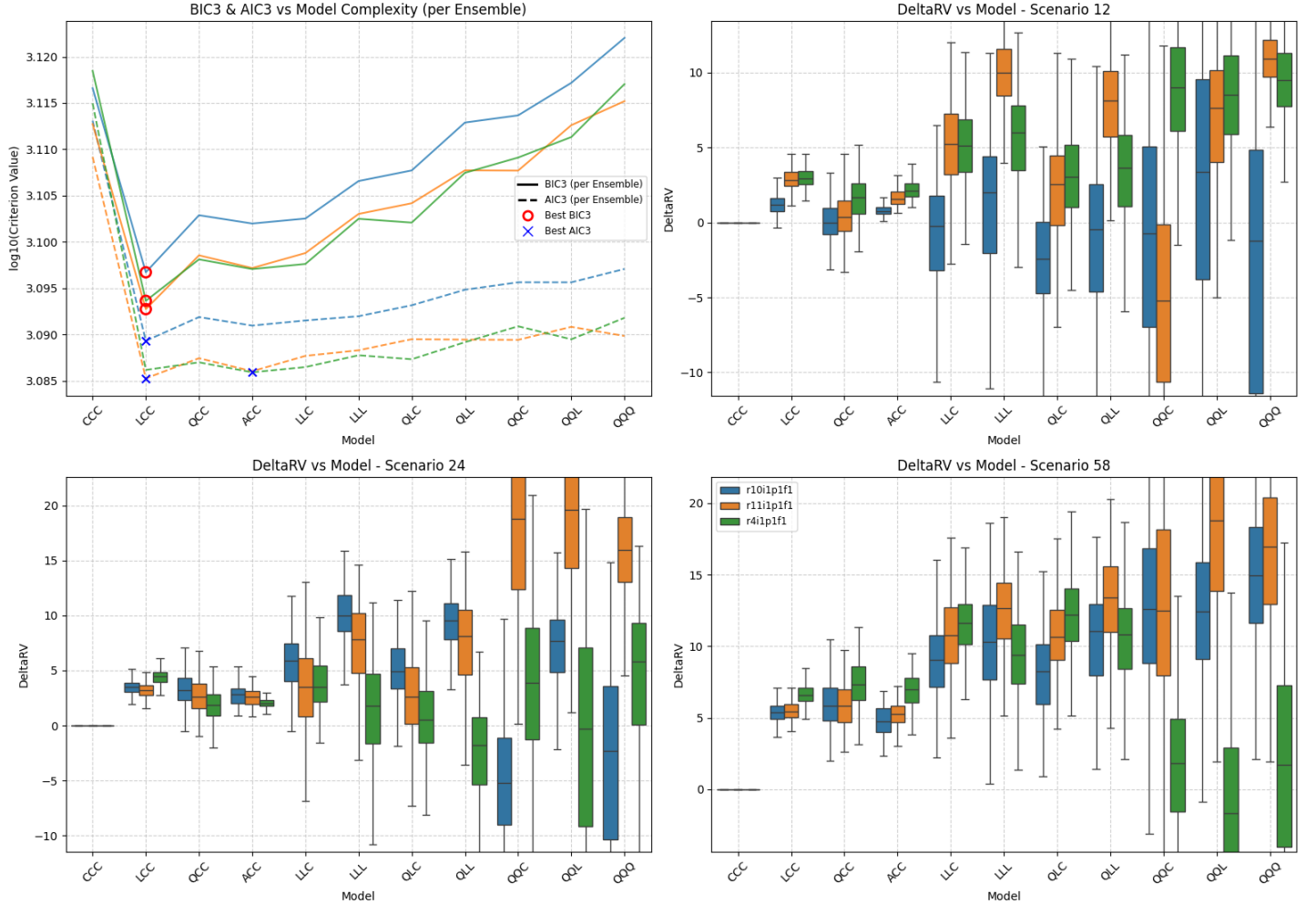


Figure SM46: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Mojave region using ACCESS-CM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.



Location: MO | GCM: EC | Agg: Mnm

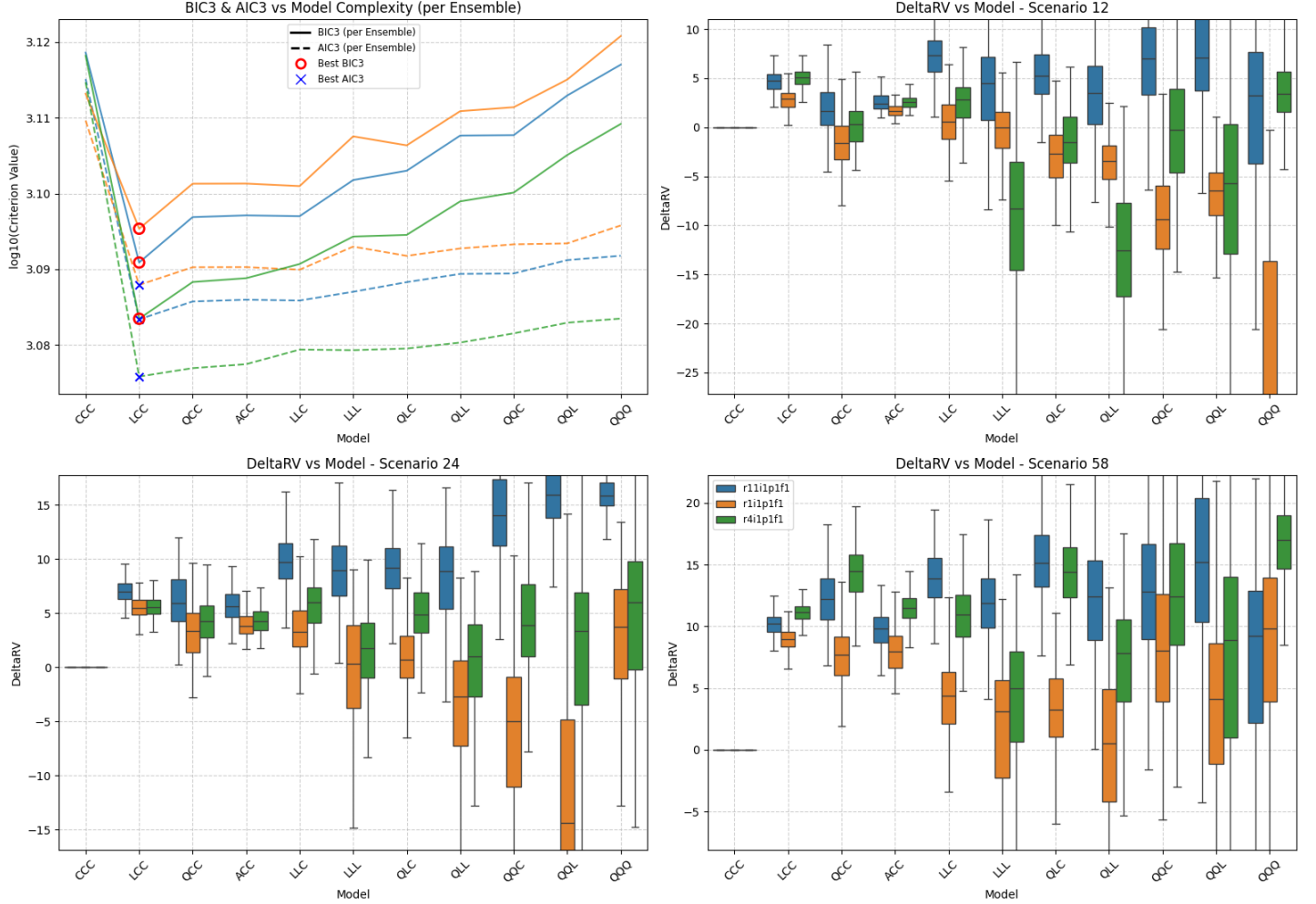


Figure SM48: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Mojave region using **EC-Earth3** GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario **SSP126** as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios **SSP245** (ΔQ_2) and **SSP585** (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: MO | GCM: MR | Agg: Mnm

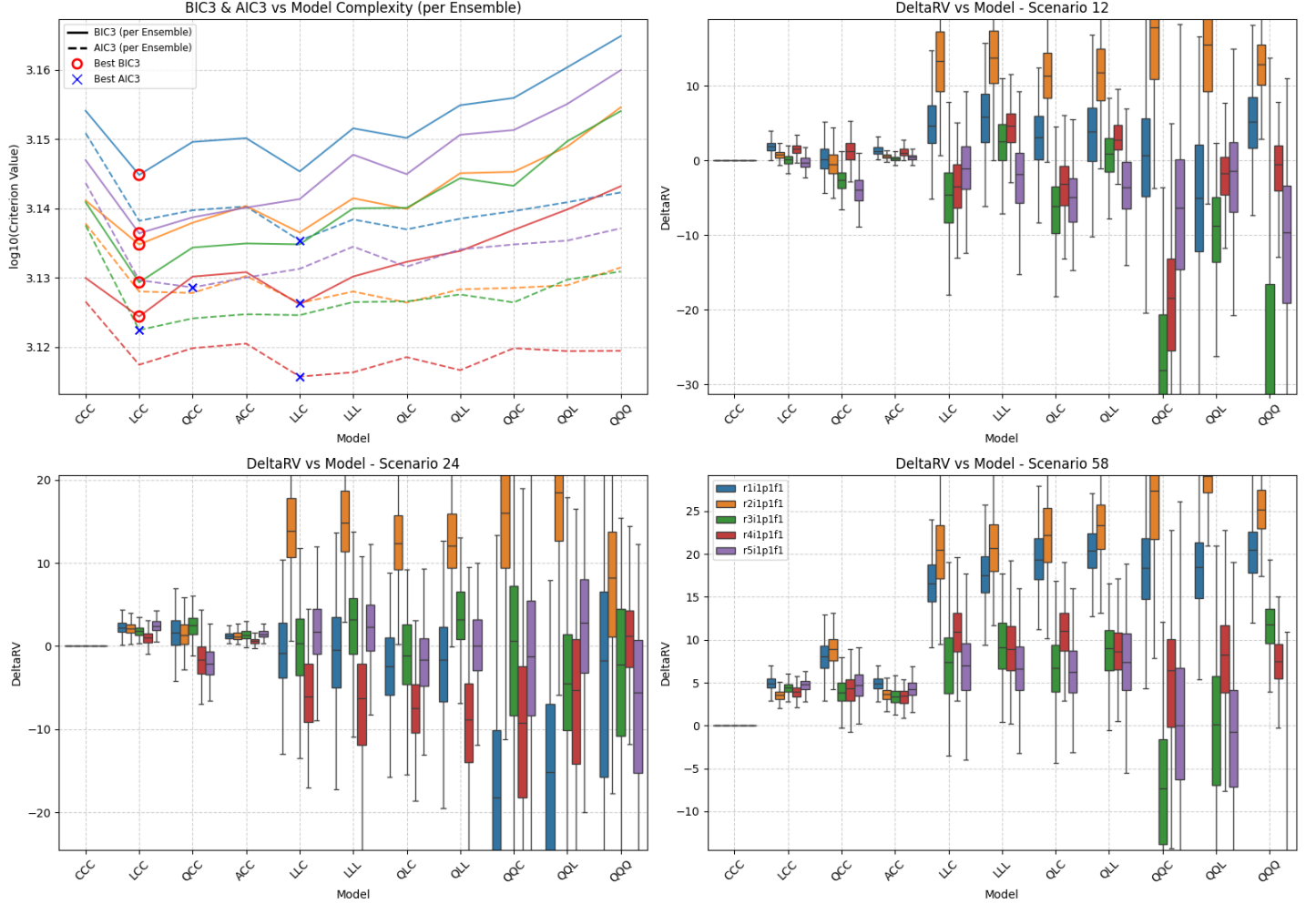


Figure SM49: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Mojave region using MRI-ESM2-0 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: MO | GCM: UK | Agg: Mnm

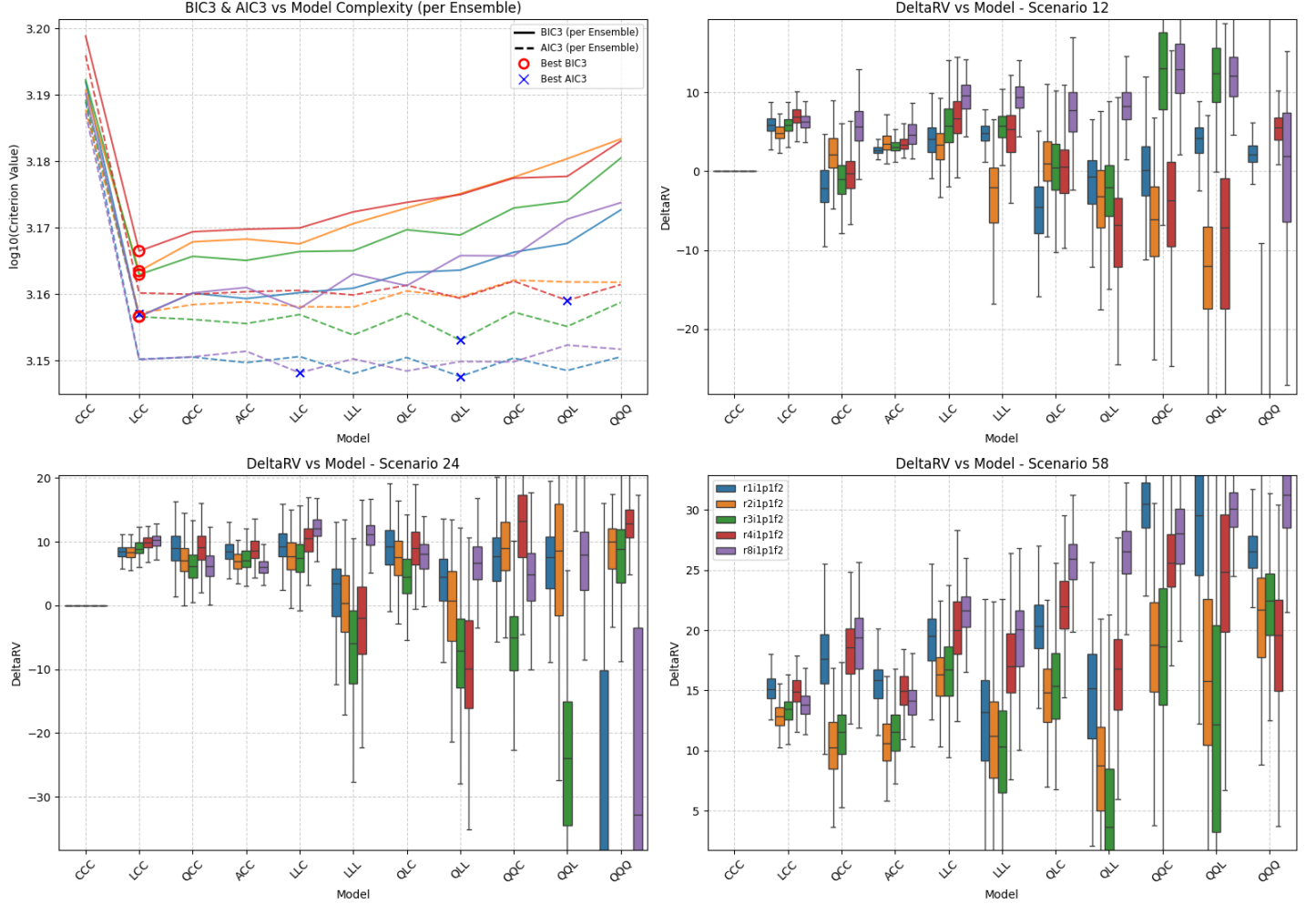


Figure SM50: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Mojave region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SA | GCM: AC | Agg: Mnm

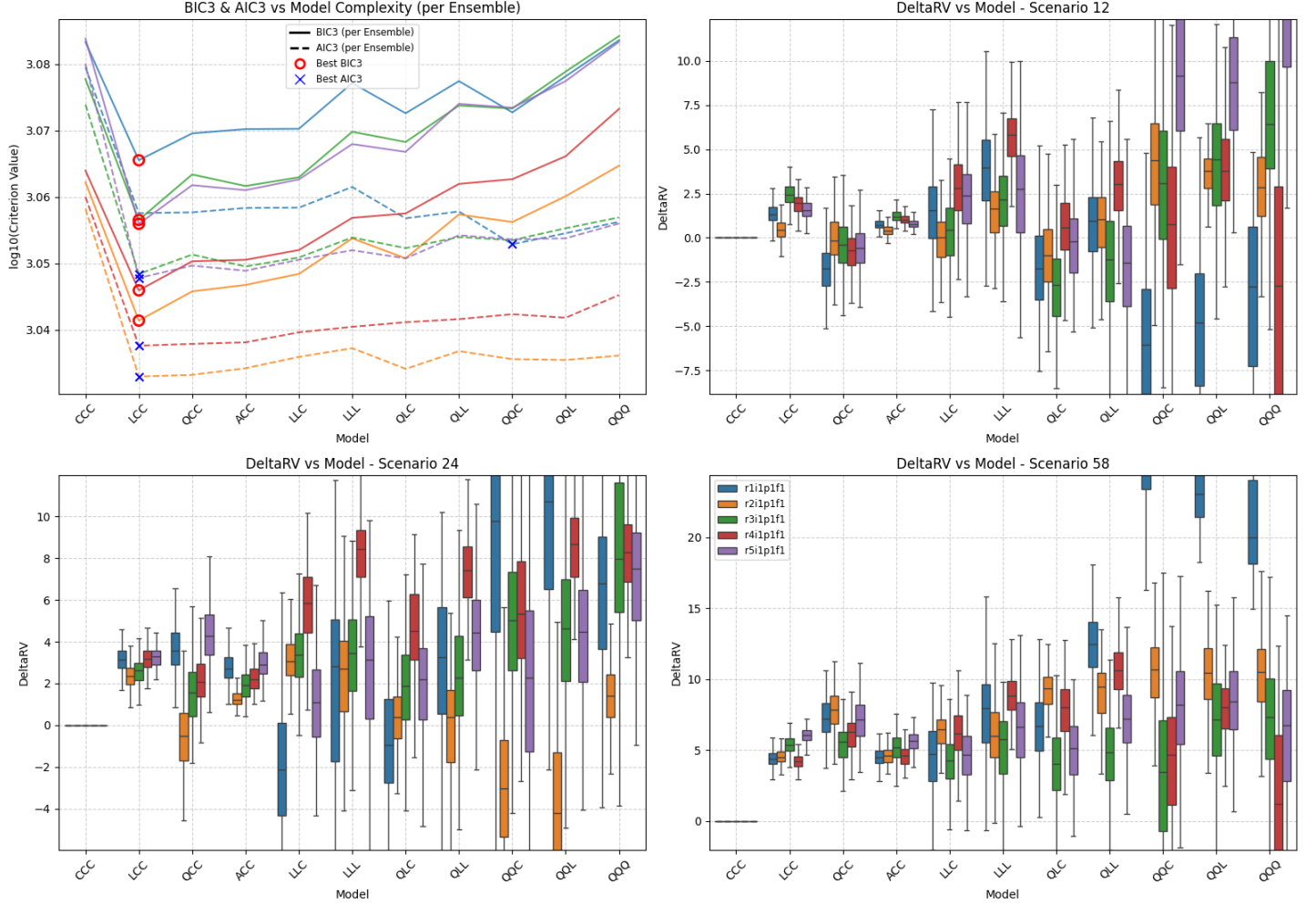


Figure SM51: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Sahara region using ACCESS-CM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SA | GCM: CE | Agg: Mnm

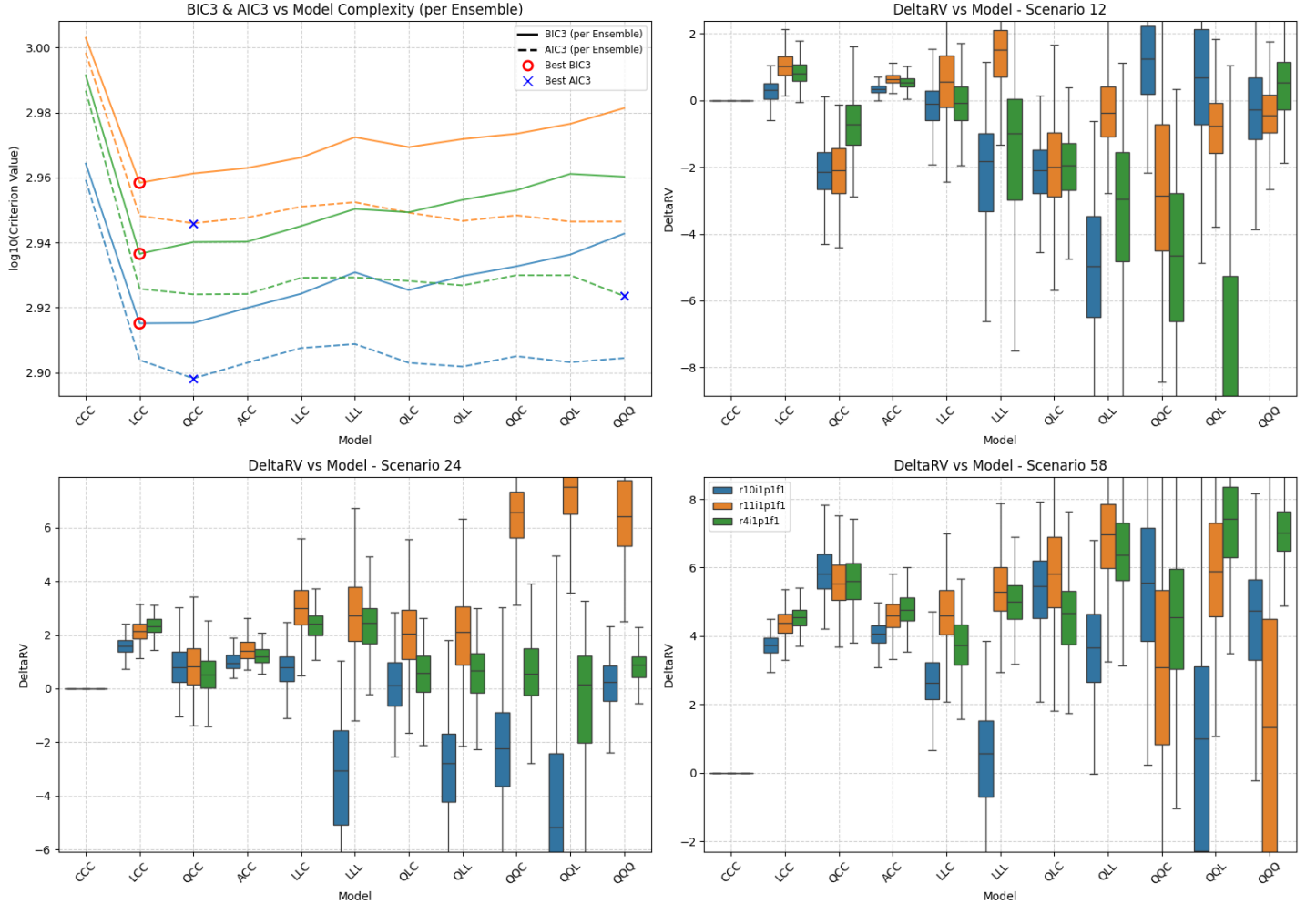


Figure SM52: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Sahara region using CESM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SA | GCM: EC | Agg: Mnm

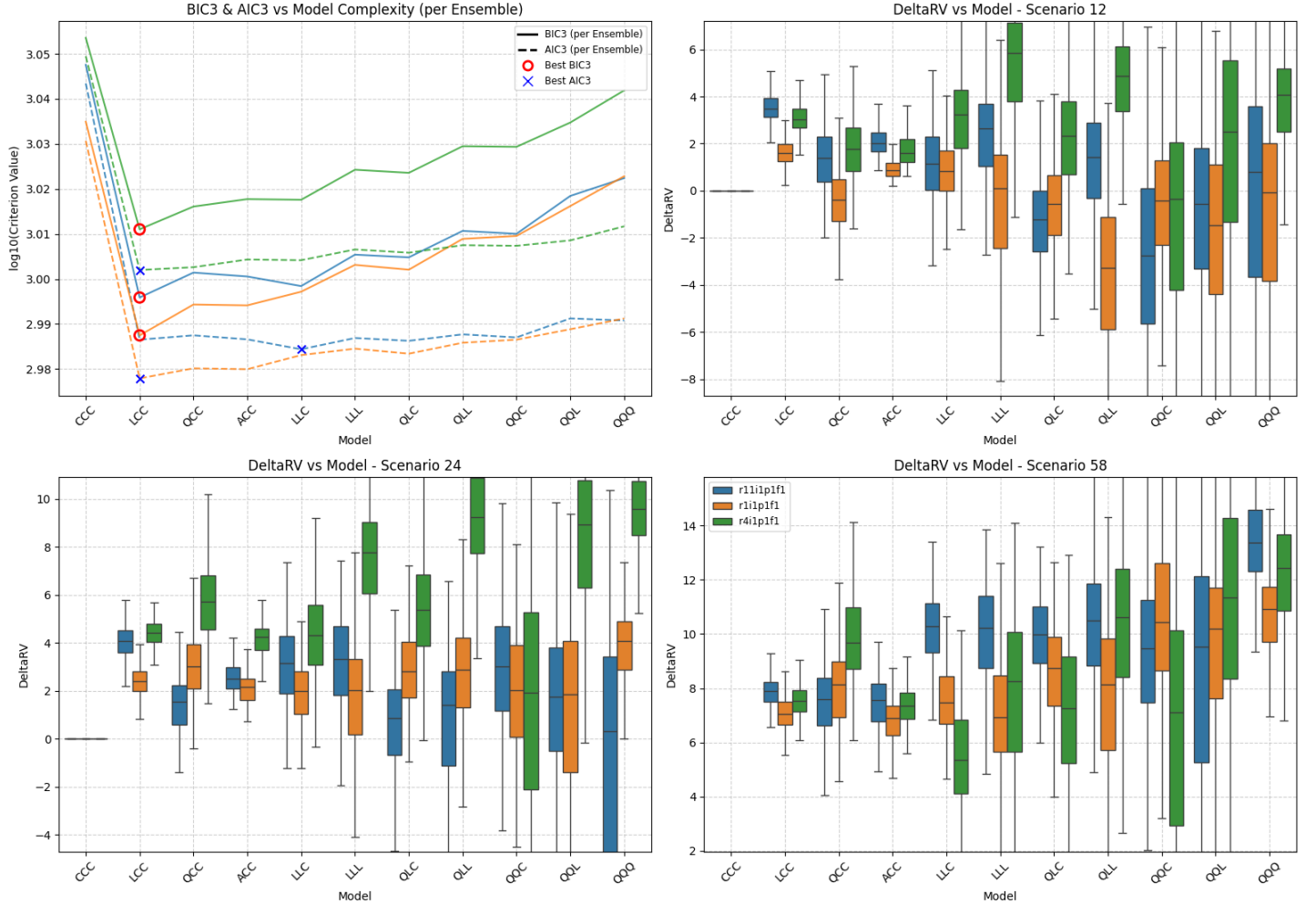


Figure SM53: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Sahara region using EC-Earth3 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

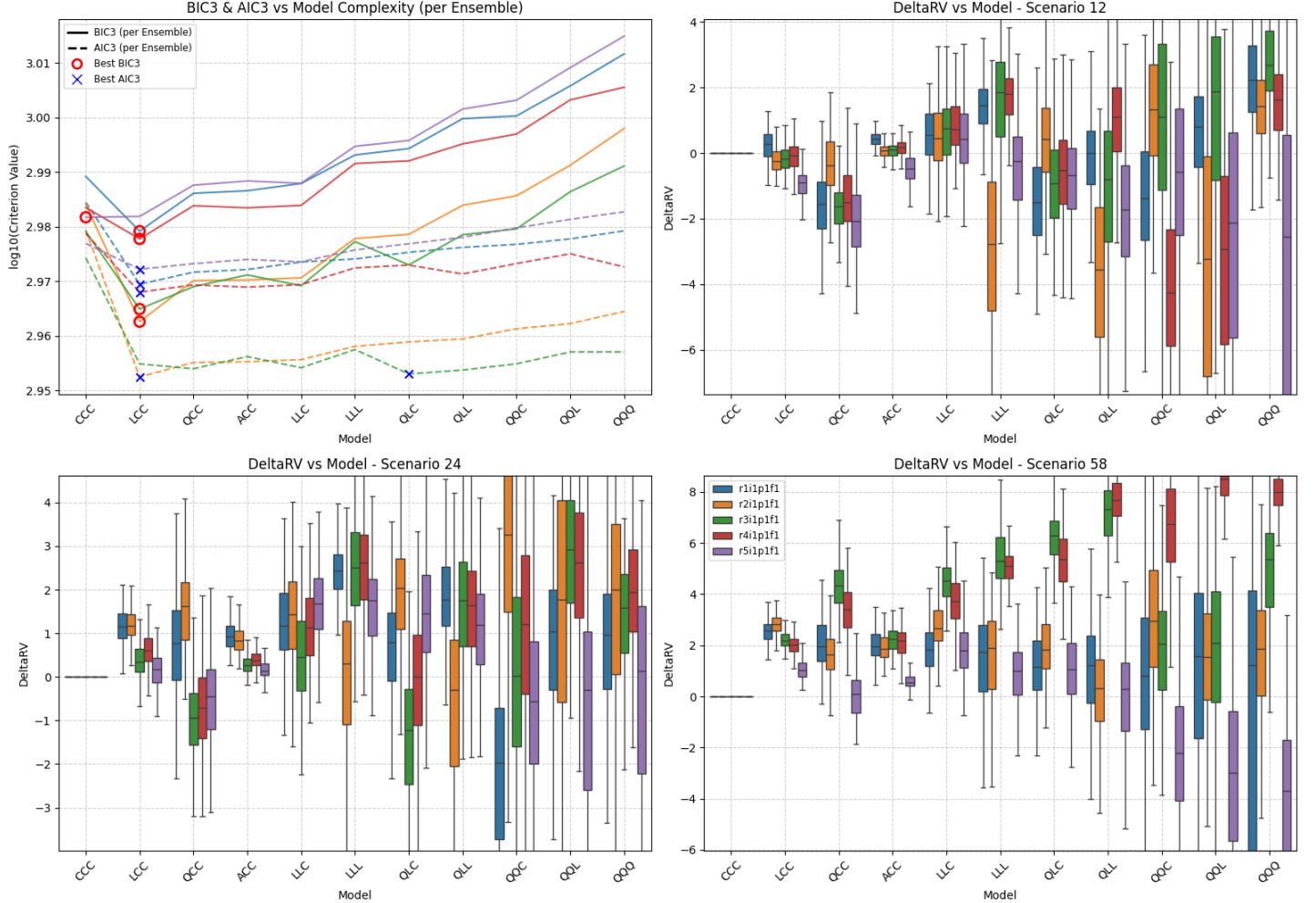


Figure SM54: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Sahara region using MRI-ESM2-0 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SA | GCM: UK | Agg: Mnm

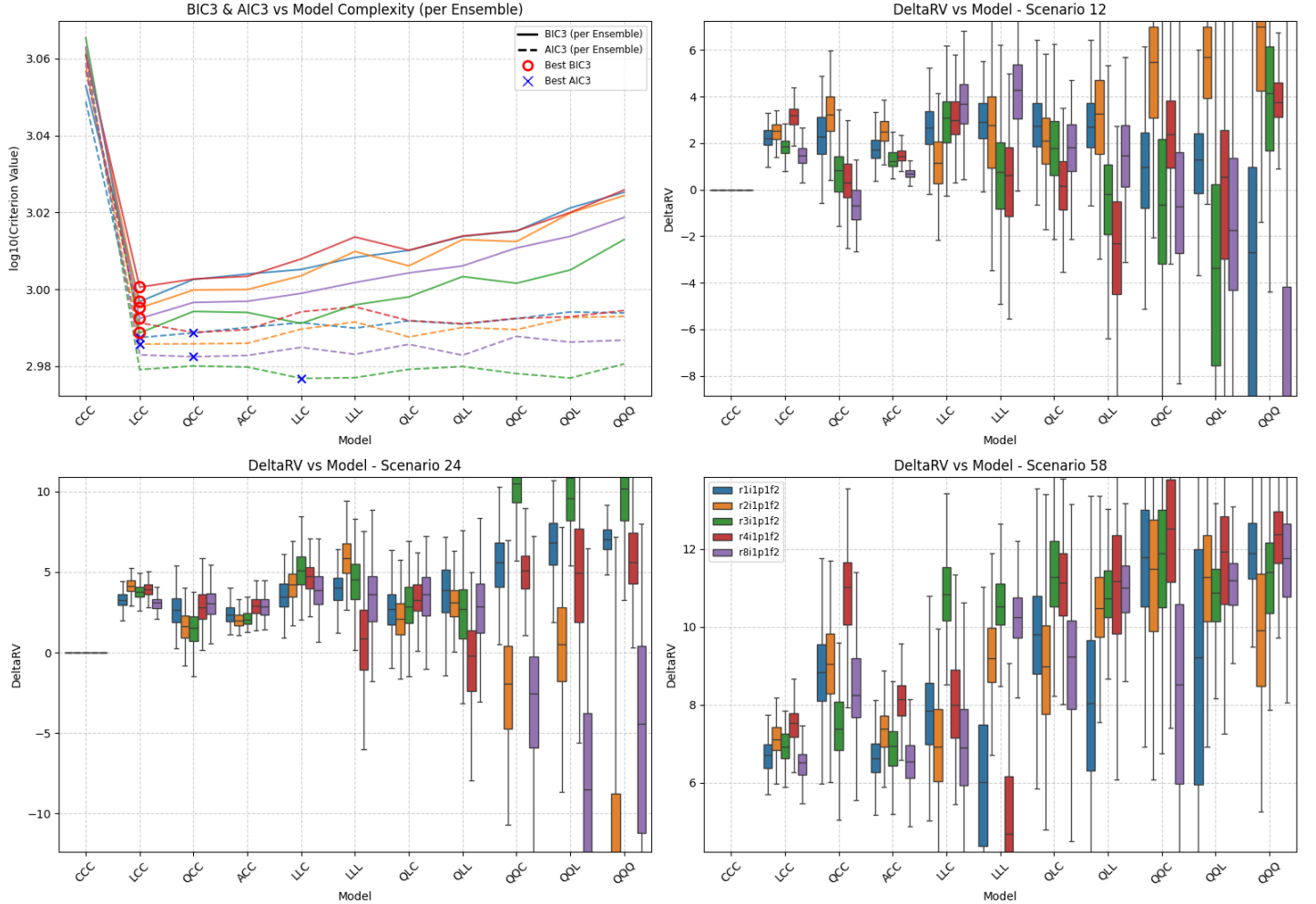


Figure SM55: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Sahara region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SI | GCM: AC | Agg: Mnm

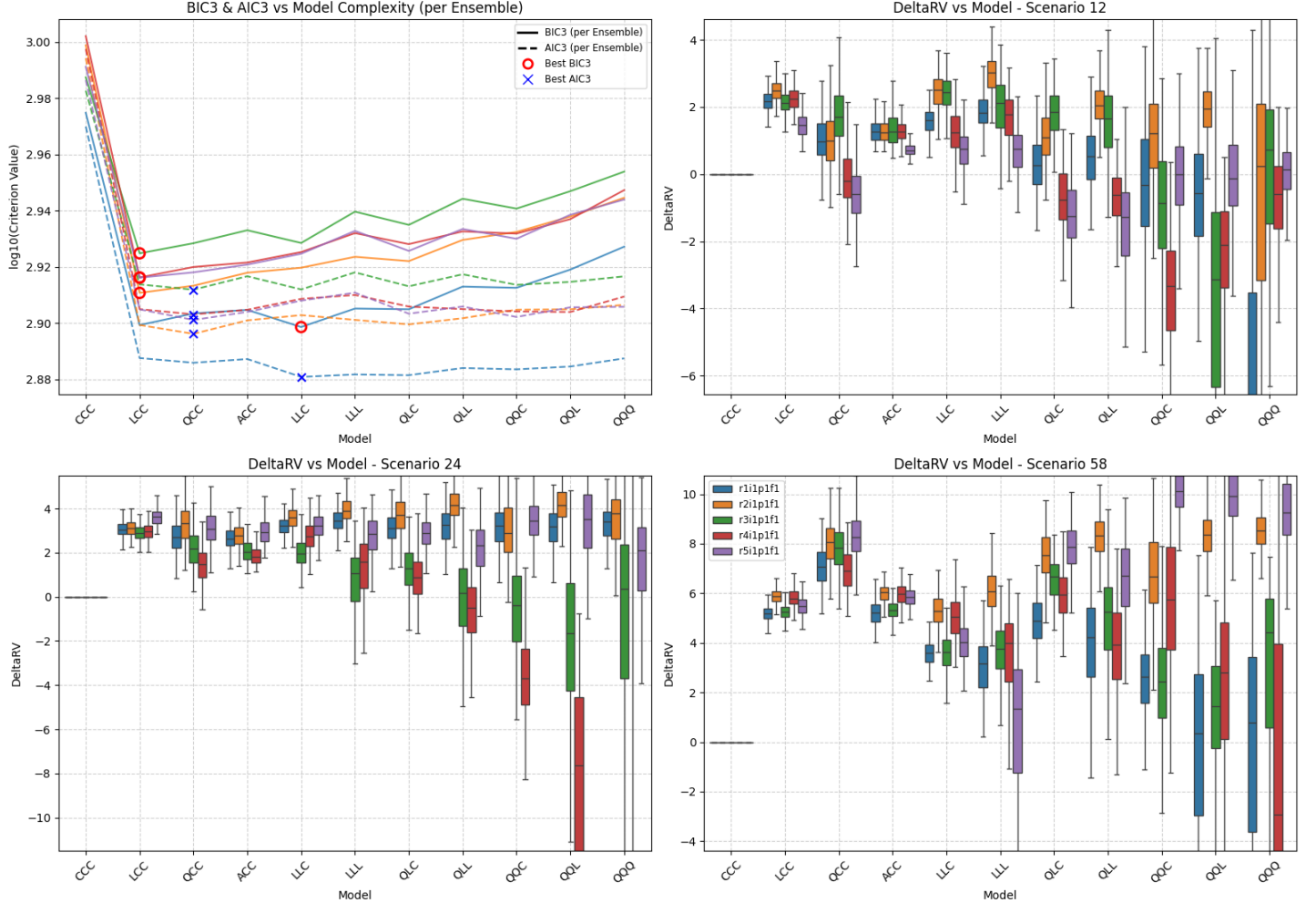
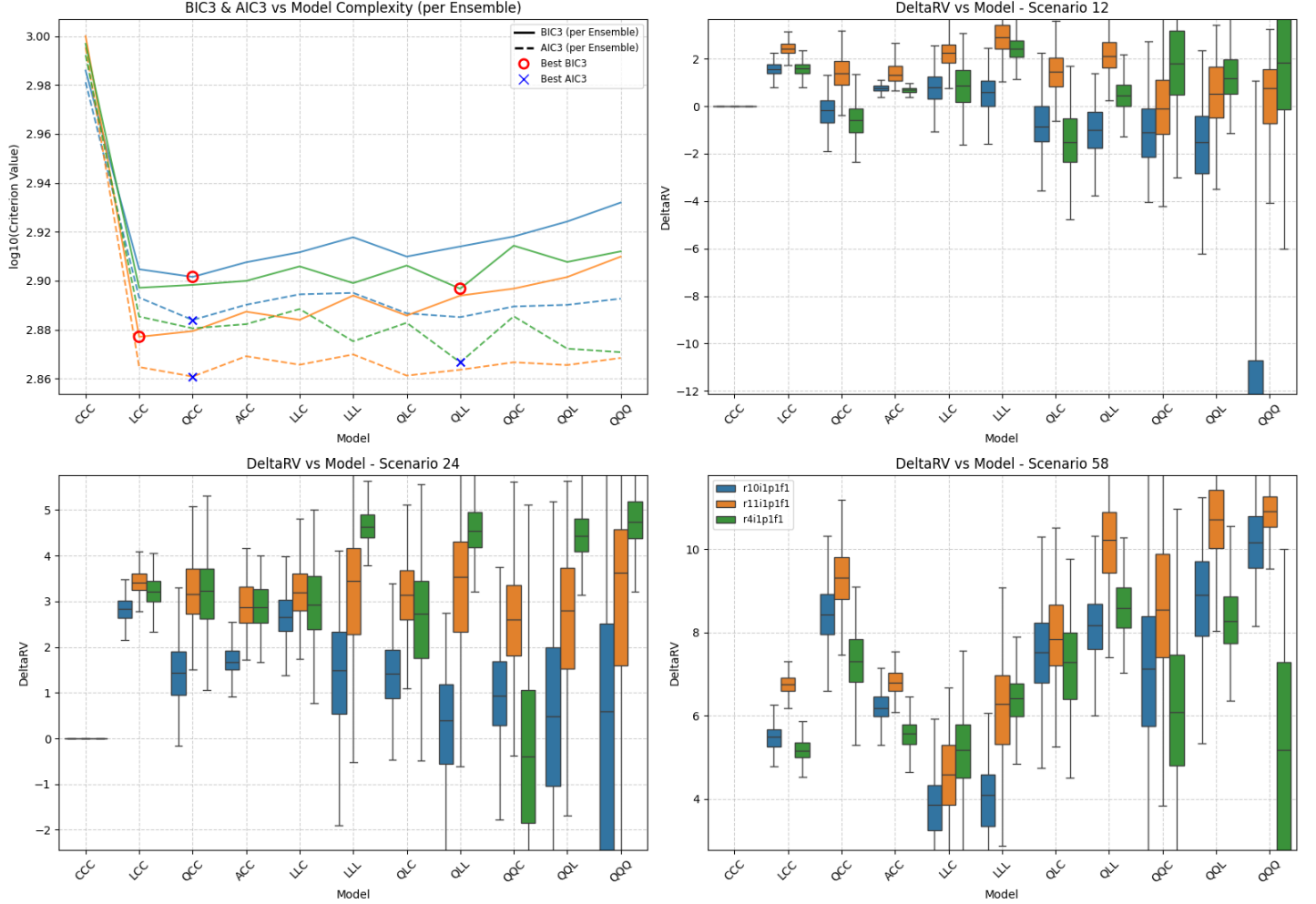


Figure SM56: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Simpson region using ACCESS-CM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SI | GCM: CE | Agg: Mnm



Location: SI | GCM: EC | Agg: Mnm

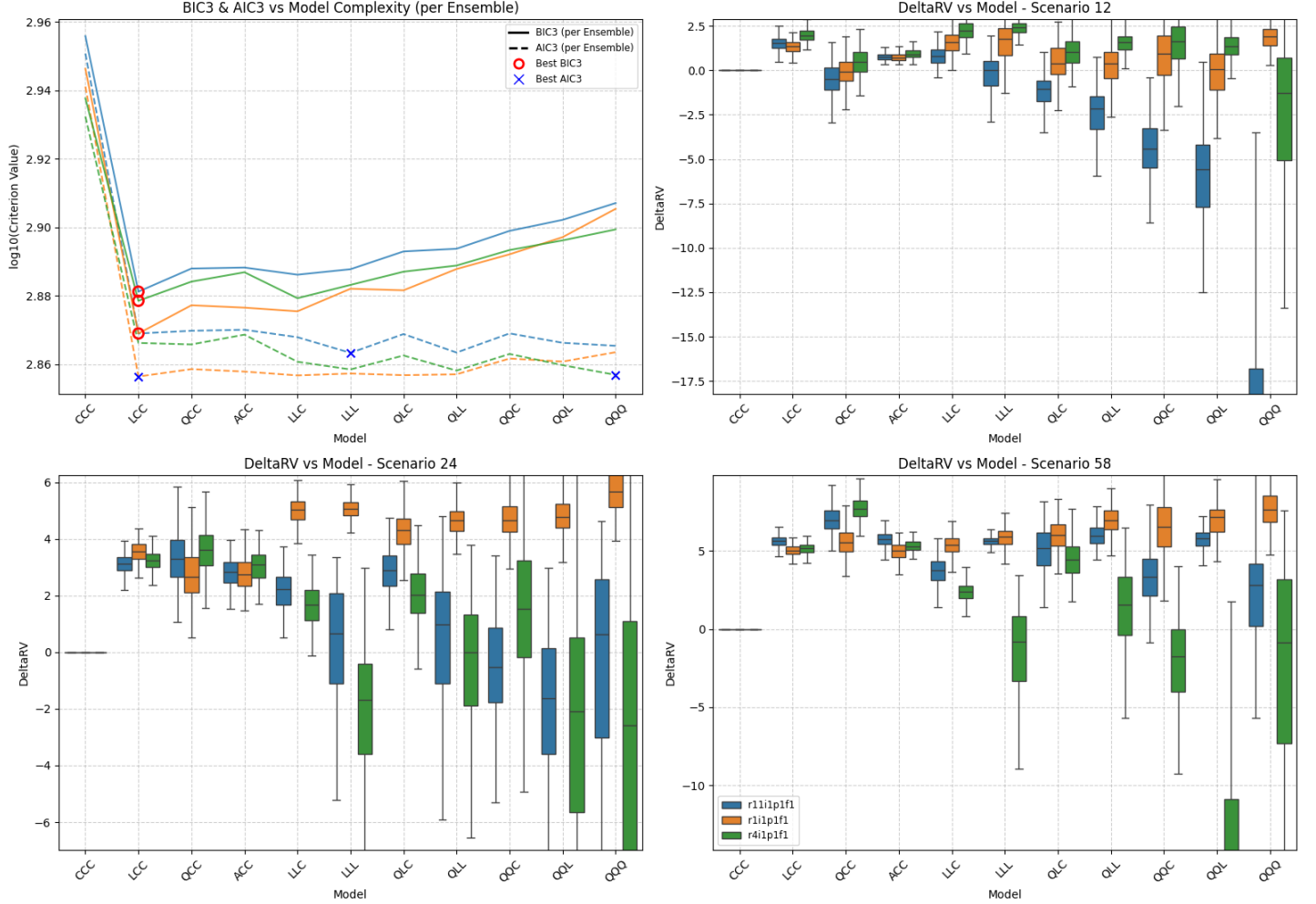


Figure SM58: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Simpson region using EC-Earth3 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

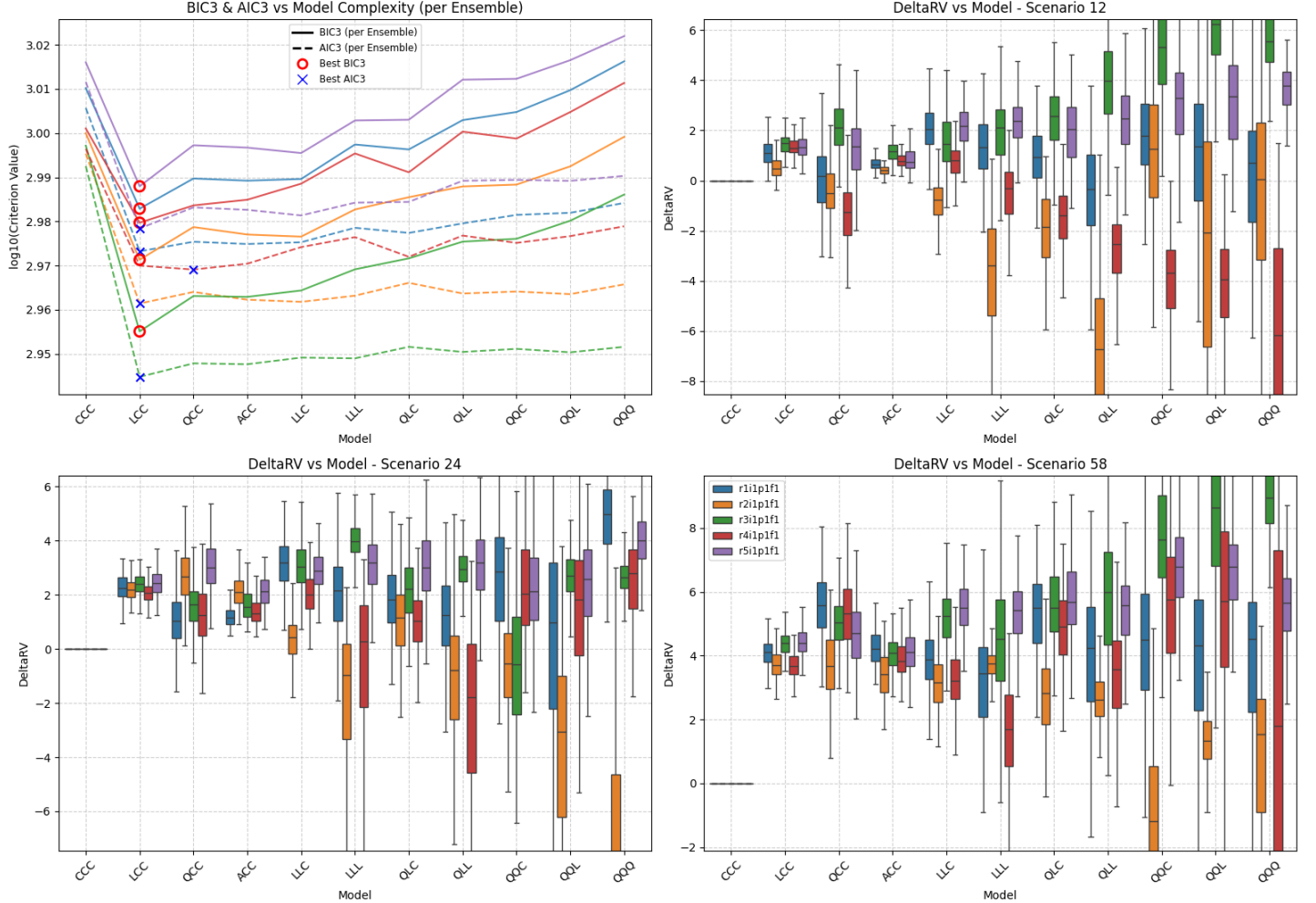


Figure SM59: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Simpson region using MRI-ESM2-0 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: SI | GCM: UK | Agg: Mnm

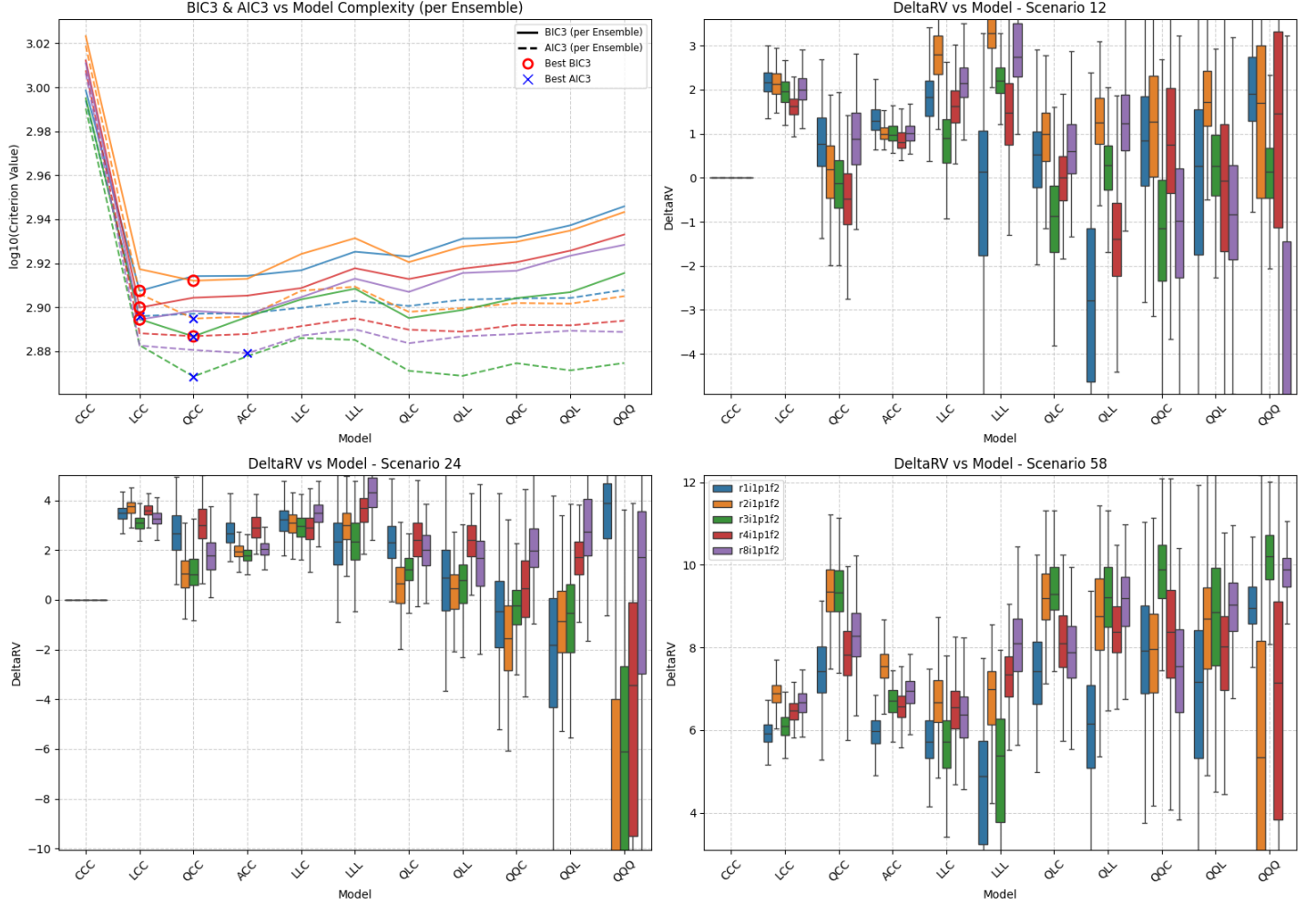
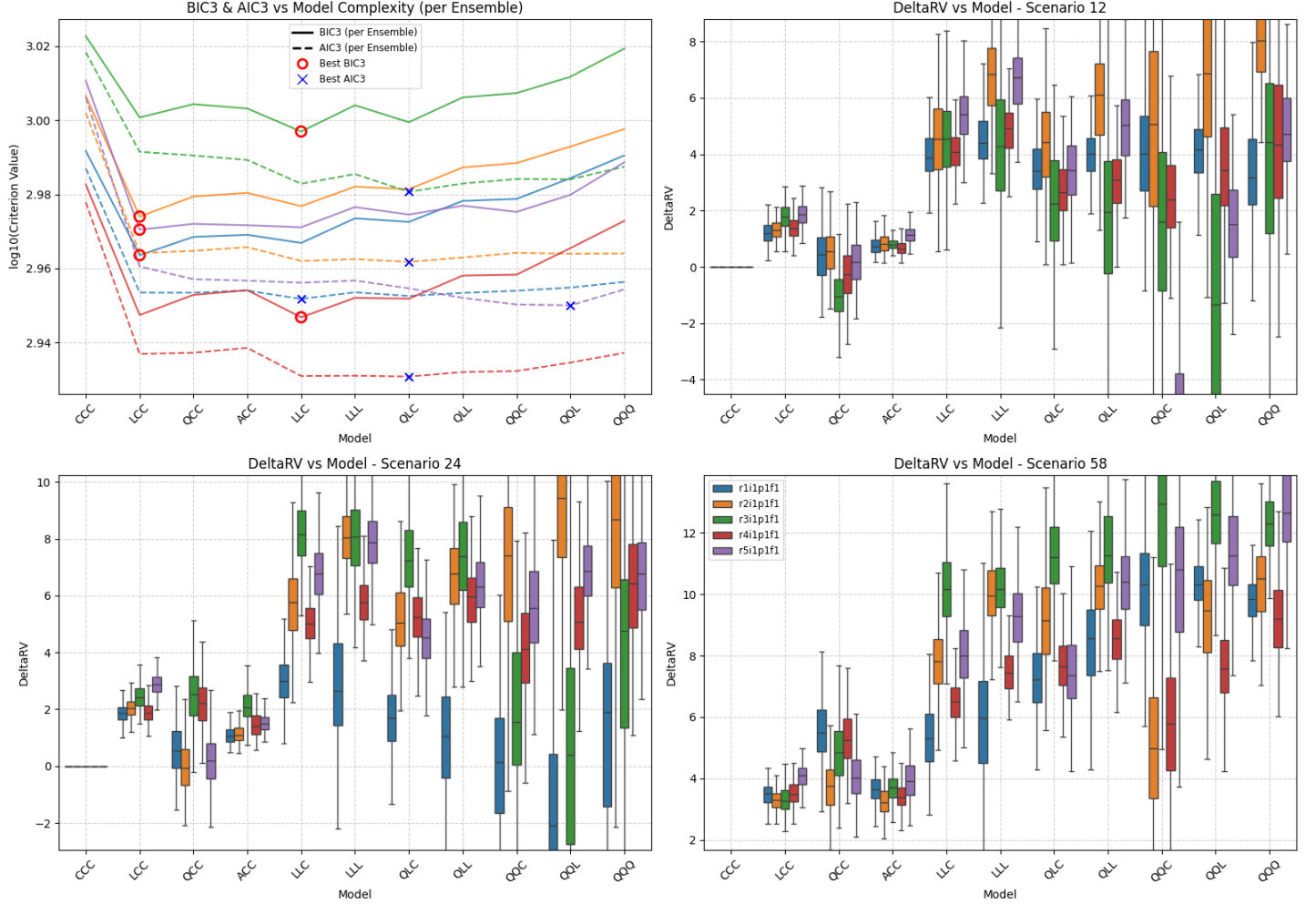


Figure SM60: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the Simpson region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.



Location: UK | GCM: CE | Agg: Mnm

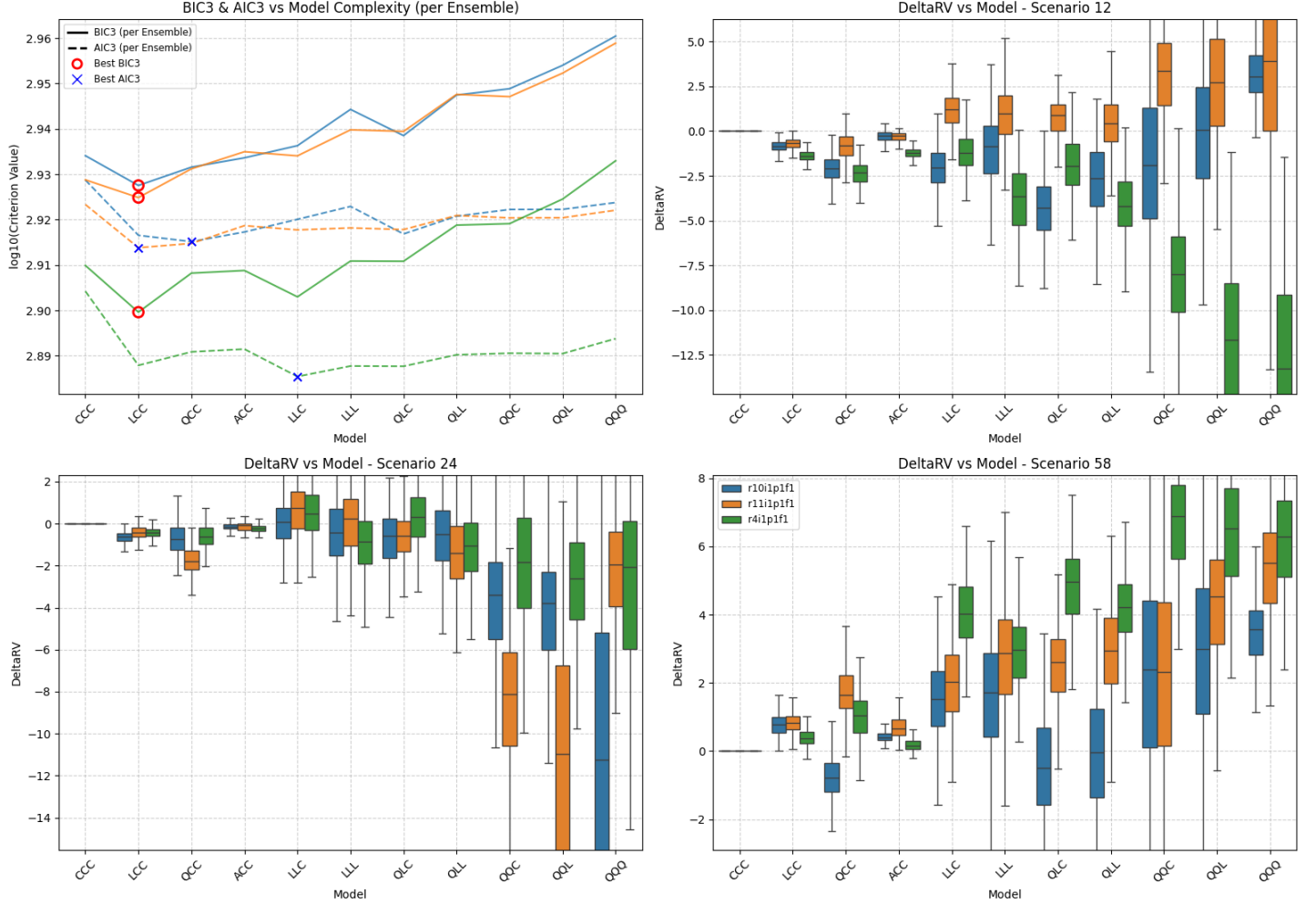


Figure SM62: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the UK region using CESM2 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: UK | GCM: EC | Agg: Mnm

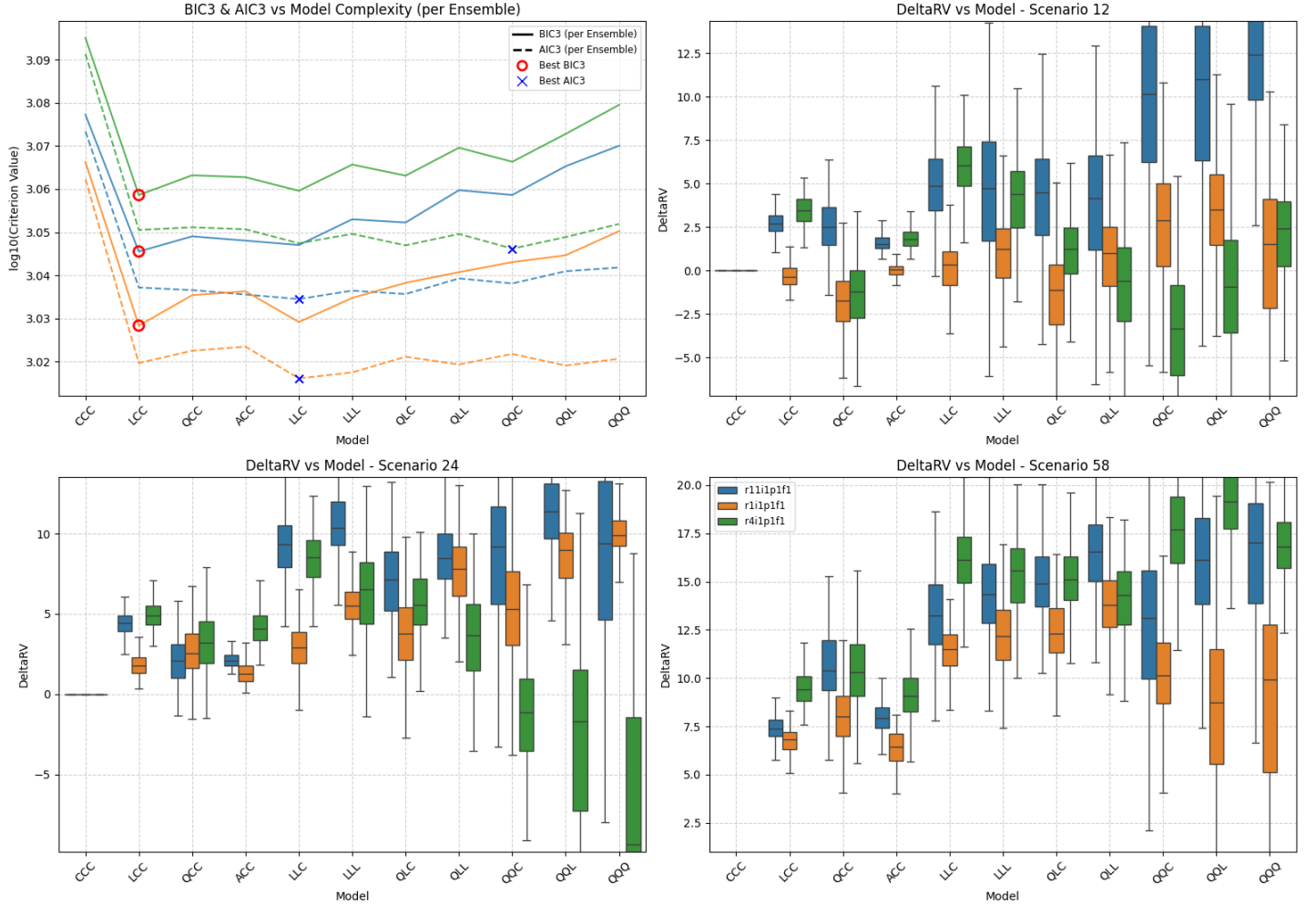


Figure SM63: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the UK region using EC-Earth3 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: UK | GCM: MR | Agg: Mnm

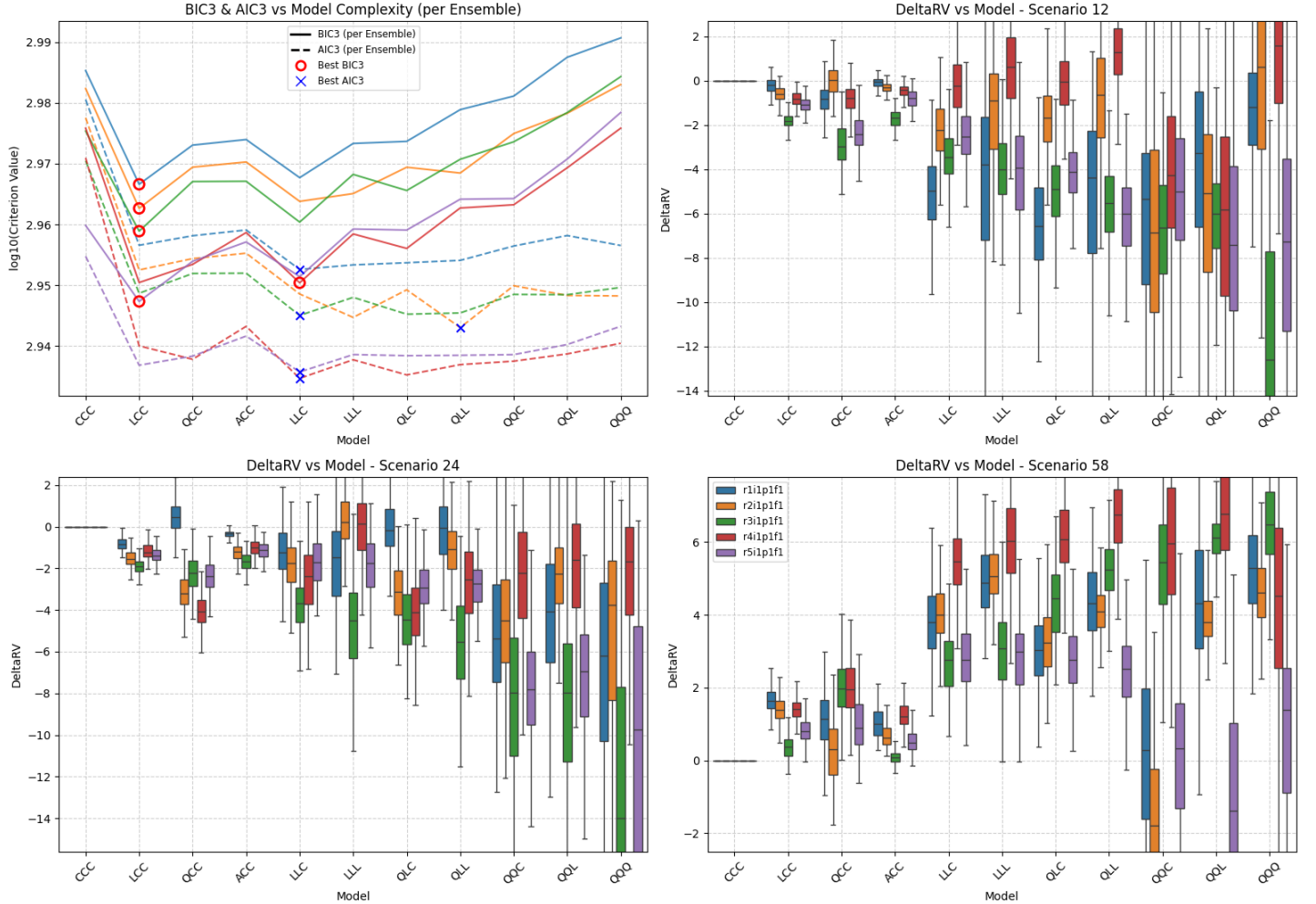


Figure SM64: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the UK region using MRI-ESM2-0 GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

Location: UK | GCM: UK | Agg: Mnm

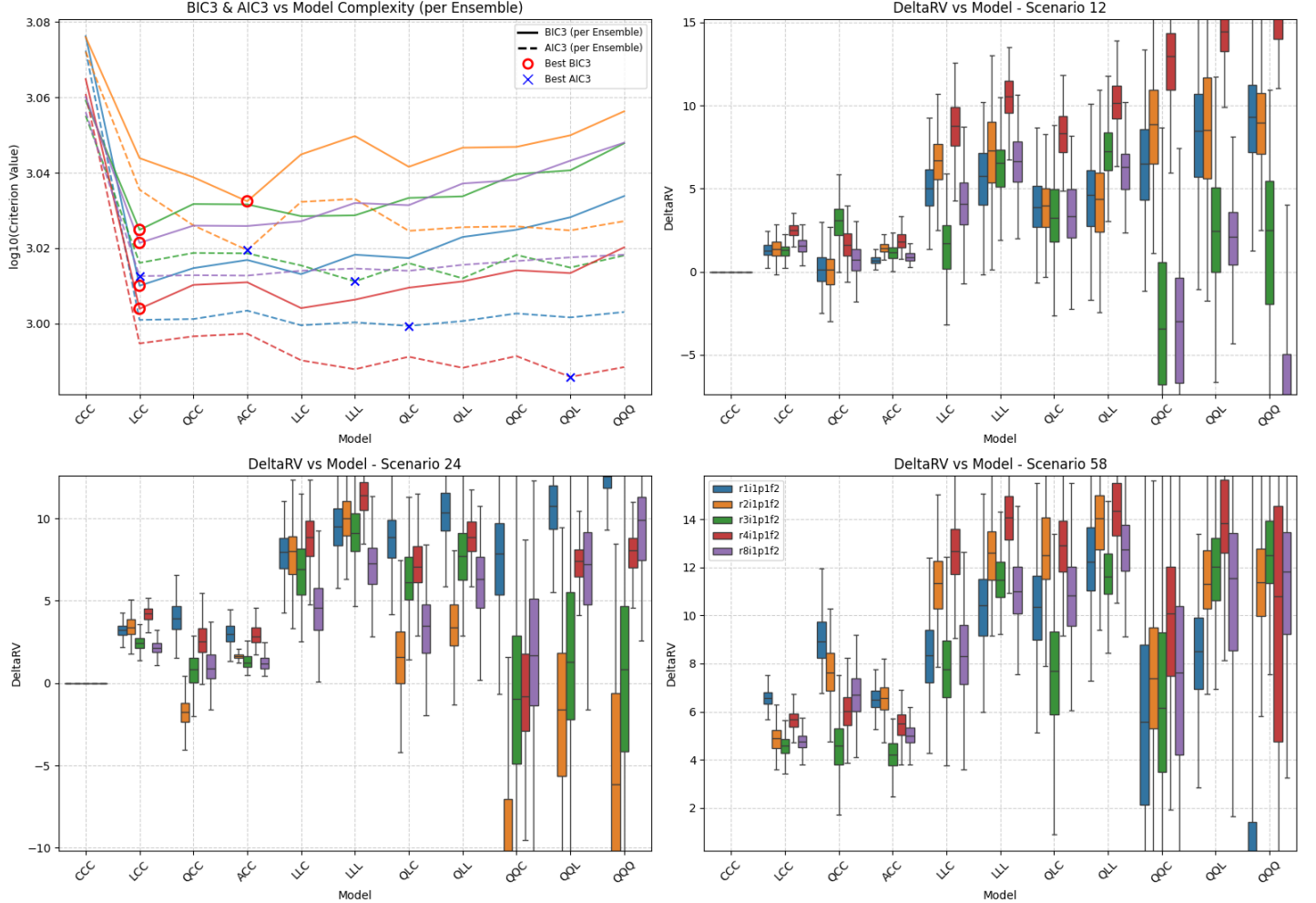


Figure SM65: Summary of scenario-coupled GEV regression for regional annual minima of the UK region using UKESM1-0-LL GCM data. Top left: plots of BIC3 (solid line) and AIC3 (dashed line) for each available ensemble (distinguished by colour, see Table 2 of the main text and legend in bottom-right panel); optimal model choice using BIC3 (AIC3) indicated using red disc (blue cross). Top right: box-whisker plots summarising the distribution of the difference in the 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125 (ΔQ_1 ; see Equation 7) for climate scenario SSP126 as a function of fitted model complexity (x-axis) and ensemble (distinguished by colour, with consistent ensemble colouring across panels); location of horizontal centre line of each box indicates posterior median of ΔQ_1 ; location of top (bottom) side of each box indicates 75%ile (25%ile) point, and top (bottom) of whiskers the 97.5%ile (2.5%ile) point of the posterior distribution. Bottom left and right: analogues of top right for scenarios SSP245 (ΔQ_2) and SSP585 (ΔQ_3). Value of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ under model CCC is identically zero, and is omitted from bottom panels when convenient to provide better illustration of the variation in estimates under more complex models. For comparison with Figure 6 of the main text.

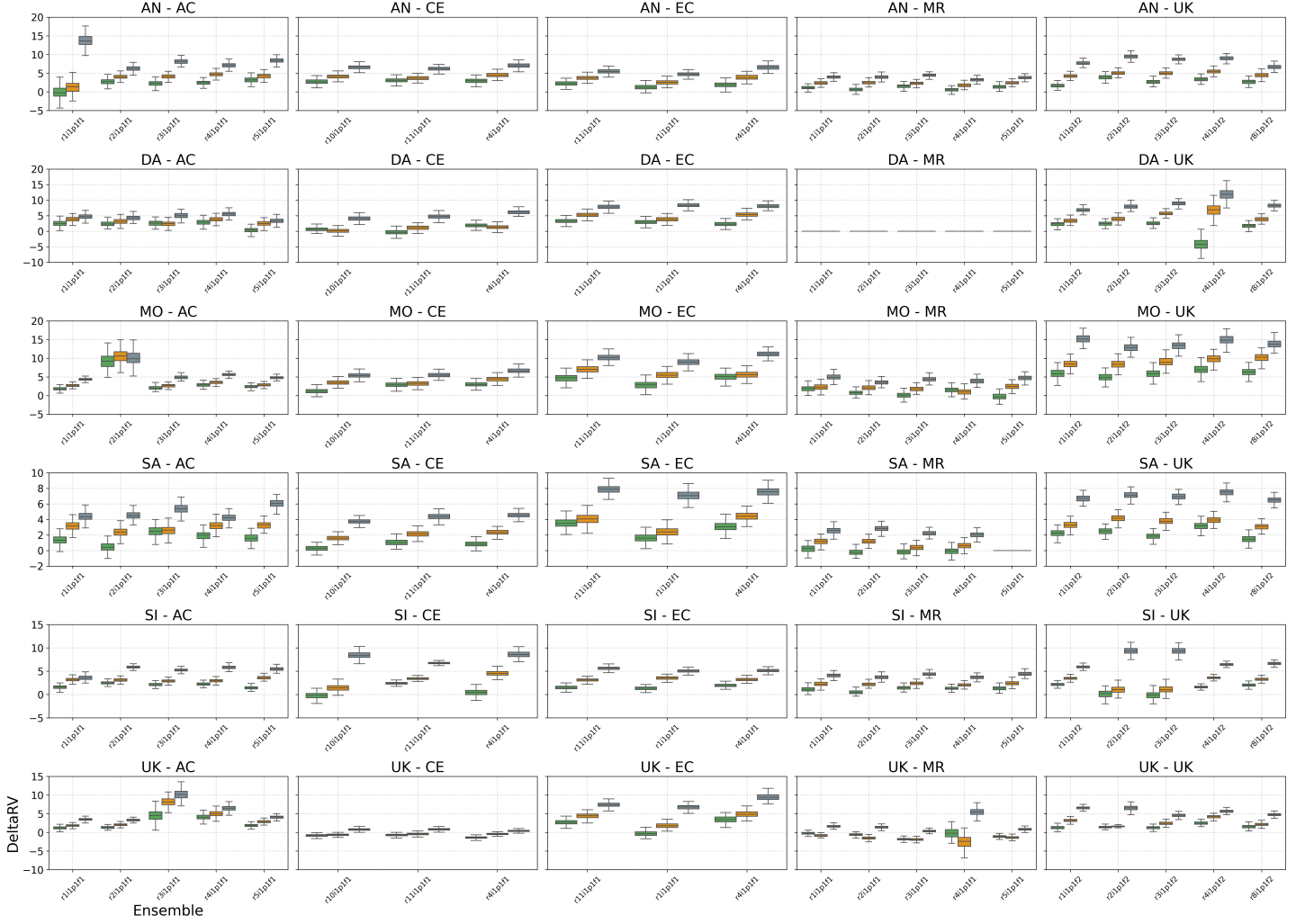


Figure SM66: Summary of inferences for return value differences ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 7) of regional annual minima using BIC3 for model selection. Each panel shows box-whisker plots summarising the posterior distribution of ΔQ for climate scenarios SSP126 ($j = 1$, green), SSP245 ($j = 2$, orange) and SSP585 ($j = 3$, grey) for each of up to five climate ensembles. Different panels show inferences for specific combinations of regions and locations; see Tables 1 and 2 for region and GCM acronyms.

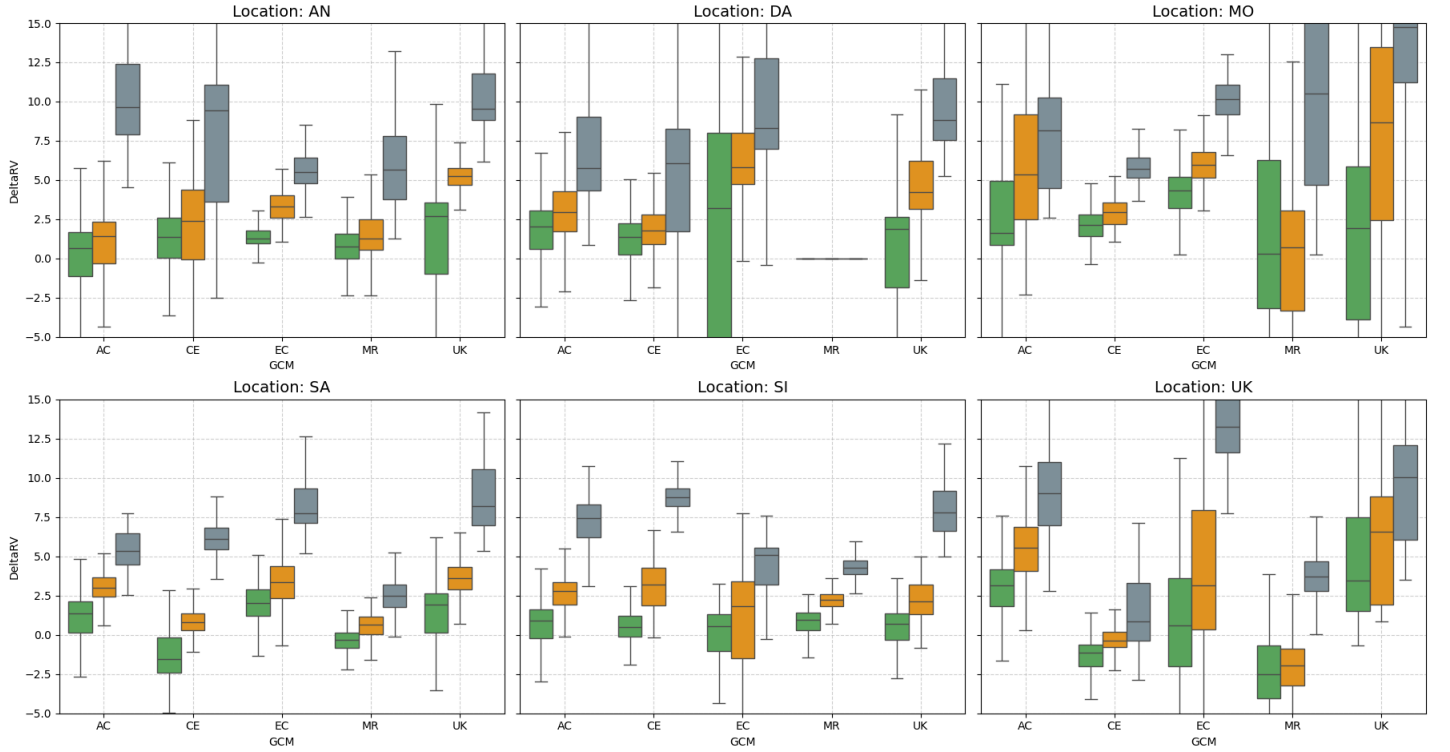


Figure SM67: Summary of inferences for return value differences ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 7) of regional annual minima using AIC3 for model selection, aggregated over climate ensemble. Each panel shows box-whisker plots summarising the posterior distribution of ΔQ for climate scenarios SSP126 ($j = 1$, green), SSP245 ($j = 2$, orange) and SSP585 ($j = 3$, grey) and each of five GCMs (ACCESS-CM2, CESM2, EC-Earth3, MRI-ESM2-0, UKESM1-0-LL). Left to right, top to bottom, panels show inferences for the Antarctic, Dasht-e Lut, Mojave, Sahara, Simpson and UK regions. For comparison with Figure 10.



Figure SM68: Summary of inferences for return value differences ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 7) of regional annual minima using AIC3 for model selection. Each panel shows box-whisker plots summarising the posterior distribution of ΔQ for climate scenarios SSP126 ($j = 1$, green), SSP245 ($j = 2$, orange) and SSP585 ($j = 3$, grey) for each of up to five climate ensembles. Different panels show inferences for specific combinations of regions and locations; see Tables 1 and 2 for region and GCM acronyms.

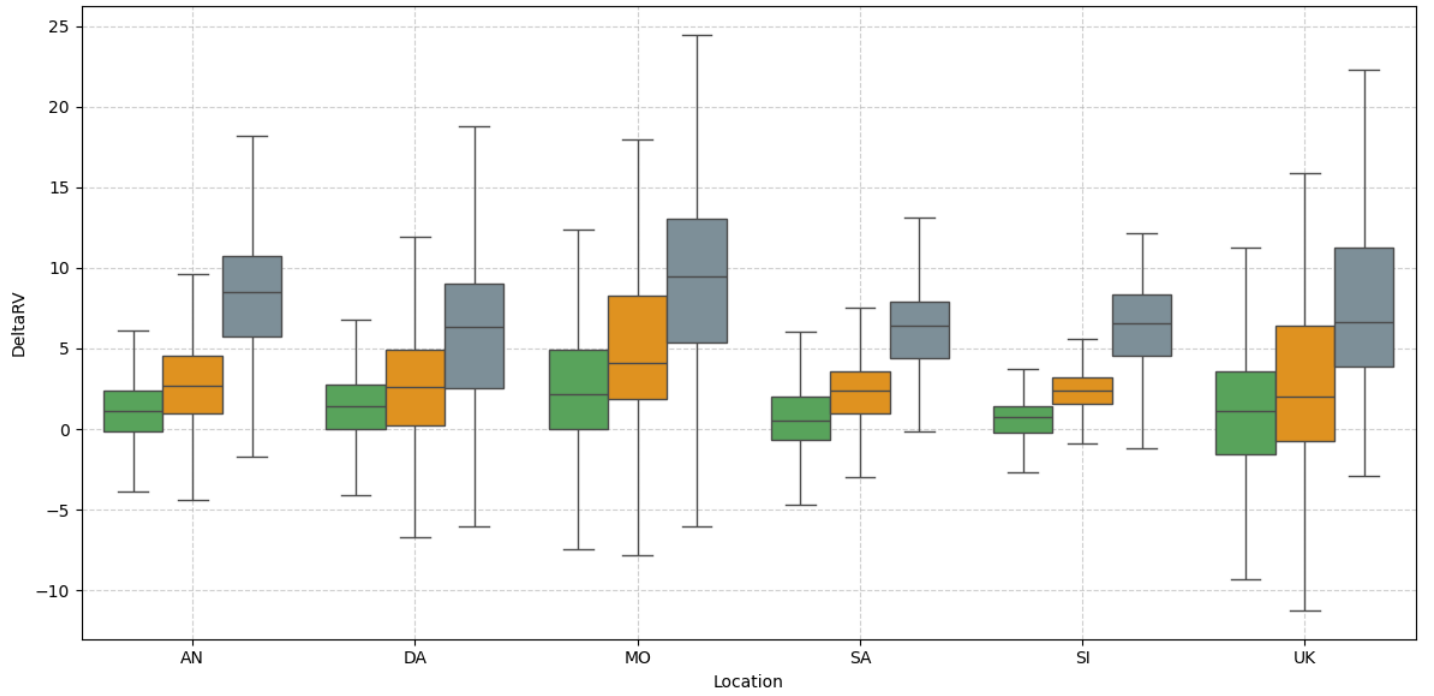


Figure SM69: Summary of inferences for return value differences ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 7) of regional annual minima using AIC3 for model selection, aggregated over climate ensemble and GCM. Box-whisker plots summarise the posterior distribution of ΔQ for climate scenarios SSP126 ($j = 1$, green), SSP245 ($j = 2$, orange) and SSP585 ($j = 3$, grey) for the Antarctic, Dasht-e Lut, Mojave, Sahara, Simpson and UK regions.

SM6 Differences between changes in return value for maxima and minima

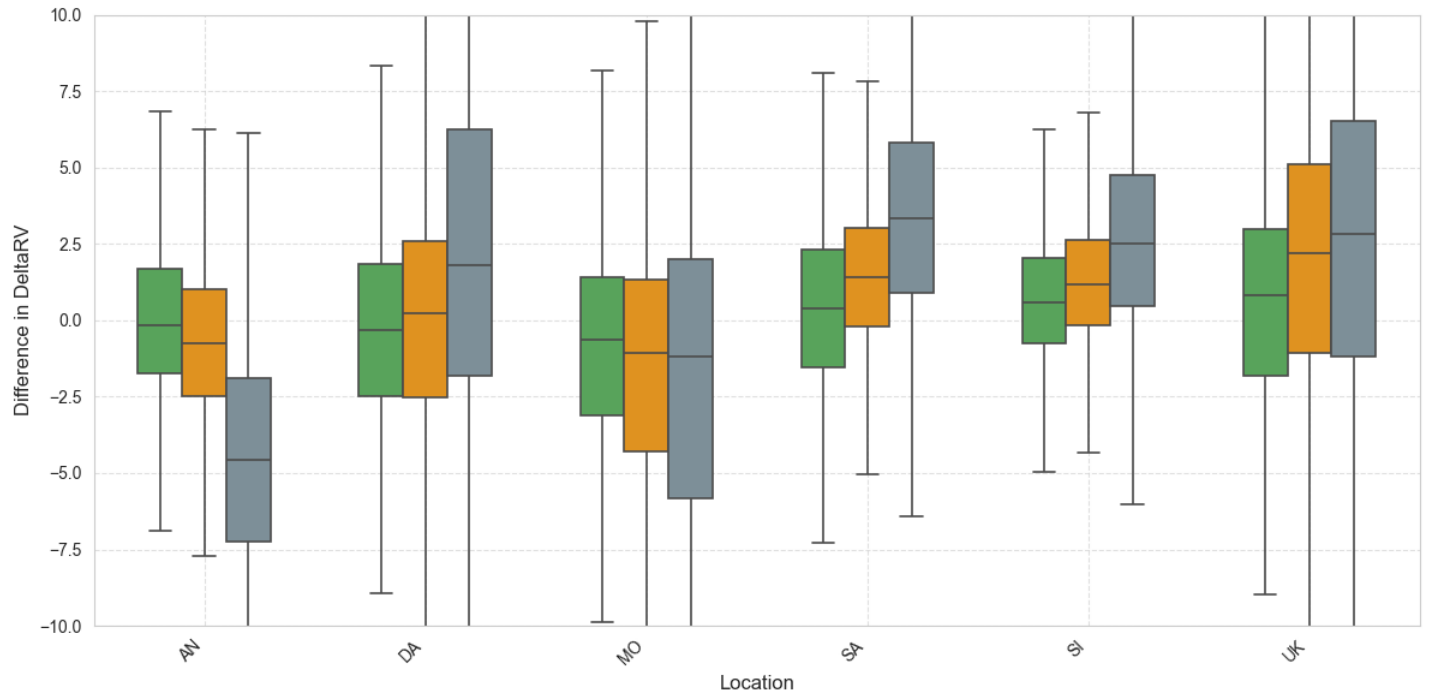


Figure SM70: Summary of inferences for the difference $\Delta\Delta Q_j$, $j = 1, 2, 3$ (see Equation 12) between ΔQ values of regional annual maxima and minima. AIC3 was used for model selection, and posterior distributions aggregated over climate ensemble and GCM. For other details, see Figure 8. For comparison with Figure 12.

SM7 Locations of regional annual maxima and minima in time

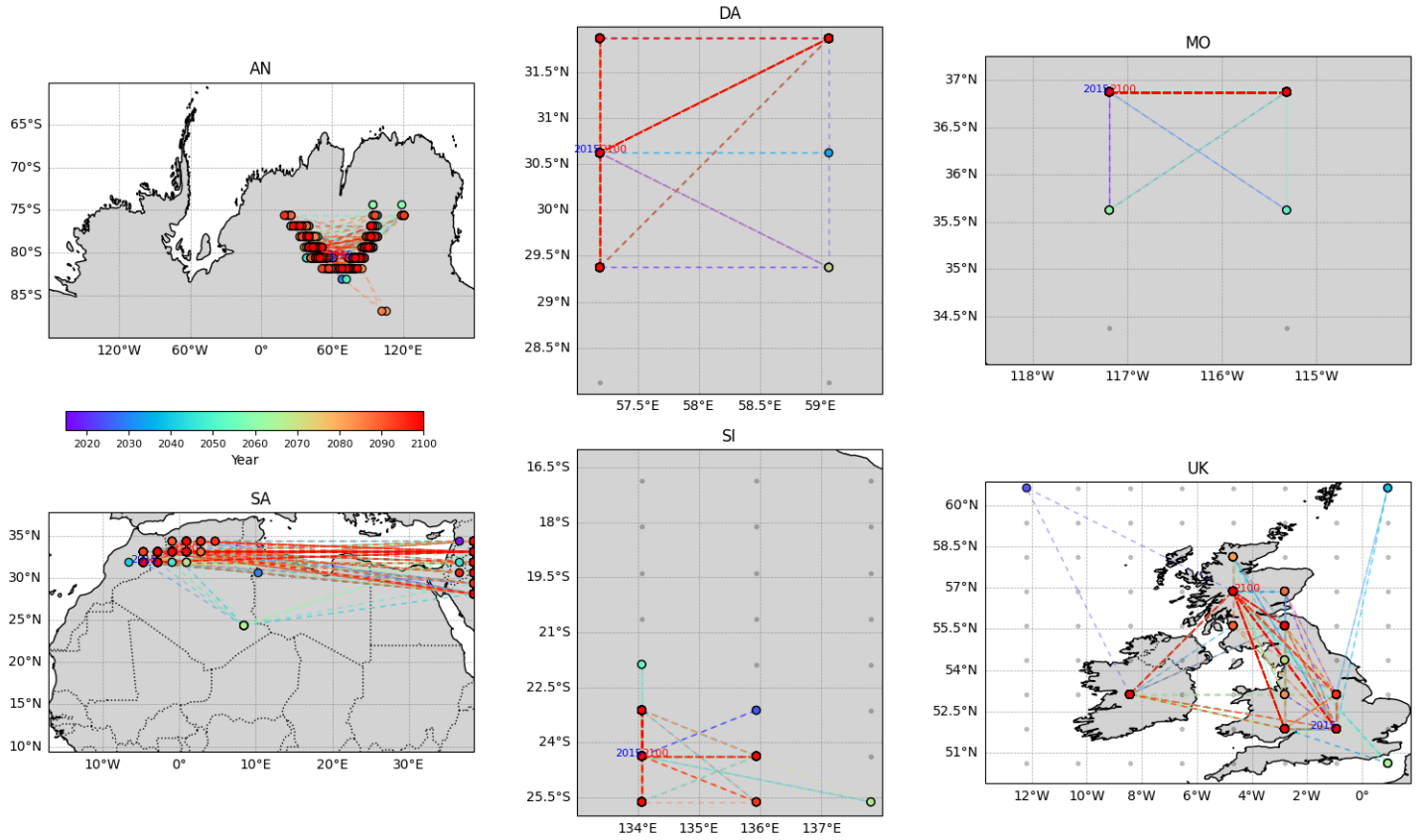


Figure SM71: Locations of regional annual minima (coloured discs) per region (panels) over time for the period (2015,2100) from the UKESM1-0-LL GCM. Lines connect discs corresponding to adjacent years; disc and line colours indicate the year; grey dots indicate GCM grid locations for Dasht-e Lut (DA), Mojave (MO), Simpson (SI) and UK (UK), suppressed for Antarctic (AN) and Sahara (SA). For comparison with Figure 13.

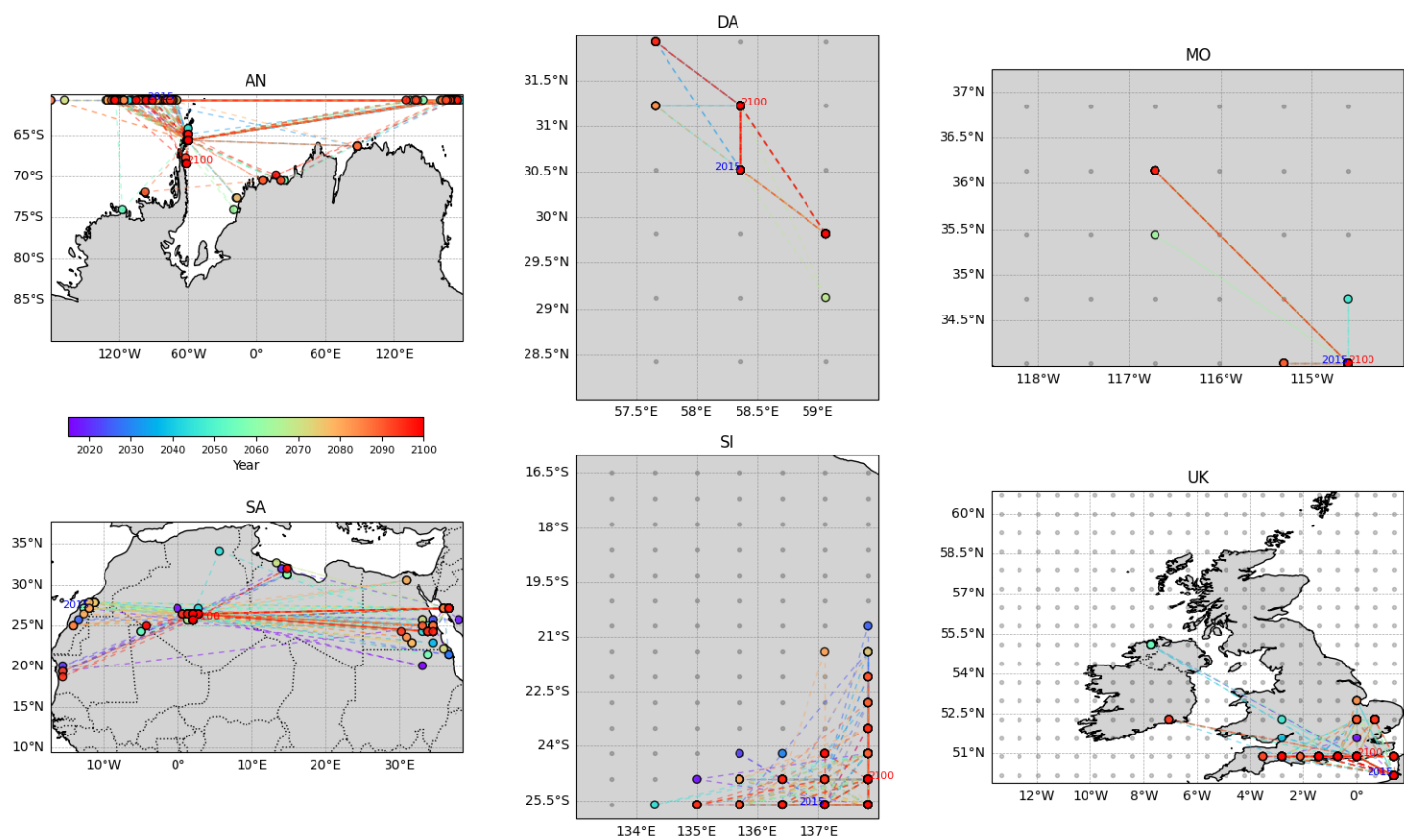


Figure SM72: Locations of regional annual maxima (coloured discs) per region (panels) over time for the period (2015,2100) from the EC-Earth3 GCM. For other details, see Figure SM71.

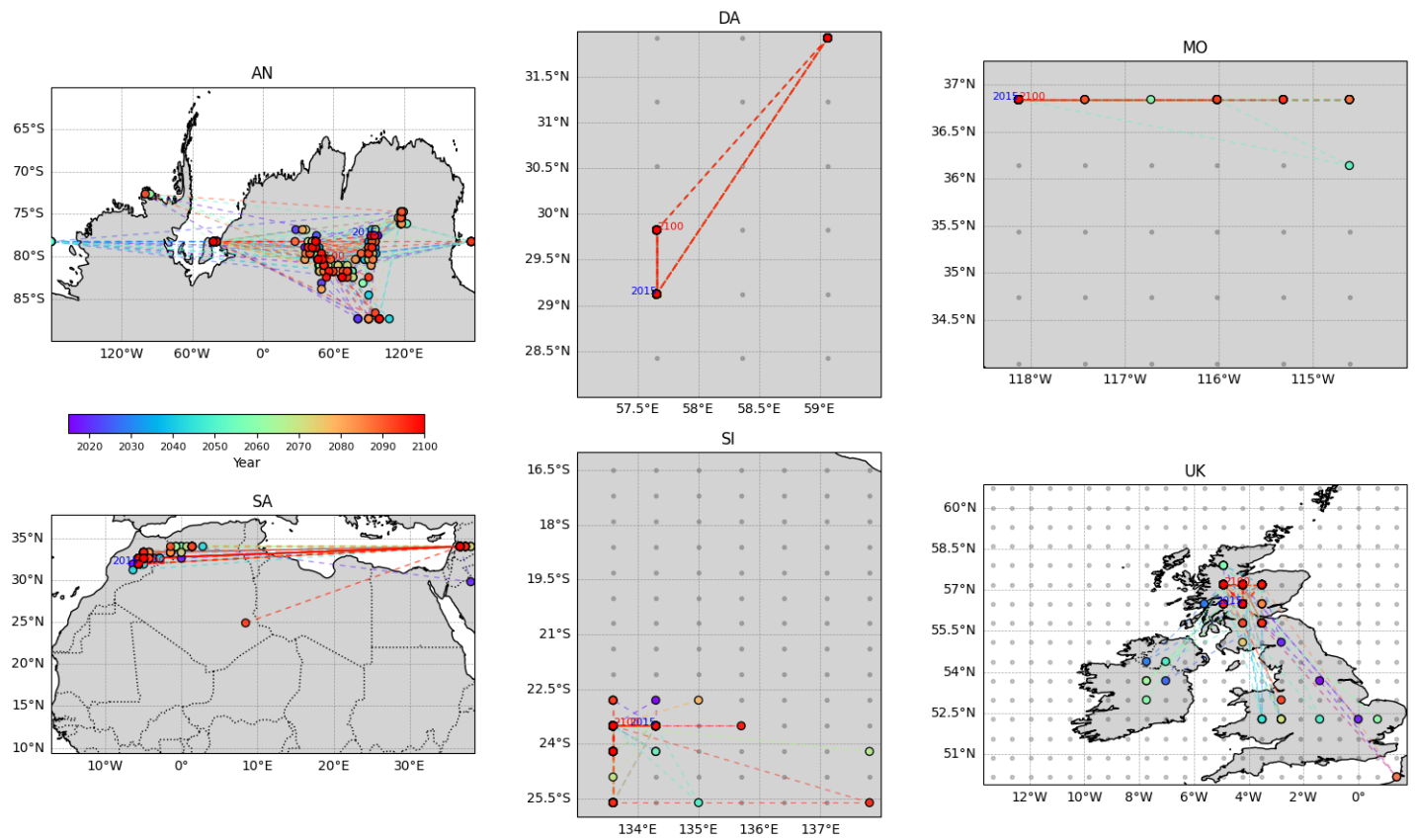


Figure SM73: Locations of regional annual minima (coloured discs) per region (panels) over time for the period (2015,2100) from the EC-Earth3 GCM. For other details, see Figure SM71.

SM8 Distribution of complexity of fitted models

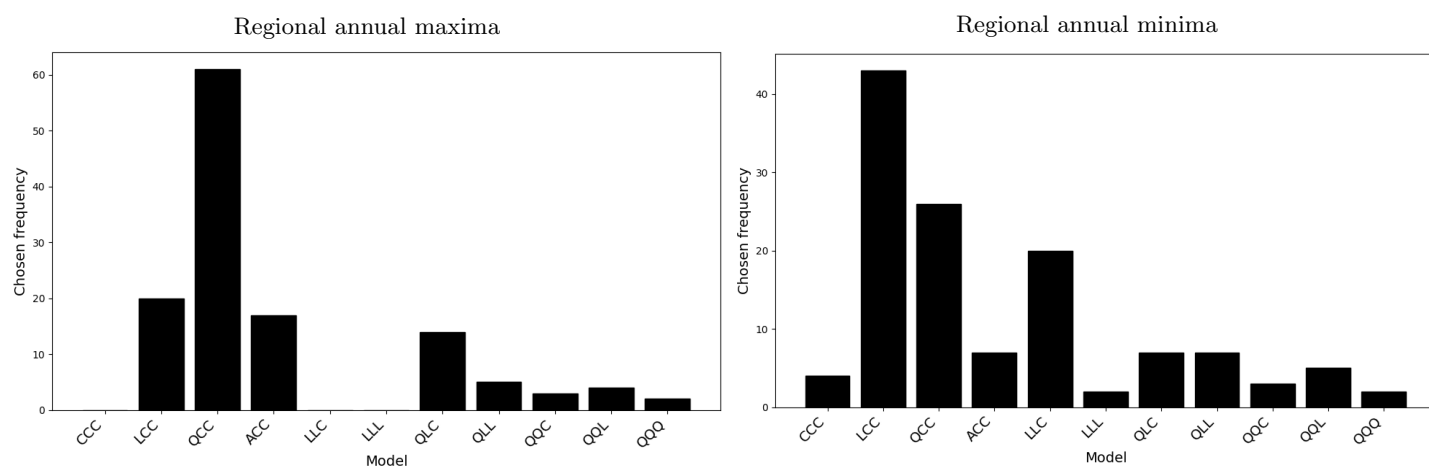


Figure SM74: Complexities of optimal fitted models for regional annual maxima (left) and minima (right) using AIC3 for model selection.

SM9 Bayesian model averaging

This section should be read in conjunction with Section 6.4 of the main text. Consider using sample $x = \{x_1, x_2, \dots, x_P\}$ of annual maxima to estimate n_M different models $M_1, M_2, \dots, M_{n_M}$, with which to make a prediction of some future q . In the context of the current work, the $n_M = 11$ models correspond to the different models CCC, LCC, ..., QQQ, and q to the vector of values of ΔQ for the difference in 100-year return value between 2025 and 2125, for three climate scenarios SSP126, SSP245 and SSP585. Instead of selecting a single “best” model from the set of n_M models, we can use a weighted average of all the models for prediction. Specifically, the Bayesian model average for the density $f(q|x)$ of q given sample x takes the form

$$f(q|x) = \sum_{m=1}^{n_M} f(q|M_m, x) f(M_m|x) \quad (\text{SM1})$$

where $f(q|M_m, x)$ is the posterior predictive density of q under model M_m , $m = 1, 2, \dots, n_M$, and $f(M_m|x)$ is the posterior probability of model M_m given x . We can estimate $f(q|M_m, x)$ relatively straightforwardly using Bayesian inference, e.g., using MCMC as in the current work, since

$$f(q|M_m, x) = \int_{\theta_m} f(q|\theta_m, M_m) f(\theta_m|M_m, x) d\theta \quad (\text{SM2})$$

where $f(\theta_m|M_m, x)$ is the posterior density of parameters θ_m of model M_m from the MCMC, and $f(q|\theta_m, M_m)$ is the known density of q given M_m and its parameters θ_m . We can also attempt to estimate the posterior probability of model M_m using the expression

$$f(M_m|x) = \frac{f(x|M_m) f(M_m)}{\sum_{m'=1}^{n_M} f(x|M_{m'}) f(M_{m'})} \quad (\text{SM3})$$

where $f(x|M_m)$ is the marginal probability of x under model M_m , given by

$$f(x|M_m) = \int_{\theta_m} f(x|\theta_m, M_m) f(\theta_m|M_m) d\theta \quad (\text{SM4})$$

where $f(x|\theta_m, M_m)$ is the known density of x given model M_m with parameters θ_m . The remaining densities $f(M_m)$ in Equation SM3 and $f(\theta_m|M_m)$ in Equation SM4 are prior specifications of the models M_m , $m = 1, 2, \dots, n_M$ and their parameters θ_m . In principle, once the priors are specified we can therefore use Equations SM1 - SM4 to estimate the model average density for q .

In practice however, specifying $f(M_m)$ and $f(\theta_m|M_m)$, $m = 1, 2, \dots, n_M$ is problematic. Practitioners often revert to trying different possible choices of prior, and confirming whether plausible estimates for $f(q|x)$ result. Model stacking provides a data-driven alternative to prior specification. The stacked model average density $f_S(q|x)$ is given by

$$f_S(q|x) = \sum_{m=1}^{n_M} w_m f(q|M_m, x) \quad (\text{SM5})$$

where weight vector $w = (w_1, w_2, \dots, w_{n_M})$ is found by a cross-validation strategy

$$w = \underset{w'}{\operatorname{argmax}} \sum_{i=1}^P \log \left(\sum_{m=1}^{n_M} w'_m f(x_i|M_m, x_{-i}) \right) \quad (\text{SM6})$$

where $f(x_i|M_m, x_{-i})$ is the posterior predictive density of observation x_i , $i = 1, 2, \dots, n$, under model M_m estimated using all observations in x except for x_i . $f(x_i|M_m, x_{-i})$ is evaluated using

$$f(x_i|M_m, x_{-i}) = \int_{\theta_m} f(x_i|\theta_m, M_m) f(\theta_m|M_m, x_{-i}) d\theta \quad (\text{SM7})$$

where, as before, $f(x_i|\theta_m, M_m)$ is a known density, and $f(\theta_m|M_m, x_{-i})$ is the posterior density of parameters θ_m of model M_m estimated using sample x_{-i} , which can be sampled using MCMC. Comparison of Equations SM1 and SM5 suggests that the stacking weight vector w acts as an estimate of the set of the posterior probabilities $f(M_m|x)$, $m = 1, 2, \dots, n_M$.

To then evaluate the RMSE for BMA in Section 6.4, we use the expression

$$\text{RMSE} = \left(\frac{1}{3n_R n_S} \sum_{j=1}^3 \sum_{k=1}^{n_R} \sum_{s=1}^{n_S} \left(\Delta Q_j^* - \sum_{m=1}^{n_M} (w_m | D_k) (\Delta Q_{j(s)} | M_m, D_k) \right)^2 \right)^{1/2}. \quad (\text{SM8})$$

where ΔQ_j^* is the true value, and $\Delta Q_{j(s)}|M_m, D_k$ is posterior estimate of ΔQ_j , $j = 1, 2, 3$ corresponding to iteration s , $s = 1, 2, \dots, n_S$ from the MCMC chain for data realisation D_k , $k = 1, 2, \dots, n_R$ and model M_m , $m = 1, 2, \dots, n_M$, and $w_m|D_k$ is the BMA weight of model M_m for data realisation D_k .

Note that many different metrics (or “scoring rules”) are available, as alternatives to RMSE, to evaluate the performance of our models for ΔQ . We chose RMSE for its simplicity; an attractive option might be the Jensen-Shannon (JS) divergence. Clearly, the choice of preferred model selection criterion in the simulation study of S4 of the main text (namely BIC3 using RMSE) might be different were we to use JS divergence as our metric.

An issue with applications of leave-out methods to environmental extreme value modelling is that the support of an estimated marginal model $f(x|M_m)$ may be bounded above if the posterior density of the shape parameter is zero for non-negative values. As a result, it is possible in particular that the density $f(x|M_m, x_{-i})$ of withheld observation x under model M_m estimated using sample x_{-i} is zero; that is, that the value x lies beyond the upper end point of the estimated GEV distribution. To mitigate this issue, we impose a constraint on the Bayesian inference using MCMC, for each geographic region considered, that temperatures up to 20% higher than the largest observed temperature (over all combinations of GCM, scenario and ensemble member) must have non-zero density. Formally, we insist that

$$\mu - \frac{\sigma}{\xi} > x_{\min}^* + 1.2 \times (x_{\max}^* - x_{\min}^*) \quad (\text{SM9})$$

for each geographic region, where $x_{\min}^*$ and $x_{\max}^*$ are the minimum and maximum values observed anywhere over the region, over all combinations of GCM, scenario and ensemble member.

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